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## NEARBY



### Vijay positions TVK as AIADMK successor

**DHARAPURAM**
Chief Minister and TVK chief C. Joseph Vijay has made his intent clear to position his party as an organic successor of the AIADMK, as he extolled its leadership acumen in handling the DMK. » PAGE 4

### 'Stealing of candidates caused bypolls'

**CHENNAI**
DMK leader Kanimozhi on Wednesday alleged that the Tamil Nadu bypolls had been necessitated by the "stealing of candidates" by those who had proclaimed themselves to be a "clean force". » PAGE 4

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

# Israel-bound plane drops 16,000 ft in a minute as pilot stabs colleague

Netanyahu hails Indian captain of Dubai-Tel Aviv flight for 'extraordinary bravery', says co-pilot tried to crash the plane; flydubai jet makes erratic circle close to Jordan, lands in Saudi Arabia; Defence Minister terms it a 'terrorist attack attempt'

**Associated Press**
TEL AVIV

An Indian pilot on a flight from the United Arab Emirates to Israel was stabbed by his co-pilot who was apparently trying to crash the aircraft on Wednesday, Israel's Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said.

Passengers and crew subdued the attacker, and the plane made a safe emergency landing in Saudi Arabia. Captain Smit Machchhar sustained serious injuries.

The flydubai flight FZ 1073 was travelling from Dubai to Tel Aviv carrying 174 people, dozens of them Israelis. Around two-and-a-half hours after leaving Dubai, the Boeing 737 MAX aircraft issued an emergency alert and descended from 33,000 feet to 17,000 feet in about a minute, before making an erratic circle close to the Jordanian border and landing in Tabuk in Saudi Arabia about an hour later, according to Flightradar24.


Passengers who were on the flydubai flight arrive at the Ben Gurion International Airport in Tel Aviv, Israel, on Wednesday night. AP

The episode prompted Israel to scramble warplanes amid concerns of possible hijacking.

Video footage circulating online shows two men on the floor of the plane, bloodied and wounded. Two people appear to be providing medical treatment, while two others guard the cockpit. "We are guarding the pilot," one person says in Hebrew.

In another video, passengers weep and cry out in distress as the aircraft shakes.

The passengers and crew who intervened "saved many lives and prevented a major disaster," Mr. Netanyahu said, adding that the co-pilot, whose identity was not immediately shared by authorities, has been arrested in Saudi Arabia and is being questioned by authorities. Saudi Arabia had no immediate comment.

Mr. Netanyahu praised Captain Machchhar for his "extraordinary bravery". "Despite being stabbed and seriously injured, he fought back... preventing a catastrophic mid-air disaster. He saved the lives of 174 people, including Israeli citizens and other nationals," Mr. Netanyahu wrote on X. Captain Machchhar has been admitted to a hospital in Tabuk city and is reported to be in stable condition.

Later in the day, the passengers were taken to Israel in a separate aircraft. Israel has decided to ramp up security checks on pilots flying into the country following the incident, a spokesperson for the Prime Minister's Office said.

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz said the incident aboard the plane "was a jihadist terrorist attack attempt, which was thwarted only thanks to the bravery of several Israeli passengers who broke into the cockpit and overpowered the terrorist".

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'CONDITIONAL RELAXATION'

### SC rules out total ban on fireworks for Deepavali

NEWS » PAGE 10

INDIA-EFTA DEAL

### *One plus one equals three*

*Partnership can deliver across sectors, writes Ambassador of Iceland*

EDITORIAL » PAGE 6



MAMMOTH CHASE

### Gill and Rohit shine as India seals series

SPORT » PAGE 15

## *Golden duo*


**Reaping it rich:** Compound archers Chikitha Taniparthi and Sahil Jadhav beat South Korea in a shoot-off to retain the mixed team title at the Asian Games on Wednesday. India won two more gold in the sport and one in shooting to boost its medal tally. R.V. MOORTHY (REPORT: PAGE 13)

# INDIA bloc to kick off campaign against CEC, SIR across country from tomorrow

**Sobhana K. Nair**
NEW DELHI

The Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance (INDIA) on Wednesday announced a nationwide campaign beginning Friday against the Election Commission (EC) and the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. The graded agitation plan includes protest marches at district headquarters, a march to the Election Commission, and a joint appeal to the Chief Justice of India for expedited hearings in cases related to the SIR and alleged electoral "malpractices".

The decisions were taken after a three-and-a-half-hour meeting attended by 33 leaders from 19 political parties. Independent MP and senior Supreme Court lawyer Kapil Sibal also participated.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said the leaders had agreed to fight together. "With unanimity, everyone vowed to fight together," he said at a press conference. While there was no direct reference to involving the Cockroach Janta Party, leaders agreed that the bloc should engage with civil society and secular parties outside the alliance.



**United voice:** Leaders of INDIA bloc parties address the media after a meeting in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Notable absentees at the meeting included the DMK, which has refused to share a stage with the Congress after the Tamil Nadu election.

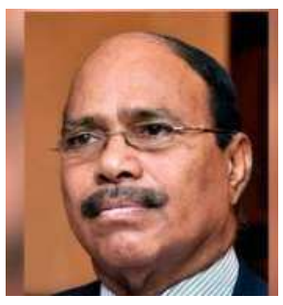
CONTINUED ON
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### Poll body extends SIR dates for A.P., Meghalaya

**NEW DELHI**
A full bench of the Election Commission convened on Wednesday, in what was the second such meeting in four days, and decided to extend the dates for publication of the final electoral rolls under the SIR in Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya. » PAGE 9

# Let SIT work in peace on Veeramani case: HC

**Mohamed Imranullah S.**
CHENNAI


R. Veeramani

Observing that a Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the child sexual abuse case involving R. Veeramani of Gem Granites must be allowed to work in peace, the Madras High Court on Wednesday adjourned by four weeks a petition filed by the DMK to inquire Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar, too, in connection with the case.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan took the decision after Advocate General Vijay Narayan pointed out that the DMK had not only filed the current petition but had also initiated a defamation suit against the two Ministers for reportedly alleging that the party shielded the accused during its tenure. He said Justice K. Govindarajan Thilakavadi had reserved orders on the DMK's plea seeking permission to file the suit.

CONTINUED ON
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# Southwest monsoon ends with 12% deficit, October rain also likely below normal: IMD

**Jacob Koshy**
NEW DELHI

India's 2026 southwest monsoon ended with 759.4 mm of rain, 12.6% below the 868.6-mm normal, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) said on Wednesday. At 87% of the Long Period Average (LPA), this is the lowest rainfall recorded during the monsoon since 2015, which was a tad drier at 758.2 mm.

The east and northeast region, which recorded 1,017.1 mm of rainfall, had its driest monsoon since 1901, or since the IMD started to keep systematic records.

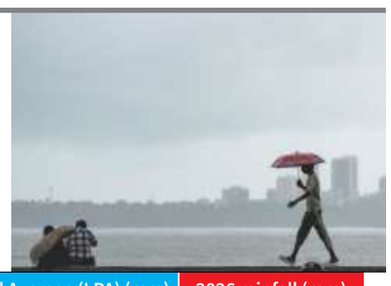
The subdued rainfall was in line with forecasts by global weather agencies, including the IMD, which anticipated one of the strongest El Ninos in recent history. The IMD had, since April, predicted a subdued monsoon rainfall and overall, reality corresponded to what was forecast. On April 13, for instance, it anticipated the June-September rain to be at 92% of LPA, with an error window of 5%. The May 29 update lowered that to 90% with a 4% error window. The IMD's final estimate sits within this range.

The southwest monsoon this year is in the process of withdrawal and is likely to completely exit within the first weeks of October, IMD Director-General M. Mohapatra said. The country will then see the advent of the northeast monsoon. With the El Nino still gaining strength, rainfall for the country in October is likely to be below 85% of the LPA of about 75.4 mm. Most regions are expected to get below-normal rain, except parts of northwest India, southern peninsular India, and isolated pockets of the east.

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**Driest in a decade**

With 759.4 mm of rain, 2026 recorded the lowest monsoon rainfall since 2015, which was a tad drier at 758.2mm



| 2026 | Long Period Average (LPA) (mm) | 2026 rainfall (mm) |
|---|---|---|
| June | 165.3 | 106.8 (65% of LPA) |
| July | 280.5 | 283.3 (101% of LPA) |
| August | 254.9 | 213.3 (84% of LPA) |
| Sept. | 167.9 | 155.1 (92% of LPA) |

SOURCE: IMD

# LeT 'commander' killed in J&K: Army

**Peerzada Ashiq**
SRINAGAR

A Pakistan-based Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) 'commander' active in the Pir Panjal Valley and south Kashmir was killed in an ongoing operation in Budgam district of Jammu and Kashmir, the Army said on Wednesday.

The body of the terrorist, identified as Mohammad Asif alias Hashim Moosa, was recovered along with "war-like stores" during a search in Palmaidan, the Army said, adding that the combing operation continued in the area.

Officials said the killing of Moosa is a breakthrough for the security forces, as he had remained active in central and south Kashmir for several years. They said Moosa coordinated many attacks in the region and was part of the larger LeT group active in the Kashmir Valley.


Security forces keep watch in Budgam district of Jammu and Kashmir on Wednesday. ANI

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 8
'FOUR KILLED SINCE 2022'
» PAGE 8

# Boy found dead at home in Koyambedu

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

Tarun, 9, was strangled to death at his home in Koyambedu on Tuesday evening. The police have launched a search for his mother's friend.

The police said his mother, T. Poovarasi, lived with him and Tamilselvan, 38, a labourer at Koyambedu market, after separating from her husband. Tamilselvan reportedly suspected Poovarasi of speaking with another man, leading to quarrels between them.

On Tuesday, Tamilselvan argued with some women at the Koyambedu bus terminus, and later with Poovarasi for not supporting him. He called her after returning home and threatened to kill her son. Soon afterwards, he called her again and claimed he had killed the boy.

Poovarasi rushed home to find Tarun lying dead in the bedroom with strangulation marks. Tamilselvan was missing.

The police recovered the body and sent it for a post-mortem.

# Govt. to soon sign MoU for CMRL's takeover of MRTS

The takeover must happen within 90 days of the MoU signing; the Metro Rail will have two years to complete the process, after which it can assume full charge of the MRTS to upgrade its stations

TRACK TALES

**Sunitha Sekar**
CHENNAI



**Station upgrade:** There has been a delay in signing the MoU, as a severance package must be finalised. However, talks are under way to arrive at the final amount soon. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

**The government plans to seek loans for executing the 'MRTS Rejuvenation' project that would require ₹6,600 cr.**

The State government plans to begin the Chennai Metro Rail's takeover of the Mass Rapid Transit System (MRTS) within three months.

A government order (G.O.) will soon be issued, after which a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) will be signed between the State government and Southern Railway in this regard.

Afterwards, a second G.O. will be issued, directing the Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) to take over the MRTS stations for upgrading them. Sources said these processes were likely to be completed by December this year.

While the government has been holding discussions and is keen to sign the MoU soon, there is a delay in signing the document, as a severance package must be finalised.

This package contains details of how much the State government has to pay Southern Railway with respect to assets such as land and other infrastructure. Talks are under way to arrive at the final amount soon.

### In-principle nod

The Railway Board issued the in-principle approval for the takeover only in July last year. After protracted discussions, the board gave the nod for the MoU in August this year.

The CMRL must take over the MRTS within 90 days of the signing of the MoU and will have two years to complete the process, after which it will assume full charge of the system.

Meanwhile, the State government wrote to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs two months ago to take up the 'MRTS Rejuvenation' project as a Central sector one, as it will require nearly ₹6,600 crore. It plans to seek loans for carrying out this project that aims at revamping the MRTS stations.

# Northeast monsoon likely to be normal in Tamil Nadu, says IMD

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The much-awaited Northeast (NE) monsoon, which accounts for a substantial share of the State's annual rainfall, is likely to be normal this year, according to India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The State may have to brace for above normal maximum and minimum temperatures in October, too. Conditions are favourable for the onset of NE monsoon from October third week, said IMD Director General Mrutyunjay Mohapatra during a virtual press briefing on Wednesday. The State usually receives an average of 44 cm during the NE monsoon.

While south and coastal areas are likely to receive normal to above normal rainfall, north interior districts are expected to receive below normal rain.

Many parts of the State may experience normal to above normal rainfall in October, except parts of north Tamil Nadu that may receive below average rainfall. The prevailing strong El Niño conditions may further strengthen till the year-end, and a neutral Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) may continue during Northeast monsoon as well. A positive IOD is usually considered favourable for NE monsoon.

### Deficient SW monsoon

The State has recorded a below average rainfall, with a deficit of 20% this Southwest monsoon. Many districts, including Thanjavur, Thoothukudi, and Chengalpattu, have recorded deficit above 35%.

Meanwhile, the Regional Meteorological Centre said that a north-south trough would trigger rainfall over the Western Ghats and interior districts till the weekend. V.R. Durai, Head, Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, attributed the simmering heat in interior districts partially to a strong El Niño. A reversal in wind patterns and more cloud cover would bring down temperatures.

**Timings**
**CHENNAI**

| | |
|---|---|
| **THURSDAY, OCT. 01** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:59 |
| RISE 21:47 | SET 10:11 |
| **FRIDAY, OCT. 02** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:59 |
| RISE 22:49 | SET 11:15 |
| **SATURDAY, OCT. 03** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:58 |
| RISE 23:53 | SET 12:17 |

| Chennai Weather | max | min |
|---|---|---|
| Tiruvallur | 36 | 23 |
| Chennai Airport | 37 | 28 |
| Chennai City | 37 | 28 |

**Chennai Airport Today**
**37°C** The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

**Chennai Airport Tomorrow**
**36°C** The weather will be very warm. Night will be comfortable. Chances of light to moderate rain and thundershower.

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# Declare govt. healthcare institutions as high-security zones: doctors' body

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Service Doctors and Post Graduates Association (SDPGA) has urged the State government to declare all government health institutions as "high-security zones", citing incidents of violence on hospital premises and the recent death of a police constable on duty at Paramakudi Government Hospital. The police constable had suffered injuries while attempting to stop two groups from fighting.

The association said the incident brought to light the unsafe conditions prevailing in the State's government healthcare institutions, including Primary Health Centres, government hospitals (GH), and medical college hospitals.

The SDPGA listed a number of incidents that occurred on the premises of hospitals recently. On September 21, a 35-year-old woman working in the Emergency Department of Ponneri GH was set on fire, while on duty, by an unidentified man. In another incident, a group of youth barged into Valparai GH and threatened women doctors on duty. While an FIR was filed in this case, no arrests were made.

The association also reminded the government about the stabbing of a senior oncologist at Kalaignar Centenary Super Specialty Hospital in 2024. Following the incident, the SDPGA conducted Statewide protests, demanding that government healthcare institutions be notified as high-security zones.

The government had then formed committees to improve/implement security arrangements in hospitals, but the recommendations still remain on paper, it said.

The association urged the Chief Minister to intervene and create a special police force to improve the security status of all government healthcare institutions, as more than 70% of the health workforce in the State were women.

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**PERSONAL**
**CHANGE OF NAME**

**I, JANAKI** NAGARAJAN, Residing at No. 4, 1st Street Arul Murugan Ramamurthy Nagar, Near Sri Chaitanya Mahaganapathy Temple, Chrompet have changed my name to JANAKI KALYANAM vide notarized affidavit dated 28/09/2026.

**I, PATEL** Shilpabahen Jayendrakumar d/o Jayendrakumar Chunilal Patel born on 17/06/1979 residing at Villa 221, Alliance Humming Garden, Near Mohana Hall, Thaiyur, Kelambakkam Post, Sub–district Chengalpattu, Kancheepuram district Tamilnadu, 603103, have changed my name to Patel Shilpa Nikhil vide affidavit dated 01st September 2026 at I.Arunkumar notary kelambakkam 603103

**PERSONAL**
**CHANGE OF NAME**

**I, Tiruvarur** Subbaiah Jawahar S/o. Subbiah born on 26.06.1964 at Mannargudi residing at # 11-20 Swamy Mada St., Tiruvarur 610 001, shall henceforth be known as JAWAHAR SUBBAIAH - Tiruvarur Subbaiah Jawahar

**I, BHOOMIT** DHIRAJ GALA, S/o Dhiraj Gala, Date of Birth 20/10/1993, residing at Palace Regency, Flat 7D, 80-93 Purasawalkam High Road, Kellys, Chennai – 600010, have changed my name from Bhoomit Dhiraj Gala to Bhoomit Gala and shall henceforth be known as Bhoomit Gala.

**PERSONAL**
**CHANGE OF NAME**

**I, PRIYANKA** Ravindra Kumble, w/o Ajit Rajiva, residing at No.84A, 3rd Cross Kamarajar Street, Near CGA Church, Bagayam, Vellore, Thorapadi, Vellore – 632002, Tamil Nadu, India, have corrected the spelling of my name from Priyanka Kumble to Priyanka Ravindra Kumble as wrongly recorded in my Passport, vide Affidavit dated 30/9/2026 sworn before Notary K. Vimalraj at Vellore.

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S.F. Nos. - Vaikkadu Village:
74/1, 74/2 pt (Por), 74/3, 74/4, 74/5A, 74/5B, 74/6, 74/7 pt, 75/1A, 75/1B, 75/1C, 75/1D, 75/2A, 75/2B, 75/3A, 75/3B, 75/4 (Por), 76/1 to 9, 77/1–4, 77/6 & 7, 77/5 (Por), 78/1 pt, 78/2 to 5, 78/6 (Por), 79/2 pt, 79/4 pt, 79/5 pt (Por), 85/1 (Por), 85/2A, 85/3, 86/1 (Por), 86/2A, 86/2D, 86/3 pt, 87/1A, 87/1B & 2, 88/1 to 7, 89/1, 89/3, 89/4 pt, 89/6 pt, 89/7, 89/8, 89/9, 89/10, 89/11 pt, 89/12 pt, 89/2 (Por), 92/1 (Por), 92/2 to 5, 93/1 to 7, 94/1, 94/3–13, 94/2 (Por), 94/14 (Por), 95/1, 95/3 to 8, 95/2 (Por), 96/1 Part, 96/2, 96/3A Part, 96/3B, 96/3C, 96/3D, 96/3E, 96/3F Part, 96/3H Part, 96/3I, 96/3J, 96/3K, 96/3L, 96/3M, 96/4A to 96/4K, 97/1 Part, 97/2 Part, 97/3 Part, 97/4 Part, 98/1–3 & 5–8, 98/4 (Por), 99/1–8, 99/9 pt, 99/11 pt, 99/12 pt.

This is to inform the public that State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA), Tamil Nadu has issued Environmental Clearance (EC) certificate to M/s. TOSHIBA JSW POWER SYSTEMS PRIVATE LIMITED, vide File No: 13087 & EC Identification No: EC25C3806TN5821797N, dated: 04.09.2026, Category -B2 for Development of Industrial Buildings at Chennai District over an extent of 3,60,170 Sq.m (89.0 acres) at above mentioned Survey Nos and address

The Environmental Clearance certificate issued by SEIAA, Tamil Nadu is available on the official website of SEIAA, TN (PARIVESH) and clearance is also available with the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TN-PCB), Chennai.

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**NEW / RENEWAL DEPOSITS with effect from 24-08-2026 Public Deposits**

**NON-CUMULATIVE**

| Period (Months) | General Category | | | Senior Citizen | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Monthly (%) p.a. | Quarterly (%) p.a. | Annually (%) p.a. | Monthly (%) p.a. | Quarterly (%) p.a. | Annually (%) p.a. |
| 24 | -- | 7.65 | -- | -- | 7.80 | -- |
| 36 | 7.75 | 7.75 | 7.98 | 7.95 | 7.95 | 8.19 |
| 48 | 7.85 | 7.85 | 8.08 | 8.20 | 8.20 | 8.46 |
| 60 | 8.00 | 8.00 | 8.24 | 8.50 | 8.50 | 8.77 |

Minimum deposit: Rs. 1,00,000/- and further deposits in multiple of Rs.1000/-

**CUMULATIVE**

| Period (Months) | General Category | | Senior Citizen | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Base rate per Annum (%) | Effective Yield (%) | Base rate per Annum (%) | Effective Yield (%) |
| 12 | 7.55 | 7.77 | 7.70 | 7.93 |
| 24 | 7.65 | 8.18 | 7.80 | 8.35 |
| 36 | 7.75 | 8.63 | 7.95 | 8.88 |
| 48 | 7.85 | 9.12 | 8.20 | 9.59 |
| 60 | 8.00 | 9.72 | 8.50 | 10.46 |

Minimum deposit: Rs. 1,00,000/- and further deposits in multiple of Re.1/-

**HIGHLIGHTS**

1. Remittances for deposits can be made in the prescribed format in complete shape along with Crossed Cheque / Core Banking Cheque / Demand Draft payable at Chennai in favour of Tamil Nadu Power Finance and Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd.,
2. The KYC needs to done by all depositors as per RBI Guidelines and the terms and conditions for acceptance of the deposits.
3. **Payment of Interest:**

| Interest Payment Option | Date of Interest Payment |
|---|---|
| Non-Cumulative -Monthly Interest option | First day of every Month |
| Non-Cumulative - Quarterly Interest option | 1st July, 1st October, 1st January and 31st March |
| Non-Cumulative - Yearly Interest option | 31st March |
| Cumulative Deposits (Quarterly rests) | On Maturity |

In case the above mentioned dates are Sunday / Bank Holiday / Government Holiday, then the interest shall be payable on immediate next working day.
The interest for the first broken period under Non – Cumulative Scheme will be paid in next month

4. Interest credited / paid will be subject to deduction of tax at source, as applicable.
5. Loan on deposits up to 70% of the deposit amount will be sanctioned after three months from the date of deposit.
6. Repayment of deposits are made through NEFT/RTGS.
7. Deposits can be renewed subject to the Company's terms and conditions for acceptance of deposits.
8. Interest rates are subject to change and the rate applicable will be the prevalent rate on the date of acceptance of deposit / renewal.
9. Deposits solicited by the Company are not insured.
10. Nomination facility is available.
11. The terms for premature withdrawal of deposit:
    **a.** Premature withdrawal of deposits within three months from the date of deposit will not be allowed. In case of death of a depositor, premature withdrawal within 3 months will be allowed.
    **b.** Interest for premature withdrawal of deposits after three months but before date of maturity will be regulated as follows:
    **c.** No interest will be paid on the deposits closed after three months but before expiry of six months.

| | |
|---|---|
| After six months from the date of deposit but before twelve months | Interest @ 3% per annum less than the rate applicable for 12 months deposit will be paid |
| After twelve months from the date of deposit but before twenty four months | Interest @ 2% per annum less than the rate applicable for 12 months deposit will be paid |
| After twenty four months from the date of deposit but before thirty six months | Interest@ 2% per annum less than the rate applicable for 24 months deposit will be paid. |
| After thirty six months from the date of deposit but before the date of maturity | Interest @ 2% per annum less than the rate applicable for 36 months deposit will be paid. |

    **d.** The request of premature closure should be signed by Primary Depositors and all Joint holders
    **e.** However, in order to meet certain expenses of an emergent nature and subject to the satisfaction of the Company and supported by documentary evidence, premature repayment of public deposits before the expiry of three months from the date of acceptance may be permitted as under:
    **i.** Emergent nature include medical emergency or expenses due to natural Calamities/disaster as notified by the concerned Government or authority:
    Up to 50% of the principal sum of the deposit amount or Rs.5 lakh, whichever is lower, may be prematurely repaid to individual depositors, without payment of interest. The remaining amount shall continue to be governed by the original terms of the contract.
    **ii.** In case of critical illness of the depositor, 100% of the principal sum of deposit amount may be prematurely repaid without payment of interest. Critical illness shall be guided by IRDAI (Health Insurance) Regulations, 2016 and guidelines issued thereunder, as amended from time to time.
12. Terms for Renewal of deposit:
    No Auto – Renewal and/or Auto Closure of Deposits. In the event of renewal of deposit received within 90 days from the date of maturity, the deposit will be renewed from the date of maturity at the interest rate, operating at the time of maturity. In case the renewal application received after 90 days from the date of maturity, the same will be treated as fresh deposit and the interest rate prevailing on the date of receipt of renewal application will be applicable. The rate of interest applicable for the overdue period ie. from the date of maturity to the receipt of renewal application, on the amount so placed as fresh deposit shall be 2% less than the rate of interest applicable for 12 months deposits either at the time of maturity or receipt of renewal application whichever is less.
13. The financial position of the Company as disclosed and the statements made in the application form are true and correct. The Company and its Board of Directors are responsible for the correctness and veracity thereof.
14. In case of non-repayment of the deposit or part thereof as per the terms and conditions of such deposit, the depositor may approach the Southern Region Bench of Company Law Board, Shastri Bhavan, "A" Wing, V Floor, Block 8, No.26, Haddows Road, Chennai - 600 006.
15. Any deposit which remain unclaimed and unpaid for a period of seven years from the date it became due for payment will be transferred to "The Investor Education and Protection Fund" established by the Government of India under Section 125 of the Companies Act, 2013.
16. In case of any deficiency of the Company in servicing its deposit, the depositor may approach the District Level Consumers' Disputes Redressal Forum, the State Level Consumers' Disputes Redressal Forum or the National Consumers Disputes Redressal Forum for relief.
17. The Company is having a valid certificate of Registration No.07.00389 dt.7.12.1998 issued by the Reserve Bank of India under Section 45 IA of the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.
    However, the Reserve Bank of India does not accept any responsibility or guarantee about the present position as to the financial soundness of the company or for the correctness of any of the statements or representations made or opinions expressed by the company and for repayment of deposits / discharge of liabilities by the company.
18. Deposit application forms containing detailed terms and conditions can be obtained from the Registered Office of the Corporation at No.490/3,4 Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai - 600035 and can be downloaded from the website **(www.tnpowerfinance.com).**
    Information required to be specified as per the provisions of RBI (Non-Banking Financial Companies - Acceptance of Public Deposits) Directions, 2025 and Non-Banking Financial Companies and Miscellaneous Non-Banking Companies (Advertisement) Rules, 1977 are given below:-

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| a. | Name of the Company | TamilNadu Power Finance and Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited |
| b. | Date of Incorporation | 27th June 1991 |
| c. | Business carried on by the Company and its subsidiaries with details of branches. | Hire Purchase, lease finance, term loan and other forms of financial assistance for those who are directly / indirectly engaged in generation, transmission and distribution of power and infrastructure development |
| d. | Brief particulars of Management | The Company is managed by the Chairman and Managing Director under the supervision of the Board. All the Directors are nominated by the Government of TamilNadu. |

**Date : 30.09.2026**
**Place: Chennai**

**e. Name, address and occupation of the Directors at present:**

| S. NO | NAME OF DIRECTOR | DESIGNATION | ADDRESS |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Thiru. Mangat Ram Sharma, IAS., | Additional Chief Secretary, Chairman and Managing Director, TN Power Finance Corporation | 490/3-4, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai - 35 |
| 2. | Thiru.Anil Meshram, IAS., | Principal Secretary to Government, Energy Department | Secretariat, Fort St. George, Chennai - 600 009. |
| 3. | Thirumati. Pooja Kulkarni, IAS., | Special Secretary to Government, CEO, Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Board (TNIDB) | 3rd Floor, CMDA Tower II, No.1, Gandhi Irwin Bridge Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 |
| 4. | Thiru.Nirmal Raj, IAS., | Secretary to Government, Transport Department | Secretariat, Fort St. George, Chennai - 600 009 |
| 5. | Thiru. C.A.Rishab, IAS., | Deputy Secretary to Government (Budget), Finance Department | Secretariat, Fort St. George, Chennai - 600 009 |
| 6. | Thiru. Dr.J.Sadakkadulla (Cessation on 27.07.2026) | Independent Director | Flat 3A, Jamals Shanthi 1, Seethammal Colony, 2nd Main Road, Alwarpet Chennai - 600018. |
| 7. | Thirumati. Chitra Nagappan | Independent Director | A- 1, Shoreham Apartments, No- 38, Fifth Avenue,Besant Nagar, Chennai - 600090. |

**f. Profit & Dividend:** **(Rs. in Lakhs)**

| Year Ended | Profit beforeTax | Profit after Tax | Dividend |
|---|---|---|---|
| 31/03/2024 | 37,244.64 | 28,911.53 | 16,000.00 |
| 31/03/2025 | 35,164.81 | 27,488.85 | 13,885.00 |
| 31/03/2026 | 70,474.74 | 48,656.28 | - |

**g. Summarized financial position of the Company:**
**STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION**
**Amount in Rs. Lakhs**

| Particulars | as on 31/03/2026 (Rs.in lakhs) (as per Ind AS) | as on 31/03/2025 (Rs.in lakhs) (as per Ind AS) |
|---|---|---|
| **ASSETS** | | |
| **Financial Assets** | | |
| Cash and cash equivalents | 5,92,406.93 | 5,74,894.73 |
| Bank balance other than Cash and cash equivalents | 21.00 | 20.05 |
| Loans | 48,28,022.14 | 47,36,527.33 |
| Investments | 10,85,136.36 | 5,36,023.44 |
| Other financial assets | 50.03 | 49.49 |
| **Non-financial Assets** | | |
| Current tax assets | 14,325.86 | 7,663.82 |
| Property, plant and equipment | 394.52 | 408.31 |
| Intangible Assets | 0.00 | 0.70 |
| Intangible Assets under Development | -- | -- |
| Other non-financial assets | 442.08 | 381.63 |
| **TOTAL ASSETS** | **65,20,798.94** | **58,55,969.50** |
| **LIABILITIES** | | |
| **Financial liabilities** | | |
| Deposits | 50,76,929.76 | 46,54,278.92 |
| Other financial liabilities | 5,95,504.98 | 4,23,294.41 |
| **Non-financial liabilities** | | |
| Deferred tax Liabilities (net) | 1,310.51 | 2,084.55 |
| Provisions | 194.45 | 259.68 |
| Other non-financial liabilities | 10,589.22 | 8,523.10 |
| **Total liabilities** | **56,84,528.91** | **50,88,440.65** |
| **Equity** | | |
| Equity share capital | 4,01,700.00 | 3,76,700.00 |
| Other equity | 4,34,570.03 | 3,90,828.85 |
| **Total equity** | 8,36,270.03 | 7,67,528.85 |
| **Total liabilities and equity** | **65,20,798.94** | **58,55,969.50** |

h. Net Owned Funds as on 31.03.2026 - Rs.8,45,790.69 Lakhs
i. Public Deposits as on 31.03.2026 - Rs.12,37,962.72 Lakhs
j. Contingent Liability:
Income Tax demanded under dispute Rs. 29,257.24 Lakhs
Service Tax demanded under dispute Rs.521.59 Lakhs
Stamp Duty under dispute Rs.111.00 lakhs

**k. The Company has no overdue deposits other than unclaimed deposits.**

1. The Company hereby declares:
    I) that the Company has complied with the provisions of the directions of the Reserve Bank of India applicable to it:
    ii) that the compliance with the direction does not imply that the repayment deposits is guaranteed by the Reserve Bank of India; and
    iii) ) that the deposits accepted by the Company are unsecured and rank pari passu with other unsecured liabilities.

**Sd/-**
**For and on behalf of the Board / Additional Chief Secretary / Chairman And Managing Director**

**DIPR / 834 / DISPLAY / 2026**

## INBRIEF



### 4,200 graduands receive degrees at M.G.R. University

A total of 4,200 undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral graduands received their degrees at the 36th Convocation of Dr. M.G.R. Educational and Research Institute on Wednesday. Rajendra Viswanath Arlekar, Governor of Tamil Nadu and Keralam, presented medals and degrees to students who secured first rank in their respective disciplines. A.C. Shanmugam, Chancellor, Dr. M.G.R. Educational and Research Institute, A.C.S. Arun Kumar, President of the Institute, and A. Ravikumar, Secretary, A.C.S. Medical College and Hospital, participated, according to a press release.

### Nurses stage hunger protest over temporary appointment

Nurses affiliated to the Tamil Nadu Nurses Empowerment Association observed a fast on Wednesday demanding that the State government withdraw its decision to appoint nurses in government hospitals on an 11-month temporary basis and nursing tutors on a contractual basis. About 250 nurses participated in the hunger protest organised in Chennai. They demanded that redeployment of nursing staff, a workforce reduction measure in government hospitals, should be stopped and the government should make all contractual nurses permanent as promised in the election manifesto. They also demanded that a Government Order providing regular timescale pay for 2,500 posts announced for regularisation in the Health Department's demand for grants should be issued.

# Kasimedu fishers to go on indefinite strike, ask govt. to retrieve captive boats in A.P.

The boats were caught in April 2026 and have been held captive for over 100 days, they claim; a community leader urges the State government to seek the Centre's intervention to free the boats

**Deepa H. Ramakrishnan**
CHENNAI



**Livelihood hit:** Community leader M.D. Dayalan said that the State government has not announced financial assistance to the boat owners, whose vessels have been held captive. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Fishermen at the Kasimedu fishing harbour have decided to go on an indefinite stop work and protest, demanding that the State government take steps to retrieve seven boats that are held captive in Andhra Pradesh for over a hundred days. The indefinite protest will begin in about ten days after boats that have gone on long voyages return to the harbour.

Manivannan, Chennai Visai Padagu Meenavar Nala Sangam, an association of fishing boats with larger horsepower, said that the decision was taken after a meeting of all boat owners, vendors, loaders, ice sellers, net menders, and other stakeholders involved in the fishing business at Kasimedu.

"The boats were caught in April just after the annual fishing ban was lifted. It was in response after boats belonging to Karaikal that had been held captive were quietly sneaked away. Boats from the Union Territory were seen fishing very close to the coast, spoiling the catch of artisanal crafts," said M.E. Raghupathi, also of the association.

Community leader M.D. Dayalan said that, till date, the State government has not announced financial assistance to the owners, who are all single boat owners. "Thousands of fishermen from Andhra Pradesh work as labourers on our boats, which is why boats from Tamil Nadu fish off their shores. We fish beyond the 5 nautical mile limit," he said. Nanjil Ravi, another community leader, said that the State government must seek the intervention of the Centre to free the boats. "Like the government has taken up the Cauvery River water issue, this one too must be pursued with the same seriousness as tiffs between Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu are not new. Even in Pulicat, fishing rights are an issue between the two States," he pointed out.

Other fishermen were of the opinion that the State government must stop the sale of fish from Andhra Pradesh at Chintadripet and Vanagaram fish markets.

Though almost every year, fishing boats from Kasimedu are detained by villages in Andhra Pradesh and let off after a ransom is paid, this time with opposition parties in that State raking up the issue, Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu has said that he would stand with the fishermen of his State, explained another boat owner.



**Easy access:** The FASTag cards would be scanned a little ahead of the plaza point and vehicles without the tags or with insufficient balance will be issued challans. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

# T.N.'s first booth-less toll system becomes operational at Paranur

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Paranur toll plaza on the Chennai - Tiruchi National Highway becomes the State's first booth-less facility and gets multi-lane free flow (MLFF) system. The plaza became operational from Wednesday night.

Sources in the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) said that vehicles with FASTag cards or exempt tags, including judges, district collectors, Members of Parliament, and Members of Legislative Assembly, will be able to zip through without any waiting time, as their tags would be scanned a little ahead of the plaza point.

Vehicles without the tags or with insufficient balance will be issued challans.

In place of the manned booths, tall gantries with RFID readers, radar scanners, audit surveillance cameras, and FASTag-automatic number plate recognition system have been installed.

**Reducing congestion**

The MLFF system would process vehicles faster, reducing traffic congestion and enhancing user experience.

The Paranur plaza witnesses around 46,500 vehicles a day.

The new system will be helpful, especially during the ensuing festive season that usually witnesses thousands of vehicles taking the road to the southern parts of the State.

# Health Dept. cautions candidates applying for temporary nursing posts

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Health Department on Wednesday advised candidates applying for the post of contractual staff nurses to be wary of intermediaries and not pay money to anyone promising appointments.

The District Health Society had recently invited applications for 4,724 posts of contractual/temporary staff nurses. In a post on social media, the Office of Health Minister, responding to an allegation that money was demanded for posting, said that the recruitment is being conducted in a transparent and merit-based manner.

"Candidates are requested to note that no payment or fee is required for selection or appointment. They are advised to exercise caution and not respond to any individual or intermediary who claims to influence the recruitment process in exchange for money or any other consideration," it said.

## CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

**MUSIC DANCE DRAMA**







**Kartik Fine Arts**
**24997788 / 9840928049**
Programmes for October 2026, 10th 6pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam by Vaishnavi 7.30pm Sahana Bharadwaj. 25th 6.15pm at TAG MFAC Hall Three Entertains presents 'Kaatrineley Varum Geetham'. 29th 6.45pm at TAG MFAC Hall Kala Mandir inaugurates 'Vaellvi' by Bombay Chanakya. 31st 6pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam by Mithila Sekar 7.30pm Salangai Narthanalya, Academy of Fine Arts, UK, presents 'PRAVAHAM' by Dr. Lata Surendra, Dr. Padmaja Suresh & Dr. Jeyanthy Yogharajah

**Naada Inbam, 24992672.**
Sri TRS Mani Memorial Concert. Kandadevi Brothers - Krishna Sai & Mukunda Sai, Bargava Vignesh, Sannath Parameshwaran, Karaikkal Jaikishan. Today 6.15pm at Ragasudha Hall.

**Papanasam Sivan Rasikar Sangam, Chennai**
**In association with Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Presents**
**SIVANISAI MUSIC FESTIVAL - 2026**
On the occasion of 53rd Memorial Day of Brahmasri Papanasam Sivan
Today at Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Mylapore 5.45 PM.
Chief Guest: Thiru P. Venkataramanan, Hon'ble Minister for Food and Civil Supplies, Govt.of Tamil Nadu.
Guests of Honour:
Thiru.K.N.Ramaswamy, Director, Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Kendra And Thiru.R.V.Shekar, Managing Director, Lancor Holdings Limited.
Presentation of "Sivanisai Selvar" Award to Vid.Sikkil Gurucharan followed by Vocal Concert by Vid.Sikkil Gurucharan with Vid. L.Ramakrishnan, Vid. B.Sivaraman, Vid. S.Krishna.
Master of Ceremony:Smt.Revathy Sankaran
Main Sponsor: Lancor Holdings Limited.
Co-Sponsors: COSMO, Kalpataru Doors and Plywood, Kone Elevators & Escalators, Mangal Tirth, Natraj & Venkat Architects and Roca.
All are welcome.

**Narada Gana Sabha**
**Ph: 24993201**
Programme for October 2026 - 2nd - Bharathanatyam - Dr.S.Ramanathan Endowment - Thamizh Programme - "Thirupugazh". Dancer - Karuna Sagari. Music - Bhavya Hari. 4th - 6.30 pm - Oothukadu Venkata Kavi day - Samanvi & Archana, C.S.Chinmayi , Aduthurai Guruprasad, Hari Kishore. 7th - Nadasangamam Concert - 5.30 pm - K Giridharan, G.Kailasapathy, Jayendrakumar, 7 pm - Hari Kishan, Sivateja Mallajosyula, Kaushik Sridhar. 11th - Mali Stage presents "Thoduvana Manidhargal" by Kudanthai Mali. Story - Indumathi. 17th - Natyarangam - Bharathanatyam -6 pm - Vaishnavi Dhore (Disciple of Rama Vaidyanathan). 7.30 pm - Sutanuka Bhadhury (Disciple of Girish Madhu), 18th - Sri P.S.Narayanaswamy Shraddhanjali Concert - B.U.Ganesh Prasad R.Raghul, B.Sivaraman, Sunil Kumar . 20th - Alathur Brother's Day - Guru Anjali - In association with Thirupoonthuruthy Sri Narayana Tirta Swamigal Trust - N.Ravikiran - Chitra Veena, Pathangi Brothers (Vocal support), Vittal Rangan, Thiruvaarur Bhakthavathsalam, Madipakkam Murali 25th - Vaggeyakara Bharatham - Musician - Sikkil C Gurucharan, Dancer - Indu Nidheesh & Nidheesh Kumar with their disciples.

**Rasika Ranjani Sabha Foundation**
(Estd.1929)
Mylapore, Chennai - 600 004.
Programme for the month of October - 2026
**Navarathri Nrtyotsava - 2026**
**9 DAYS of PURE CLASSICAL DANCE**
(19th, 20th, 21st, 24th, 26th, 27th, 28th, 29th, 30th)
Time: 5.00 to 8.30 p.m
22:10:2026 - 6:15 pm
Kōtīsvara Iyer birthday concert By Vivek Sadasivam & Party Vocal concert
23.10.2026 - Friday
05.00 pm RR Sabha Annual Awards - 2026
Ph. No: 86103 57987
*All Rasikas Are Welcome*

**Sri Thiagaraja Sangeetha Vidwath Samajam Mylapore**
Today Panchami. Abishegam. Pooja. 6.30 PM Vocal by A Shyamprakash, Pakala Ramdas - Violin, Calcutta J Venkatraman - Mridangam, Sankarram V - Khanjira. All are welcome. www.srithiagarajasamajam.org

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CRIS
Centre For Railway Information Systems
Chanakyapuri, New Delhi - 110021
**TENDER NOTICE**
**Centre for Railway Information Systems**
**Tender No:** 2026_CRIS_ELECT_20, dt. 01/10/2026; **Subject:** Supply, installation, testing and commissioning of Precision Air-Conditioning Units on buy-back basis, including associated civil works, for Data Centre Area 'D' at CRIS Office, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi - 110021, along with post-warranty Comprehensive Annual Maintenance for a period of four years. **Tender Closing Date:** 22/10/2026 (15:00 hrs.). Tender Documents can be downloaded from Website **www.ireps.gov.in**. For future modification/extensions please see **www.ireps.gov.in**.

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
**Tender Notice Date:26.09.2026**
**SIGNAL & TELECOMMUNICATION DEPARTMENT**
Sr.DSTE/CO/Kota for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites e-tenders against Tender No. KOTA/SNT/SIG/2025/27/R/1 Due date to open mentioned below in table. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Tender No.** KOTA/SNT/SIG/2025/27/R/1, **Name of work:** "Kota Divn : Enhancing the system redundancy by provision of Digital Axle Counters in parallel with Track circuits at stations yard on Main Line in Kota Mathura section." **Approx. cost of the work:** Rs. 45,19,32,232.48, **Bid Security value** : Rs. 90,38,700.00/-, **Last Date & Time of submission and opening of tender :** 15:00 Hrs. on Date 01.02.2027, The Tenders can be viewed at website www.ireps.gov.in. The tenderer/bidders must have class III Digital signature certificate & must be registered on IREPS portal. Only registered tenderer/bidders can participate in e-tendering. Also should have valid GSTIN. **Sd/-**
**Sr. DSTE/Co.**
**West Central Railway, Kota**
स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

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• Commerce • Economics
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• English Literature • English • Psychology • Clinical Psychology • Counselling Psychology • Media & Communication • Sociology • Political Science • Social Work
**SCHOOL OF BUSINESS & MANAGEMENT / INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT** • Management
**SCHOOL OF LAW:** • Law
**Important Dates**: Applications open: Oct. 1, 2026; Last Date: Nov. 25, 2026
Selection Process: Dec. 5, 2026; Programmes Start: Jan. 11, 2027
For more information:
Contact: Centre for Research & Development (CFRD)
Kristu Jayanti (Deemed to be University), Bengaluru-560077
Email: doctoral.research@kristujayanti.com | Mob: 9187962975
Apply Online @ www.kristujayanti.edu.in

**Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.**
**Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)**

| Specification No. | Tender Inviting Authority | Name of the Work |
|---|---|---|
| 02 | CE / Tirunelveli | Supply and Erection of 33 KV SS at Serakulam village of Tuticorin EDC |
| 03 | CE / D / Karur | Supply of 22 KV Standalone Structure material complete set |
| 05 | CE / D / Karur | Supply of 11 KV Standalone Structure material complete set |
| 09 | CE / Villupuram | Supply of 22 KV Polymer Composite Pin Insulators |
| 10 | CE / Villupuram | Supply of 11 KV 200 A Horizontal Type AB Switch with PT Insulators |
| 11 | CE / Villupuram | Supply of 22 KV 200 A Horizontal Type AB Switch with PT Insulators |
| 25 | SE / Chenglepet | 11 KV singlepole standalone complete set |
| Enq.No.10 | CE / Erode | Supply of 22 KV Polymer Composite Pin insulator |
| Enq.No.13 | CE / Erode | Supply of 22 KV Standalone structure material complete set |
| Enq.No.16 | CE / Erode | Construction of Control room - plinth and allied Civil works in Kodumanal 33 KV SS Erode EDC |
| Enq.No.17 | CE / Erode | Construction of Control room - plinth and allied Civil works in Kadambur 33 KV SS Gobi EDC |
| M.261 | CE / MM | 11 KV Polymer Composite DISC Insulators |
| C 1009 | Chief Engineer / Distribution / Kanchipuram | Laying of 33 KV 1 x 630 sqmm XLPE UG cable from Kadapperi 110 KV SS to Chitlapakkam 33 KVSS |
| C 1011 | Chief Engineer / Distribution / Kanchipuram | Laying of 33 KV UG cable from Porur SRMC 110 KV SS to Poonamallee MTC Depot EV station Reach I |
| C 1012 | Chief Engineer / Distribution / Kanchipuram | Laying of 33 KV UG cable from Porur SRMC 110 KV SS to Poonamallee MTC Depot EV station Reach II |
| C 1013 | Chief Engineer / Distribution / Kanchipuram | Laying of 33 KV UG cable from Porur SRMC 110 KV SS to Poonamallee MTC Depot EV station Reach III |
| C 1014 | Chief Engineer / Distribution / Kanchipuram | Laying of 33 KV UG cable from Porur SRMC 110 KV SS to Poonamallee MTC Depot EV station Reach IV |
| CE / D / TNJ / 002 SEMBIYAVARAMBAL | CE / D / THANJAVUR | Supply and Erection of SS equipments and construction works for Sembiyavarambal SS |
| CE / D / TNJ / 003 Poombukar | CE / D / THANJAVUR | Supply and Erection of SS equipments and construction works for Poombukar SS |
| CE / D / TNJ / 004 Thittai | CE / D / THANJAVUR | Supply and Erection of SS equipments and construction works for Thittai SS |
| CE / D / TNJ / 005 Panthanallur | CE / D / THANJAVUR | Supply and Erection of SS equipments and construction works for Panthanallur SS |
| CE / D / TNJ / 006 Uthukadu | CE / D / THANJAVUR | Supply and Erection of SS equipments and construction works for Uthukadu SS |

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites **www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in**
**DIPR/2999/Tender/2026**

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File No. HO/P&C/EST/E-3051/01/2026 28487 Dt.25.09.2026
**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (P&C), IDCO, IDCO TOWER, BHUBANESWAR**
**Bid Identification No.P&C/EST/E-29/2026-27**
**NOTICE INVITING TENDER UNDER NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement**
**Name of the Work : "Construction of 3 no.s BT road at EMC Park, Info valley-II, Bhubaneswar, Khordha"**
**1. Value of the Work : Rs.423.85 Lakhs (Approx.)**
**2. Period of completion : 04 (Four) Calendar Months**
**Other Details :**

| Procurement Officer | Bid Identification No. | Availability of Tender On-Line for Bidding | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCO, IDCO Towers, Bhubaneswar-751022 | Bid ID No.:- P&C/EST/E-29/2026-27 | 17:00 Hours of dt. 30.09.2026 | 17:00 Hours of dt. 14.10.2026 |

Tender details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: **www.tendersorissa.gov.in.** Corrigendum or Addendum if any will not be published in newspapers and can be seen in **e-procurement portal** as well as in **IDCO website.**
**Sd/- Chief General Manager (P&C), IDCO, Bhubaneswar**
4001/339/2627 OIPR-4001/4075/1/26-27/0122

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**KERALA STATE COUNCIL FOR SCIENCE, TECHNOLOGY AND ENVIRONMENT (KSCSTE)**
Sasthrabhavan, Pattom, Thiruvananthapuram - 695004,
Phone : 0471 - 2548316, Website: www.kscste.kerala.gov.in
**NOTIFICATION**
**The KSCSTE is seeking qualified candidates for the post of Director, KSCSTE-JNTBGRI**
For details log on to **www.kscste.kerala.gov.in.**
Last date for the receipt of application is **22.10.2026, 5.00 p.m**
D3/571/2026 EXECUTIVE VICE PRESIDENT

**E-AUCTION NOTICE**
**E-Auction notice no: LEASE-KGP-26-15 & 16 Date: 29.09.2026**
For and on behalf of the President, Union of India, the Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Kharagpur Division, South Eastern Railway invites e-Auction for leasing of SLRs/LVPH for a period of 03 (Three) years for transportation of parcels in the trains which are notified in the **https://www.ireps.gov.in/website. Sl. No.; Category; Catalogue No.; Date of e-Auction; Auction Start Time** and **Auction Closing Time** are as under : ● **1;** Parcel; LEASE-KGP-26-15; 13.10.2026; 11:00 hrs.; 15.30 hrs. ● **2;** Parcel; LEASE-KGP-26-16; 14.10.2026; 12:00 hrs.; 12.40 hrs. Interested parties and contractors to take note of this and go through the website as mentioned above for details of the trains and related infonnation about the E-Auction notice. For enquiries/ clarifications if any, please contact the office of the undersigned.
(PR-833) **Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager, Kharagpur**
**South Eastern Railway**
We serve with a smile

**GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA**
**EDUCATION DEPARTMENT**
No.EDN.124/2026/29 Dated Shillong, the 30th September, 2026
**PUBLIC NOTICE**
**Conduct of examinations and academic progression of existing enrolled students of CMJ University, Meghalaya**
With reference to the UGC letter D.O.No.8-21/2010(CPP-I/PU)/78587, dated 02-09-2026, the office of the Administrator, under the Government of Meghalaya, is directed to inform all students of CMJ University as follows:-"All students presently studying Diploma, Undergraduate and Postgraduate programmes at the University may be allowed to appear in examinations conducted under the supervision of an external agency/ third party, under the overall responsibility of the State Education Department."
Therefore, students are required to complete the form to submit their personal details for the examination using the QR code provided. Failure to submit the details will hinder the examination process, as these details are needed to arrange examinations with third-party institutions. The form link will remain active to accept responses until 01-11-2026.
**Link - https://forms.gle/3aMvMVWX2DxnNSzv5**
MIPR No. : 1769
Dated : 30-09-2026
**Sd/-**
**Administrator of CMJ University, Meghalaya & Joint Secretary to the Govt. of Meghalaya Education Department**

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From Page One

## Let SIT work in peace on Veeramani case: HC

When the judge said a sensitive issue such as child sexual abuse should not be politicised, senior counsel J. Ravindran replied that it was exactly the stand of DMK too.

He said the political party was also highly interested in getting the perpetrators of the crime punished and delivering justice to the child victims. However, it was being falsely accused of having shielded the offenders, he complained.

In its present petition, the DMK had insisted that the SIT should act upon its September 27, 2026 representation to summon the Chief Minister and the two Ministers for inquiry and find out if they had any material in their possession to prove the charges levelled against it. In the defamation suit, it had sought damages of ₹1 crore from the two Ministers for having levelled false accusations against it.

The suit was filed along with an application seeking the leave of the court to institute it in Chennai, though multinational corporations X Corp, Meta Platforms, and YouTube were located outside its territorial jurisdiction.

In the suit, the party had sought a direction to the social media giants to take down the false and defamatory posts, and hence, they too had been included as defendants.

Opposing the application to grant leave, the two Ministers told the court that the DMK had failed to issue prior notices to them as required under Section 80(1) of the Code of Civil Procedure, despite having made them defendants in their official capacity as Ministers, and hence, the suit itself was not maintainable in law.

# CM positions TVK as an organic successor to AIADMK; justifies candidate switching sides

Vijay addresses bypoll campaign meeting in Dharapuram; extols the leadership acumen of late Chief Ministers Jayalalithaa and M.G. Ramachandran in handling arch-rival DMK; condemns AIADMK's 'brazen' attempt at negating the legacies of the iconic leaders by contemplating a tie-up with DMK

**R. Krishnamoorthy**
DHARAPURAM

Chief Minister and TVK president C. Joseph Vijay on Wednesday made no bones about his keenness to position his party as an organic successor of the AIADMK, as he extolled the leadership acumen of late Chief Ministers Jayalalithaa and M.G. Ramachandran in handling arch-rival DMK umpteen times.

"The present AIADMK leadership's brazen attempt at negating the legacies of the iconic leaders by contemplating a tie-up even with its arch-rival for government formation was what spurred TVK candidate Sathyabama into exiting the Dravidian party she had served for decades," he claimed.

Speaking at a byelection campaign meeting in Dharapuram (Reserved) constituency, where Ms. Sathyabama has been fielded, he sought to counter the charge of the Opposition parties that she had been bought. In May, she was elected from the constituency on an AIADMK ticket. Thereafter, she resigned her Assembly membership and joined the TVK.

Earlier, the Chief Minister consoled Ms. Sathyabama when she broke down on the stage, claiming she was being abused for switching parties. She claimed that her decision to leave the AIADMK was not due to dislike of the party, but because of the mentality of AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami.

"It has been two months since I logged out of social media. The obscene taunts unleashed on me are painful. I entered politics inspired by *Amma* Jayalalithaa. Had I done anything wrong, I would not have come to seek votes with my head held high," Ms. Sathyabama said.



**Emotional moment:** The Chief Minister consoles TVK candidate Sathyabama, who broke down on the stage, claiming she was being abused for switching from AIADMK to TVK. S. SIVA SARAVANAN

Justifying her decision to join the TVK, she also thanked Mr. Palaniswami, alleging that if not for his bid to cosy up with the DMK, she would have remained in the party.

In his speech, Mr. Vijay said that due to the "DMK nexus", the AIADMK general secretary had lost his moral standing for the party leadership. He wondered why Mr. Palaniswami was agitated when he (Mr Vijay) talked about the references to the DMK's corruption in the Sarkaria Commission report.

The TVK regime was following the tenets of the late Annadurai by providing opportunities to the poor to become MLAs and Ministers. On the other hand, the DMK leadership was still fixated on family hegemony. The TVK was now the only party in a position to take on the 'evil' DMK, Mr. Vijay said.

Referring to DMK president M.K. Stalin's expression of gratitude to the voters of Kolathur for not electing him, Mr. Vijay said in jest that the party would eventually face the ignominy in all constituencies.

Describing what he construed as the tacit understanding between the DMK and the AIADMK as a 'benami alliance', Mr. Vijay said their destabilising machinations will never materialise, "now that every family in Tamil Nadu has begun treating me like a member".

"The more the Opposition disrespects me, the higher would be the esteem the people hold me in," he said.

Listing the TVK regime's achievements over the past four months, the Chief Minister gave an assurance that it will implement long-pending projects for irrigation, drinking water supply and infrastructure requirements of the Dharapuram constituency in earnest.

Getting into an interactive mode and joining the large gathering in blowing the whistle (the party symbol), Mr. Vijay sought their commitment to reject the "lies" of the Opposition and to cast their votes for the TVK candidate.

## VCK leader demands resignation, arrest of CEC

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

VCK founder and Chidambaram MP Thol. Thirumavalavan on Wednesday urged the leaders of the INDIA bloc to press eight demands, including the reinstatement of the 13 crore voters deleted from the electoral rolls, the suspension of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise, making public the social composition of the voters whose names had been deleted, the resignation and arrest of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and the withdrawal of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, besides holding a national-level agitation.

In his speech in New Delhi, Mr. Thirumavalavan said the recent revelations on the objections raised by two Election Commissioners about the legality of the SIR process had created a "constitutional crisis".

"The deletion of crores of voters from the electoral rolls raises serious questions about the validity of elections conducted in several States and Union Territories," he said.

# T.N. police don't have a crystal ball or magic wand to solve cases in a jiffy: HC

**Mohamed Imranullah S.**
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu police do not have a crystal ball or a magic wand to solve even sensitive cases such as the child sexual abuse case filed against R. Veeramani of Gem Granites within four days of the formation of a Special Investigation Team (SIT), the Madras High Court said on Wednesday.



**Casting doubt:** The petitioner apprehended that the State police might not probe the POCSO Act case against Veeramani properly.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan made the observation in an interim order passed on a writ petition filed by R. Varaaki, seeking a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) into the case filed under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012. The petitioner had apprehended that the State police might not probe the case properly.

When the judge wanted to know the basis for such an apprehension, the petitioner's counsel replied that the Tamil Nadu government had recently kept two Indian Police Service (IPS) officers on compulsory wait following complaints of their having attempted to cover up the crime during the previous regime. Immediately, the judge retorted: "Then, it means the government is taking action."

He went on to say: "It is a very sensitive matter. You people are not realising that this is not an area to play politics. I am concerned more about the children. You are not serious about what happened at all. There are other cases in which you can gain publicity. Please don't interfere in this case. A lot of children belonging to the Scheduled Castes are the victims in this case."

However, the petitioner's counsel replied that the cause of concern was the suspected involvement of some senior IPS officers in hushing up the crime in the past. Justice Lakshminarayanan said the SIT would have to necessarily investigate that angle too, and the petitioner or any other person in possession of information regarding the case could share it with the team.

On the counsel's insistence that an independent agency probes the case because it involves allegations of a cover up against serving IPS officers, the judge said: "Then, lets transfer it to the FBI (Federal Bureau of Investigation). They are totally independent. They have nothing to do with India at all. The CBI too has IPS officers. Where do they come from?"

Later, the judge directed State Public Prosecutor R. John Sathyan, assisted by Additional Public Prosecutor Arun Anbumani, to ensure that confidentiality is maintained with respect to all those who share information with the SIT in connection with the POCSO Act case, and file a status report before the court on the investigation conducted so far by October 7.

He recorded the submission of the writ petitioner that he too would appear before the SIT on October 1 and share all the information available with him with respect to the case.

### BJP seeks CBI probe

BJP spokesperson Narayanan Thirupathy on Wednesday said the Tamil Nadu government should transfer the probe into the sexual assault case to the CBI.

In a social media post, he said one of the officers in the Special Investigation Team handling the case, Deputy Commissioner Geethanjali, had requested permission to recuse herself from it, citing her prior involvement in the earlier probe, conducted under the supervision of the then Chennai Police Commissioner A. Arun, during her tenure with the Central Crime Branch.

"Given the possibility that various high-ranking police officials may have played a role in diluting or prematurely concluding the case, it would be proper and fair for the investigation to be handed over to the CBI," Mr. Thirupathy said.

# 'Stealing' of candidates by 'clean' force caused bypolls: Kanimozhi

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

DMK parliamentary party leader Kanimozhi on Wednesday alleged that the byelections to the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies had been necessitated by the "stealing of candidates" by those [TVK] who had proclaimed themselves to be a "clean force".

"By its actions, the 'clean' force has become a 'stealing' force," she said, while campaigning for party candidate I. Paranthamen in the Madurantakam.

### 'Appropriating' MLAs

Ms. Kanimozhi said the TVK should have stopped at forming the government after "appropriating" MLAs of political parties that were part of the DMK alliance.

"But it has stolen people's representatives and caused a byelection," she said, in an apparent reference to the resignation of AIADMK MLAs, who later joined the TVK and have entered the fray on its ticket now.

Ms. Kanimozhi said DMK president M.K. Stalin had fielded Mr. Paranthamen, who would fight for and defend the Dravidian ideology and, more importantly, remain with the party after his election and not resort to defection.



> You took pity on the candidate and voted for her in the election. But she defected to the ruling party. If you vote for the AIADMK again, there may be another byelection
>
> **KANIMOZHI**
> DMK parliamentary party leader

"You took pity on the candidate and voted for her in the election. But she defected to the ruling party. If you vote for the AIADMK again, there may be another byelection," she said.

She added that even "oppressive measures" and arrests could not force DMK leaders to switch sides.

Ms. Kanimozhi said she would prefer to address Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay as "Sweet Bro".

"There is a case against him for instigating children to persuade their parents to vote for him. The Chief Minister, who campaigned among children, sought to cover up the death of a girl in Vandalur as it would have affected his campaign in Madurantakam," the DMK leader alleged.

She claimed that another girl had also been sexually assaulted, and that the Chief Minister had not spoken about the incident. "But our leader Stalin spoke to the parents of the girl and promised all possible help," Ms. Kanimozhi said.

### Crime statistics

Ms. Kanimozhi said that though the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) had described Tamil Nadu as a safe State for women, it had witnessed 500 crimes, including 300 sexual assaults against women and children, 200 murders, eight custodial deaths and 10 honour killings in the four months since the TVK came to power.

# HC directs DVAC to submit report on inspections conducted in past 5 years

**The Hindu Bureau**
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court has directed the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC) to file a report on the surprise inspections/raids it had conducted in the past five years.

Justice B. Pugalendhi sought details of the quantum of amount recovered during such inspections, the number of prosecutions initiated pursuant to the inspections and their status and, if any disciplinary proceedings were recommended instead of prosecutions, the details of the same and their status.

The court posted the matter to October 1 for hearing. It said it expected the views of the government on issuance of uniform guidelines or a G.O. prescribing the maximum amount a government employee could possess while on duty.



**Gathering opinions:** The court sought the views of the government on issuance of uniform guidelines or G.O. prescribing the maximum amount a government employee could possess while on duty.

Earlier, while hearing a batch of petitions, the court said it appeared that there was no common guideline or G.O. covering all government employees in the State. Therefore, the issue required consideration at the government level.

**The court said it appeared that there was no common guideline or G.O. covering all govt. employees in T.N.**

"In the present day, when almost every payment can be made through digital modes, the necessity of carrying substantial amounts of cash to office requires to be addressed by the government by fixing an appropriate threshold limit. If such a condition is prescribed, it may, to some extent, curb corruption in government offices," the court said.

At the same time, the existence of a prescribed limit would also ensure that government employees are not unnecessarily harassed. The government has the objective of eradicating corruption, and a guideline framed in this regard may strengthen its objective of achieving corruption-free governance, the court said.

# Sivakasi fireworks industry upbeat as SC conditionally permits joined green crackers

**S. Sundar**
SIVAKASI

Fireworks manufacturers in Sivakasi are jubilant over the Supreme Court passing an order conditionally permitting them to manufacture next-generation joined green crackers.

"This is a significant milestone for the fireworks industry and a great day for all stakeholders," said P. Ganesan, an office-bearer of the Tamil Nadu Fireworks and Amorces Manufacturers' Association (TANFAMA), Sivakasi. The Supreme Court had laid down a few conditions for making chorsa, and the details of those conditions were awaited, he said.

"The basic condition is that joined crackers should be made using only green crackers," he added.



**Long battle:** The industry had been fighting it out legally in the Supreme Court since 2018, seeking to lift the ban on chorsa.

The industry had been fighting it out legally in the Supreme Court since 2018, seeking to lift the ban on chorsa, one of the most popular products in the fireworks industry. Major manufacturers' bodies such as TANFAMA and The Indian Fireworks Manufacturers' Association (TIFMA) had impleaded themselves in the case.

### Significant impact

TIFMA general secretary T. Kannan said the Supreme Court order lifting the ban on chorsa would have a significant impact on the future of the industry, as joined crackers formed 20% of the total production of fireworks goods.

With the ban on chorsa, many manufacturers, big and small, rushed to make aerial crackers that required a lot of expertise, and it led to more accidents, he said. "Now, the industry can relax a bit, and many could resume making chorsa, which has a good market," he added.

"This is one of the most affordable products in the fireworks industry, and people from all economic strata could buy it," Mr. Ganesan said.

According to the manufacturers, though they could try to make available joined crackers of various sizes and numbers during the upcoming Deepavali, mass production could be possible only for the next festival season.

# One dead and 12 injured in explosion at MRPL unit

Rupture of the cold separator operating at high pressure in the unit resulted in a fire, says firm; loud explosion heard and window panes of nearby buildings were shattered due to blast impact

The Hindu Bureau
MANGALURU

One person died, and 12 others were injured following a blast in the Coker Hydrotreater Unit of the Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd. (MRPL) on the outskirts of Mangaluru on Wednesday. Among the 12, one person sustained burn injuries while the others had minor injuries.

A loud explosion was heard from the premises around noon, following which fire broke out and thick smoke was seen emanating from the refinery. Window panes of nearby buildings shattered due to the impact of the blast.

The MRPL said in a statement that rupture of the cold separator operating at high pressure in the unit resulted in a fire at about 12.20 p.m. The battery limits of the affected unit were immediately isolated and the MRPL's emergency response and firefighting teams were deployed to control the situation. The fire was completely extinguished by 2.47 p.m., it said. "During the subsequent combing and inspection operations following the firefighting activity, the body of one deceased person was found at the affected site," the statement said.



**Loud explosion:** Smoke erupting after the blast at the MRPL unit in Karnataka on Wednesday. PTI

Police Commissioner Sudheer Kumar Reddy said that the deceased, Manish Karkada (30) from Mulky, was working on contract basis at the site. "His body was found in a charred condition," the Commissioner said.

Another injured, identified as Rajesh Baptist, sustained 35% burn injuries and was shifted to a hospital for treatment. According to the doctors, he is out of danger and was being treated in the ICU. Eleven others, working in an office adjacent to the unit, sustained minor injuries. They were treated in the OPD, he said.

Buildings in and around Jokatte, including the gram panchayat building, witnessed tremors and window panes shattered because of the blast.

People in Angaragundi, Baikampady, Kulai and surrounding areas too experienced the tremors.

# SIR: filled Form-7s targeting Muslims surface in Belagavi

Rishita Khanna
BENGALURU

**ERO Udayakumar Basavantappa Talawar says someone falsely used his name**

"For at least the last 15 years, I have been the Booth Level Agent here at polling station 196 in Belagavi North Assembly constituency. But last week, when I saw at least 380 Form-7 applications at the school, I was shocked to find my name and my brother's, along with those of our relatives and neighbours, sought to be deleted," said Meersab Sanadi, BLA at Veerabhadra Urdu Model School in Belagavi's 7th Cross, where he is also the chairman.

The incident, in which "already printed" bulk Form-7 applications seeking deletion of Muslim names were received by Booth Level Officers (BLOs), was reported in at least six polling stations in Belagavi North Assembly constituency – four in Veerabhadra Nagar (polling parts 194, 195, 196 and 199) and two in the Government Kannada Higher Primary School in Shettigali (polling parts 209 and 210).

BLOs at these stations told *The Hindu* that two men, claiming to be from the Belagavi City Corporation, brought a bulk of Form-7 applications seeking deletion of only Muslim names. The voters' names and other details were prefilled, while the objectors' names were either handwritten or left blank.

The men allegedly repeatedly told the BLOs that the applications had to be signed and returned urgently. The BLOs, however, refused, saying they knew the electors whose names appeared on the forms as that they had been living in the area for years. When the BLOs continued to refuse, the men allegedly called someone over the phone who posed as Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) Udayakumar Basavantappa Talawar and instructed them to sign the applications.

ERO Mr. Talawar told *The Hindu* that someone had falsely used his name and that he had not issued any such instructions.

Under pressure, some BLOs said they signed the forms, while others said they tried to contact their supervisors and the Assistant Electoral Registration Officer, but could not reach them.

Meanwhile, the trend of seeking deletions of Muslim voters' names continued in Bhalki even after the claims and objections period ended on September 23, with people who had filed Form-7 applications in bulk before the deadline continuing to file applications. Applications filed after the claims and objections period will be taken up only after the final electoral roll is published.

# Security tightened for Keralam CM

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Security arrangements for Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan have been tightened in light of the continuing protests, primarily by Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) workers.

More police personnel, including uniformed and plainclothes officers, were deployed at venues where the Chief Minister participated in official programmes on Wednesday.

Police personnel were positioned along routes used by the Chief Minister and Ministers. Particular attention was given to roads along the route from Cliff House, the official residence of the Chief Minister.

Nonetheless, Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha activists staged black-flag protests against Mr. Satheesan during the wee hours of the day shortly after his arrival from New Delhi, and later in the evening.

**Convoy disrupted**

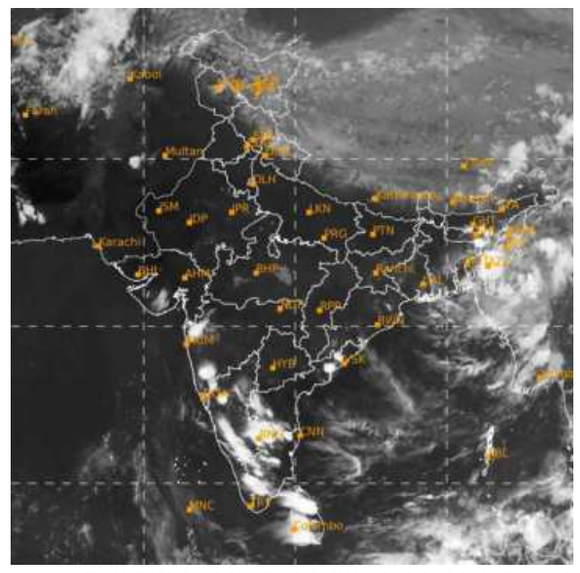
In both instances, the protesters attempted to disrupt the convoy and raised slogans while displaying black flags. But, the convoy proceeded without stopping.

The decision to strengthen security was taken after a series of demonstrations targeting the Chief Minister and Ministers by BJP workers allegedly in retaliation to protests by Youth Congress activists during Union Minister Amit Shah's visit to Kollam.

The convoys of various Ministers, including Sports and Youth Affairs Minister O.J. Janeesh, were obstructed a day ago.

## WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

**Forecast for Thursday:** Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Rayalaseema

| CITY | RAIN | MAX | MIN | CITY | RAIN | MAX | MIN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Agartala | — | 33.6 | 26.0 | Kurnool | — | 37.9 | 26.6 |
| Ahmedabad | — | 34.8 | 22.6 | Lucknow | — | 32.2 | 23.2 |
| Aizawl | 2 | 31.5 | 23.2 | Madurai | — | 38.4 | 27.1 |
| Bengaluru | 15 | 30.1 | 19.8 | Mangaluru | — | 32.0 | 24.8 |
| Bhopal | — | 33.7 | 19.7 | Mumbai | 31 | 32.5 | 24.4 |
| Bhubaneswar | — | 34.5 | 25.5 | Mysuru | — | 33.2 | 21.0 |
| Chandigarh | — | 33.6 | 21.0 | New Delhi | — | 34.2 | 22.4 |
| Chennai | — | 37.2 | 28.9 | Patna | — | 32.0 | 26.2 |
| Coimbatore | — | 35.4 | 24.0 | Port Blair | — | 31.5 | 25.5 |
| Dehradun | — | 32.0 | 19.8 | Prayagraj | — | 33.4 | 24.0 |
| Gangtok | — | 25.5 | 16.9 | Puducherry | — | 34.6 | 27.8 |
| Goa | — | 32.0 | 25.8 | Pune | 8.6 | 30.6 | 23.0 |
| Guwahati | — | 35.4 | 26.6 | Raipur | — | 33.7 | 24.9 |
| Hubballi | — | 31.0 | 22.0 | Ranchi | — | 29.6 | 20.0 |
| Hyderabad | — | 34.2 | 22.6 | Shillong | — | 25.8 | 17.2 |
| Imphal | — | 29.5 | 22.0 | Shimla | — | 26.0 | 15.8 |
| Jaipur | — | 35.4 | 24.2 | Srinagar | — | 27.9 | 10.9 |
| Kochi | — | 31.8 | 26.6 | Thiruvananthapuram | — | 34.0 | 24.9 |
| Kohima | — | 20.8 | 19.2 | Tiruchirappalli | — | 38.3 | 27.0 |
| Kolkata | — | 34.0 | 27.8 | Vijayawada | — | 35.9 | 26.2 |
| Kozhikode | — | 35.5 | 26.5 | Visakhapatnam | — | 33.5 | 27.8 |

*(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)*

**Pollutants in the air you are breathing**

| CITIES | $SO_2$ | $NO_2$ | CO | PM2.5 | PM10 | CODE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ahmedabad | .10 | .27 | 19 | 130 | 106 | |
| Bengaluru | .15 | .24 | .— | 32 | 119 | |
| Chennai | .7 | .10 | 22 | 115 | 101 | |
| Delhi | .10 | 133 | 87 | 113 | 197 | |
| Hyderabad | .1 | .3 | 17 | 147 | 135 | |
| Kolkata | .9 | .50 | 37 | 192 | 132 | |
| Lucknow | .23 | .32 | 14 | 74 | .73 | |
| Mumbai | .4 | .33 | 49 | 108 | 122 | |
| Pune | .14 | .66 | 75 | 63 | 131 | |
| Visakhapatnam | .8 | .63 | 17 | 111 | 145 | |

**Yesterday**

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Palwal, Haryana recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 259 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Madikeri, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 21

**Air Quality Code:** Poor | Moderate | Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

**$SO_2$:** Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

**$NO_2$:** Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

**CO:** Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

**PM2.5 & PM10:** Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

**ANDHRA PRADESH CAPITAL REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY**
**Project office, Rayapudi (V), Thullur (M), Amaravati-522237, A.P.**

**E PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE**
**NIT No.38/MAU61-USI0HB(OTH)/206/2026-CEAG -part (1) Dt. 30.09.2026**

**Name of Work: APCRDA-**Housing & Buildings -District Cooling Plant RFP for "Development of District Cooling System for Business Entities along Seed Access Road in Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh under Public Private Partnership (PPP) Basis".The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **06.10.2026 to 20.11.2026 up to 14.00** Hrs. Due date for submission of Bid **20.11.2026 up to 15.00 Hrs,** Technical bid opening **20.11.2026 @16.00Hrs.** For further details please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **https://crda.ap.gov.in**

**Sd/- COMMISSIONER, APCRDA, AMARAVATI**

**UJVN LIMITED**
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 893 **Date Extension Notice-06** Date: 30/09/2026

Due to unavoidable circumstances, due dates in respect of online Bid Identification No.T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27 are revised as follows:
**Last Date /Time of Receipt of bid on the portal:**14-10-2026upto 16:00 Hrs.
**Last Date /Time of submissionof bid in Office** :16-10-2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
**Date of opening of the bid on website** :16-10-2026from 13:00 Hrs.
All other details and terms & conditions shall remain same. Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancelation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal **http://uktenders.gov.in.**

**Executive Engineer (Solar)**

**"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"**

**Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd**
**Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)**

| Specification No. | Tender Inviting Authority | Name of the Work |
|---|---|---|
| 224 | CE / Coal | Service As Charterer Agent for Agency Work at Load Ports of PARADIP VIZG GANGAVARAM |
| 120 | SE / Civil Maint / TTPS | Supply of potable water to Power House Site at GLR 1 for Units 1 to 3 at TTPS |
| 121 | SE / Civil Maint / TTPS | Supply of potable water to Power House Site at GLR 1 for Units 4 to 5 at TTPS |
| 122 | SE / Civil Maint / TTPS | Supply of potable water to Power House Site at GLR 1 for DM Plant 1 and 2 at TTPS |
| 123 | SE / Civil Maint / TTPS | Supply of potable water to Power House Site at GLR 1 for Coal Handling area at TTPS |
| 124 | SE / Civil Maint / TTPS | Supply of potable water to Power House Site at GLR 1 for Residential Camps including IB at TTPS |

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: **www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in, www.tenders.tn.gov.in**

**DIPR/3001/Tender/2026**

**GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA**
**HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE DEPARTMENT**

No. HEALTH/MC/2026-27 Dated: 1st October, 2026

**Request for Proposal (RFP)**

Department of Health & Family Welfare, Government of Meghalaya invites RFP for the following partnership:

**Empanelment / Framework Agreement with Healthcare Institutions for Improving access to Specialist Care in Meghalaya**

Detailed RFP is available at www.meghssp.org, www. https://nhmmeghalaya.nic.in/, https://www.meghealth.gov.in/ The interested institutions are requested to keep checking the aforementioned websites for any updates.

**The last date for submission of RFP is 23rd October, 2026 by 4:00 PM in hard copy. All details are provided in the RFP Document.**

**Sd/-**
**Ramkumar S, IAS**
**Secretary**
**Department of Health & Family Welfare, GoM**

**MIPR No. : 1764**
**Dated : 30-09-2026**

## OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

### DEATH

*In Loving Memory of*



**MR. RAMABHADRAN SESHADRI (RAMJEE)**
29 September 2026

With deep sorrow, we announce the peaceful passing of **Mr. Ramabhadran Seshadri (Ramjee)** at his residence on 29 September 2026. Rising from humble beginnings to senior corporate leadership, he was admired for his integrity, positivity, and lifelong curiosity. A devoted son, loving father, joyful grandfather, and a constant companion to his wife of over sixty years, Vatsala, he lived a life of service, compassion, and unwavering dedication to family and community.

**Rituals at the family residence on 1st October at 7:30 AM, followed by final rites at Banashankari Crematorium between 10:00 AM and 11:00 AM.**

**Vatsala, Apsara, Aparna, Anand, Jay, Jayanth, Jeyasree & Grandchildren Sadhana, Bhavana, Vedh, Neel & Abhay**

### DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

**6th ANNIVERSARY**



**Mrs.SHANTHA RAJAGOPAL**
*OUR BELOVED FOUNDER*
*LA CHATELAINE - Keeper of the Keys*
*Holds the Keys with Blessings From Above.*
**Truly Missed, Fondly Remembered by LA CHATELAINE Family**

### DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

**FORTY-SECOND ANNIVERSARY**
*Our respectful Homage to*



**Shri.A.K.SAMBASIVAN** F.C.A.
22.08.1905 to 01.10.1984
Partners & Staff of
**R.G.N.PRICE & Co., & Members of the Family**

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### DEATH

**IN LOVING MEMORY**

WITH DEEP SORROW WE INFORM
THE PASSING OF OUR BELOVED



# Balasaraswathy Murugesu

18-08-1941 - 29-09-2026

A loving mother, grandmother and a guiding light,
she touched our lives with her warmth, strength and kindness.
Her love, values and blessings will always remain in our hearts.
We will for ever cherish the beautiful memories
and be grateful for her presence in our lives.

M.Lankalingam, Umangany Sathyaraj, Subangani Rajkumar
Suyambukani Kumeran, Shivanka, Malvika, Vijayalakshmi & Vianka

19, Lingams, Casuarina Drive, Sri Kapaleeswarar Nagar,
Neelankarai, Chennai, Tamilnadu - 600 115.

KINDLY KEEP HER IN YOUR PRAYERS

## Good foundation

### The festive season looks set to build on months of strong industrial growth

India's industrial growth performance in August continued its strong streak since the beginning of the financial year, and sets the economy up well for the upcoming festive season. Growth in the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) quickened to 8% in August 2026, the second fastest that it has been since at least April 2024, which is the earliest month for which the new series of the IIP has growth data. The fastest growth in this period, of 8.8%, came as recently as June 2026. In fact, IIP growth in the April-August period of this financial year stood at a robust 6.8%, faster than that seen during the corresponding periods of the previous two years. The new series has an updated base year, more data sources, and improved methodology, so this growth performance is as accurate an indication of industrial growth as government data can provide. Moreover, apart from a few divergences, IIP data largely match the trends evident in the Index of Core Industries (ICI), the other government index that measures industrial performance. For example, the IIP shows that the electricity sector's growth quickened to 12.3% in August 2026, while the ICI pegs it at 11.6%. Similarly, the construction goods sector saw growth come in at a relatively strong 6.4%, albeit slower than July's 8%. In keeping with that, the ICI shows that the cement sector grew by a robust 12.5% in August, though this was slightly slower than the 12.7% in July. The older series of both indices often provided contrary indications, so this alignment is welcome.

The IIP for August also lays out some core strengths that seem to be developing in the economy. The manufacturing sector grew by nearly 9% in August, and averaged 7.6% in the April-August 2026 period. Given that it had grown by about 4.2% in the first five months of the previous financial year, this acceleration is good to see, especially since it comes at a time when producers are facing several input-related pressures. At the start of this calendar year, manufacturing growth seemed to have been driven by a growth in exports. The August data show that this is now being supplemented by a recovery in domestic consumption. The growth in consumer durables stood at 11.1% in August. The consumer non-durables sector returned to growth, of a little more than 2%, after having contracted in July. The effect of the Goods and Services Tax rate cuts in September 2025 should have petered out by now, so this boost in durables production likely means that producers are expecting a strong festive season ahead. The third quarter of the financial year will therefore be crucial for the economy, but the groundwork seems to be in place for a relatively good one.

## Bitter pills

### The Supreme Court did well to intervene in drug pricing by retailers

The Supreme Court has upbraided disparities between the price to retailer (PTR) and the maximum retail price (MRP) of certain drugs, including those used to treat cancers, in some instances up to 1,000%. These drugs are not available over-the-counter, so hospitals often control which brand a patient uses. As a result, pharmaceutical companies compete for the hospitals' business, not patients'. To incentivise a hospital to stock specific drugs, they deliberately specify inflated MRPs while offering the hospital low PTRs, and the hospital can pocket the difference. The practice does not technically amount to a kickback but is one economically, as manufacturers effectively promise hospitals an embedded financial reward to pick specific products, and leave patients to potentially pay more than the medicines' supply price because hospitals have an incentive to sell brands with the largest margins. When private hospitals also force patients to purchase drugs from on-premise pharmacies – as Competition Commission investigations have established – patients are unable to shop around, undermining normal price competition. So, more affordable equivalent drugs are disadvantaged because of their lower revenue generation potential for hospitals. Patients, meanwhile, face severe financial strain – a concern also flagged by drug regulators in Karnataka and Maharashtra – and could, among those with cancers and chronic conditions, reduce adherence to longer treatment regimens.

The practice arises from a gap in the 2013 Drug (Prices Control) Order, which caps the final maximum price of scheduled drugs, but not the markup on hospitals' transactions. Say the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority (NPPA) calculates the market-derived average price of such a drug to be ₹100, making the ceiling ₹116. If a hospital negotiates a PTR of ₹50 from the manufacturer, it can still sell the drug (or bill the government if a drug is state-financed) at ₹116, without breaching the ceiling, and enjoy the difference of ₹66. In a proof-of-concept exercise in 2019, the NPPA capped the trade margins of 42 non-schedule anti-cancer drugs at 30%. The Department of Pharmaceuticals subsequently said prices of 526 brands dropped by up to 91%, suggesting that the MRPs of several cancer drugs included compressible margins. Second, while the Court's suggestion to have a fixed percentage markup across all drugs is appealing, it should accompany a regressive margin that applies a smaller percentage as drug prices increase, to neutralise sellers' incentive to favour more expensive products. Overall, however, the Court is right to highlight this insidious problem, especially after refusing to intervene in *Siddharth Dalmia* (2025), and while the Union and States have failed to counterbalance the absence of natural market mechanisms to rationalise drug prices.

# The India-EFTA partnership, one plus one equals three



**Benedikt Höskuldsson**

The Ambassador of Iceland to India

On October 1, 2025, the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) between India and the four European Free Trade Association (EFTA) states – Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland – entered into force. One year on, the more useful question is not how many tariff lines have fallen, but what kind of partnership the agreement is making possible.

The tariff figures are substantial. EFTA states have offered concessions on 92.2% of their tariff lines, covering 99.6% of the value of India's exports to them. India, in turn, is granting concessions on 82.7% of its tariff lines, covering 95.3% of the value of EFTA's exports. Few market-opening exercises between India and a group of developed economies have been this ambitious.

**Lasting partnerships, an India focus**

Yet, the defining feature of TEPA lies elsewhere. It was the first trade agreement that India signed with a dedicated chapter on investment and job creation. Under it, the EFTA states aim to raise investment in India by $100 billion over 15 years and to facilitate one million direct jobs. An agreement based on that is designed to build lasting industrial and technological partnerships.

For a country of just under 4,00,000 people, Iceland's contribution to that partnership was never going to be about scale. It is about experience, particularly in three areas where that experience speaks directly to India's priorities.

The first is geothermal energy, specifically a part of it that receives far less attention than power generation: the direct use of low- to medium-temperature heat. In Iceland, geothermal energy heats nearly every home, dries fish, warms greenhouses and keeps entire communities running through Arctic winters without burning fossil fuels. That century of experience in direct use is what the Himalayan geothermal belt of northern India can draw on.

Consider the apple growers of Himachal Pradesh. Many have long been forced to sell their harvest immediately, at the lowest prices of the season, because they lacked the means to store their crops.

That is now changing. At Tapri, in Kinnaur district, a geothermal facility operated by Geotropy, an Indian-Icelandic venture, uses heat drawn from the ground to dry fruit, and this harvest season, it is running round the clock as growers line up to use it.

A geothermal cooling facility at the same site is due to be completed by the end of the year. Farmers there can now process their produce and time their sales rather than remain price-takers at harvest, drawing on the same direct-use techniques that Iceland has refined over generations. Or consider the high-altitude communities and installations along India's northern frontier, which depend on fuel hauled along supply lines that can close for months. Heat drawn directly from the ground beneath them offers something no convoy can: energy security that does not depend on the road remaining open.

An ambitious India-Europe partnership can deliver across trade, technology, energy and Arctic stewardship

The second area is carbon capture, utilisation and storage. A NITI Aayog study in 2022 estimated that India could capture some 750 million tonnes of carbon dioxide a year by 2050. The scientific foundations are being laid by the Department of Science and Technology, which has steered India's carbon capture, utilisation and storage (CCUS) research for years and, in December 2025, published the country's first dedicated research and development road map for CCUS in support of the 2070 net-zero goal.

The Union Budget followed in February with an outlay of ₹20,000 crore over five years to take these technologies towards scale in power, steel, cement, refining and chemicals, while public sector companies such as the Oil and Natural Gas Corporation, NTPC Limited (formerly National Thermal Power Corporation) and Indian Oil Corporation Limited are taking the work into the field through feasibility studies, pilot projects and subsurface assessments.

This pre-commercial stage is exactly where Iceland's experience is most valuable, on both sides of the equation. On storage, CarbFix has shown that when carbon dioxide is dissolved in water and injected into basalt, more than 95% of it turns to stone within two years; India's Deccan Trap basalts share striking geological similarities with Iceland's volcanic rock.

**New frontiers**

On utilisation, Iceland was home to the world's first industrial-scale plant to turn captured carbon dioxide into fuel: Carbon Recycling International's George Olah plant at Svartsengi, which began producing methanol in 2011-12. Its technology now operates on a far larger scale abroad, including in projects involving steel-sector emissions. In May, Carbon Iceland signed a memorandum of understanding with JSW Steel and Bharatia to explore a 3,00,000-tonne-a-year e-methanol project in Raigad, Maharashtra, converting steel-plant emissions into fuel using green hydrogen. The opportunity, therefore, lies less in exporting equipment than in sharing knowledge and building partnerships through technology licensing, storage assessment, monitoring and verification, and the co-development of projects as India's pilots scale up.

The third area is the ocean. Iceland's economy was built on the sustainable management of North Atlantic fisheries, and with it came deep expertise in seafood quality, cold-chain logistics and value-added processing. Icelandic companies are already exploring how to bring further processing of North Atlantic catch to Indian shores, creating local jobs and transferring technology under the TEPA concessions.

Iceland has also shown that the greatest gains may lie in what is usually thrown away. Where most fishing nations use only 40% to 60% of each fish, Iceland now uses around 90% of every cod landed, turning skin, liver and bones into medical products, oils and feed. India does not need to catch a single additional fish to create new value, jobs and exports. It needs only to look differently at what its fleets already bring ashore.

All of this sits within a wider frame. Nearly six years of working on energy access at the United Nations, along with a seat at the table during the Paris Agreement negotiations, taught this writer that climate and energy policy are, at their core, exercises in patient and practical partnership between nations. That same spirit defines Iceland's and India's engagement in the Arctic. Iceland is a founding member of the Arctic Council; India has been an Observer since 2013 and has taken that role seriously, publishing its Arctic Policy in 2022 and operating the Himadri research station in Svalbard. As one of the eight Arctic States, Iceland offers India a direct and trusted bilateral channel into Arctic governance and research, complementing its multilateral engagement. For Iceland and India, energy, trade and Arctic stewardship are part of the same conversation.

**Some Icelandic arithmetic**

TEPA is young, but it is already showing what an ambitious, rules-based partnership between Europe and India can deliver in investment, technology and jobs, as well as in energy, fisheries and shared stewardship of a changing Arctic. It is not a rival to the European Union (EU)-India Free Trade Agreement (FTA) but a complement to it: a working model, already in force, of what the next chapter of Europe-India trade can look like. If readers will permit a small piece of Icelandic arithmetic, TEPA and the EU-India FTA are a case of one plus one equalling three. That is not competition but addition – and a rather good addition at that.

# Household debt, financing today against tomorrow



**M. Suresh Babu**

Director, Madras Institute of Development Studies, Chennai

Household borrowing is becoming an integral part of everyday consumption. Credit cards, personal loans, consumer durable loans, digital lending and buy-now-pay-later arrangements have expanded the possibilities of bringing future income into the present. The latest evidence points to a significant expansion of household leverage. According to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), as of September 2025, India's household debt stood at 45.5% of its gross domestic product (GDP). In June 2023, the debt had been around 42% of GDP. The household debt had stood at 39.2% in March 2021. While this remains relatively modest compared with several emerging market economies, the composition and pace of household borrowing deserve closer attention.

**The household savings transition**

The conventional Indian household financial model was built around savings. This model has been undergoing a transformation. Household net financial savings declined sharply from the exceptionally high levels witnessed during the COVID-19 pandemic, though recent data suggest some recovery. According to the government's response in Parliament, household net financial savings increased to around 6% of GDP in 2024-25 from 5.2% in 2023-24. Thus, the story is not one of an across-the-board collapse of household savings. Housing loans traditionally represented a major component of household debt. Such borrowing creates an asset and can therefore be viewed differently from borrowing to finance routine consumption.

The rapid expansion of personal loans, credit-card borrowing and other unsecured loans raises a different set of questions. These loans enable households to smooth consumption when current income is inadequate, but they also bring future income under commitment. This is particularly important in an economy where employment remains highly unequal and income growth is uneven. A salaried household with predictable monthly earnings can service a loan relatively comfortably. A self-employed worker, informal-sector employee or casual worker faces a very different risk profile. The RBI has noted that consumption-oriented borrowing remains significant, although its growth has moderated, while borrowing for productive purposes has been increasing. This should be welcomed, but should not obscure the distributional dimension of household indebtedness.

India's household debt story is more complicated than the headline number suggests

The fundamental question is why households are borrowing. If borrowing increases because incomes are rising and households are investing in houses, education or productive assets, higher indebtedness need not necessarily be a source of concern. But if borrowing is required to finance food, health care, education, housing rents, durable goods or other routine expenditures because current incomes are inadequate, debt becomes a mechanism for postponing rather than resolving the income constraint.

Digital lending platforms, instant personal loans, app-based credit and online consumer finance have substantially reduced the transaction costs associated with borrowing. The boundary between what a household can afford and what it can borrow becomes blurred. At the macroeconomic level, consumption financed through credit can support aggregate demand. At the household level, however, the same process creates future repayment obligations. When households borrow to finance health care, education, housing or old-age needs, debt is effectively substituting for inadequate social protection. In this sense, household debt is not merely an outcome of individual financial choices. It is shaped by the institutional structure of the economy.

**The macroeconomic implications**

Household debt has implications beyond individual borrowers. In the short run, credit expansion can stimulate consumption and support economic growth. But excessive household leverage can eventually have the opposite effect. As debt-servicing obligations rise, households reduce discretionary expenditure. Consumption becomes increasingly sensitive to interest rates and employment conditions. The macroeconomic transmission mechanism is straightforward: Income stagnation, borrowing to sustain consumption, rising debt service, declining disposable income, weaker consumption, greater dependence on credit.

If this cycle becomes entrenched, credit ceases to be an instrument for productive investment and becomes a mechanism for sustaining consumption in the face of inadequate income growth. There is therefore a potential contradiction between credit-led consumption growth and income-led demand expansion.

The first can generate a temporary acceleration of demand. The second provides a more sustainable foundation. The policy response to rising household debt should not be simply to restrict lending. Credit is an essential component of economic development, and access to formal credit can substantially improve household welfare. The challenge is to distinguish productive credit from distress credit and asset-building borrowing from consumption smoothing under income pressure.

**What the central issue is**

India's household debt story is therefore more complicated than the headline number suggests. The government has emphasised that India's household leverage remains below that of many emerging-market peers and that household net financial savings have improved. But the central issue is not simply how much households owe. It is why they owe it, to whom they owe it, at what cost, and against what income.

The danger lies in confusing access to credit with improvement in economic welfare. The more unequal and uncertain incomes become, the greater the temptation to finance living standards through borrowing. The question before policymakers is therefore not merely how to regulate household debt, but how to build an economy in which households can live on their incomes rather than against their future incomes.

*The views expressed are personal*

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

**SIR debate, electoral trust**

With the top court upholding the validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) conducted in Bihar, and the Election Commission clarifying its position on the exercise and stating that its decisions were taken unanimously, the legal position on the SIR has been substantially settled. It is difficult to understand why the Opposition and some television channels continue to question the exercise. Voters have exercised their franchise in favour of both the National Democratic Alliance and the Opposition in different elections. Where, then, is the justification for questioning the Chief Election Commissioner when a party loses an election? Earlier, the Electronic Voting Machine was blamed; now the Chief Election Commissioner is being questioned. It is undeniable that voters consider their sense of security and the quality of leadership when making their electoral choices.

**S. Seshadri,**
Chennai

**Celebrating victory**

I write this letter as a former Deputy General Manager (Sports Department), Rashtriya Ispat Nigam Limited (RINL), Visakhapatnam Steel Plant (VSP). Whenever athletes win medals at major international sporting events, photographers frequently ask them to hold the medal between their teeth and pose. Indian sportspersons have also increasingly followed this international practice. The medal-biting pose is mainly a modern sports photography tradition. It is sometimes associated with the old image of biting gold to test its authenticity. However, modern Olympic gold medals are not made of solid gold, and there is no sporting rule requiring an athlete to bite a medal. Could India develop its own dignified and distinctive way of celebrating sporting success? For example, Indian medal winners could be encouraged to hold the medal near their heart, raise it proudly alongside the Indian Tricolour, salute the National Flag, or adopt another respectful pose representing India's cultural identity. There is nothing wrong with following an international photographic tradition, but there can be a change.

**J.L.V. Sastry,**
Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

# In U.P., the Congress needs the SP



**Syed Kamran**

Independent journalist and political commentator based in Lucknow

As Uttar Pradesh heads toward its next Assembly contest, Congress strategists are dealing with an uncomfortable truth: in the current alliance, the Samajwadi Party (SP) holds the stronger hand. Beyond the optics of 'INDIA bloc unity', the arithmetic and organisational depth point the same way: the Congress needs the SP more than the SP needs the Congress.

The first distinction is structural. The SP is not a personality-led outfit that borrows crowds for a season and vanishes when the tide turns. It has a functioning cadre and booth-level workers; Yadav-Muslim social capital built over three decades; a growing share of non-Yadav Other Backward Classes (OBCs) and Dalits; and a district-to-village skeleton that survives bad election cycles. Compare this to the Trinamool Congress or the Aam Aadmi Party which is based on 'leader-and-supporter' constructs; they are formidable when the leader is popular but structurally thin once the wave recedes.

The Congress's State unit suffers from the ailment the SP has cured. It is a supporter-driven shell, dependent on media cycles, occasional Rahul Gandhi yatras, and transient online support, lacking ground infrastructure to convert sentiment into votes on polling day. The SP's cadre, by contrast, is a durable asset that isn't going anywhere regardless of who wins in 2027; that permanence is the leverage.

The second argument, arguably more decisive, is vote arithmetic. U.P.'s contest is no longer a fragmented four-cornered fight; it has hardened into a bipolar contest between the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and the SP-led opposition. The Bahujan Samaj Party's (BSP) vote share has been steadily eroding, and what remains of it, along with residual anti-BJP sentiment scattered across smaller caste-based and regional outfits, has no natural home. It flows toward whichever non-BJP formation has the most chance of winning.

In a bipolar contest, that residual "anyone but the BJP" vote doesn't split evenly; it consolidates behind the party seen as the real challenger, and in U.P. that is unambiguously the SP, not the Congress. Voters unhappy with the BJP will vote strategically by gravitating to the SP because it has repeatedly shown itself as the only outfit within striking distance of the BJP's vote share. The Congress, hovering in single digits across most U.P. assembly segments for over a decade, isn't part of that calculation for the median opposition voter. Its vote-multiplying value is limited, while the SP's brand pulls in the anti-incumbency vote that decides seats.

Voters unhappy with the BJP will vote strategically by gravitating to the SP because it has repeatedly shown itself as the only outfit within striking distance of the BJP's vote share

The third argument is narrative ownership. The 2027 U.P. election is shaping Akhilesh Yadav as the face of the opposition and the PDA (*Pichda*, Dalit, *Alpsankhyak* (Backward, Dalit, Minority)) as the organising social coalition. This has been Mr. Yadav's framework since the 2022 defeat, and it has visibly reshaped how backward and Dalit voters outside the traditional SP base view the party. The Congress has no competing narrative in U.P. with similar traction; its national *Nyay* (justice) framework and Bharat Jodo-adjacent messaging hasn't localised into a U.P.-specific story the way the PDA has.

When one partner owns the narrative and the other is borrowing space within it, the question of who 'steers the wheel' answers itself. A realistic path for the Congress lies in being a disciplined junior partner that helps consolidate the PDA coalition in seats where it adds value, such as in Brahmin and urban pockets, rather than insisting on parity in seat-sharing. Overreach risks fracturing an already-fragile anti-BJP consolidation.

**The bottom line**

This does not mean that the Congress brings nothing to the table; a national party's symbolic weight does have marginal value. But marginal value is not equal leverage in a State as diverse as U.P. The SP has cadre permanence, the bipolar arithmetic that captures residual anti-BJP votes, and narrative ownership through Mr. Yadav and the PDA. In any honest reading, this is an alliance where one partner can survive alone and the other cannot; and that imbalance should shape how the Congress negotiates seats and its place in the coalition.

The Congress's best bet is to fight this election in alliance with the SP with realistic seat demands rather than inflated ones – concentrating resources on a limited set of seats. A good strike rate on fewer seats does two things: it hands the Congress a stronger hand in seat-sharing talks for 2029, and it gives the party a real bloc of sitting MLAs; the kind of ground presence no amount of central leadership visibility can substitute for.

# How to finance rural prosperity



**Sanjay Agarwal**

Former Secretary, Department of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare, Government of India

India's agricultural transformation is one of the greatest achievements of independent India. Over the past six decades, the nation has emerged as one of the world's largest producers of cereals, milk, fruits, vegetables and fisheries products. This progress was driven by visionary public policy, scientific innovation, irrigation, institutional credit and the enterprise of millions of Indian farmers.

While India's first agricultural transformation delivered food security, the next must deliver rural prosperity by enabling rural India to capture a larger share of the value created after harvest. Every agricultural commodity passes through a value chain from production to aggregation, storage, logistics, processing, branding and markets. It is along this chain that enterprises emerge, employment expands and prosperity grows. Financing this change requires moving past production credit towards financing the entire agricultural value chain.

Dairy, poultry and fisheries operate through continuous procurement and marketing cycles, generating predictable cash flows, lower inventory risks and regular working-capital turnover. However, seasonal commodities operate under a very different financial reality. Processors need to procure most of their annual raw material requirement within a short harvest window and finance inventory for the remainder of the year. A company investing ₹500 crore in a modern processing facility may require ₹700–₹800 crore simply to procure, store and carry seasonal inventory.

While India's first agricultural transformation delivered food security, the next must deliver rural prosperity by enabling rural India to capture a larger share of the value created after harvest

Without appropriately structured working capital, even efficient enterprises struggle to remain commercially viable. While the sugar sector is also seasonal, its growth demonstrates how inventory finance and warehouse-backed lending can overcome seasonal constraints. The difference in sector growth lies not in production potential but in the way the chain is financed.

**Need for new mechanisms**

For more than five decades, successive reforms including bank nationalisation, rural banks, cooperative institutions and the Kisan credit card expanded production credit. India has successfully built robust institutions for financing agricultural production when national food security was the priority. It must now build robust mechanisms for financing every commercially viable activity that creates value between the farm and the final consumer.

Encouragingly, elements of such a financing ecosystem are already emerging. Banks have introduced products such as warehouse receipt financing, receivables financing, and financing for food processing and agricultural infrastructure, while agri-focused non-banking financial companies have pioneered innovative value-chain models. However, these remain isolated initiatives rather than components of a comprehensive agricultural value chain financing architecture.

The opportunity is substantial. Based on the difference between the GVA (Gross Value Added) of agriculture and allied sectors (₹48.8 lakh crore) and the institutional credit flow (₹20 lakh crore) during 2023-24, indicative estimates suggest that the financing opportunity across India's agricultural value chains could exceed ₹14 lakh crore.

While only about 10-12% of agricultural produce is processed in India, the corresponding level is estimated at around 35-45% across East, South and Southeast Asia and often exceeds 60% in many developed economies. In these economies, agricultural transformation is supported by financing systems aligned with commodity-specific value chains rather than production alone.

A comprehensive agricultural value chain financing framework should provide a diverse portfolio of financial instruments, including product finance, receivables finance, warehouse receipt finance, risk mitigation solutions and credit enhancement mechanisms. These instruments can finance the flow of goods, services and capital across the value chain, with financing decisions increasingly based on commodity-specific value chains and cash-flow analysis rather than conventional collateral alone. This will enable capital to reach farmers, input suppliers, aggregators, warehouse operators, processors, logistics providers, exporters and retailers, thereby unlocking private investment, creating rural jobs, improving farmer incomes, and accelerating rural industrialisation.

Building a solid agricultural value chain finance architecture can become one of the most consequential reforms for achieving the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

# Rise in EV adoption stresses need for ramping up charging infra

Three-wheeler EVs accounted for the States of Assam, Bihar, West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh showing higher figures in EV adoption

DATA POINT

**Sachin Swaraj**
**Pon Vasanth B.A.**

India is slowly but steadily transitioning towards Electric Vehicles (EVs), with cars under the "alternative fuels" category overtaking petrol cars for the first time in August 2026, as per the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations' (FADA).

Though the alternative fuels category included fuel types such as CNG/LPG, the overall growth in the sale of EVs was significant, as reported by *The Hindu*.

However, State-wise data shows that this growth is not uniform with notable variations even among comparable States. **Table 1** shows the share of EVs and hybrid EVs in the total registrations of all types of vehicles since 2022-23. Only the States and Union Territories (UTs) that registered at least 10,000 EVs (including hybrids) are shown in the table. As the data shows, the first five months of 2026-27 have already seen a significant increase with 12.7% (16.5 lakh) of the roughly 1.29 crore vehicles registered in India being EVs or hybrids. Among the major States and UTs, Keralam, Delhi, Karnataka, Odisha, and Telangana are leading with at least 15% of the registered vehicles being EVs or hybrids.

While Keralam, Delhi, and Karnataka were already showing notable increases in the previous years as well, data shows that the near doubling of the share in Telangana was mainly driven by the three-wheeler segment. Three-wheeler EVs also accounted for Assam, Bihar, West Bengal and Uttar Pradesh showing higher figures. The share of EVs and hybrids in new registrations in 2026-27 will drop to well below 5% if three-wheelers are excluded, analysis showed. Tripura and Assam will drop to the lowest of 2.2% and 2.6% if three-wheelers are excluded.

The disparity between the States and UTs in EV adoption is also visible in terms of availability of EV charging infrastructure and the power consumption from EV charging stations.

**Chart 1** shows the power consumption from public charging stations, excluding the heavy-duty ones predominantly used by government-operated e-buses, based on the Central Electricity Authority's report for the financial year 2025-26. Among the 15 States/UTs with highest power consumption shown in the chart, Maharashtra outperformed other States in both the availability of number of charging locations and their usage measured by the power consumed.

While Delhi showed high usage despite relatively fewer number of charging stations, Karnataka was at the other end with highest number of charging locations but relatively lesser usage. All the other States shown in the chart lagged behind by a wide margin when compared with Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Karnataka and Maharashtra.

The map shows whether the charging infrastructure available in public places has grown in proportion to the number of EVs registered across India. It measures how many newly registered EVs share charging infrastructure in a public place. For instance, there is one charging location available for every 997 registered EVs in Assam. Karnataka, on the other hand, has a public charging facility for every 144 EVs registered between 2021-22 and 2026-27 (till August) – indicating the need for the charging infrastructure to grow in places that are adopting quickly to EVs.

Although the map does not show the concentration of the charging facilities within each State, analysis showed they are heavily concentrated in and around major urban centres. For instance, Karnataka has public charging facilities in around 6,000 locations, of which about two-thirds are located in and around Bengaluru.

## Uneven growth

The data for the analysis were sourced from Vahan portal, Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) and the Central Electricity Authority (CEA). Data on charging stations sourced from BEE is as of late 2025. Sachin Swaraj is interning with The Hindu's Data team



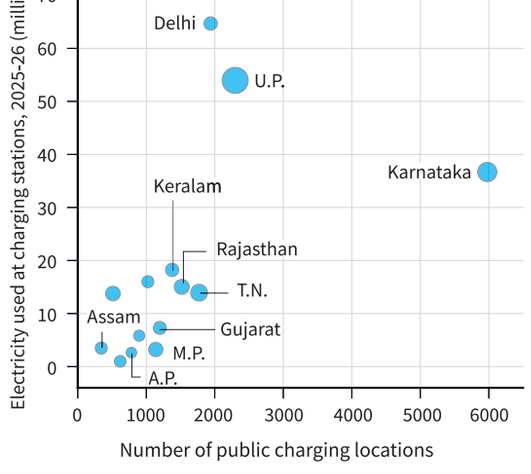

**TABLE 1:** This shows the share of electric vehicles (EVs) and hybrid EVs in the total number of vehicles registered. Only those States and UTs that registered at least 10,000 EVs and hybrid EVs in 2025-26 are shown

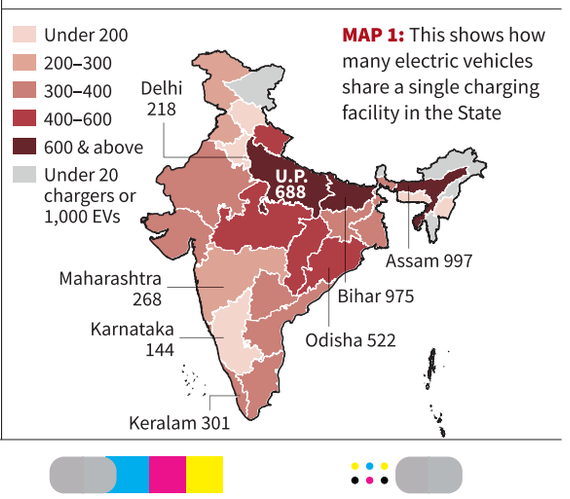
*Apr-Aug

| State | 2022-23 | 2023-24 | 2024-25 | 2025-26 | 2026-27* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Uttar Pradesh | 6.9 | 9.5 | 10.9 | 10.6 | 12.6 |
| Maharashtra | 7.7 | 9.5 | 9.6 | 9.2 | 13.1 |
| Karnataka | 8.6 | 11.1 | 11.1 | 12.7 | 16.5 |
| Tamil Nadu | 5.3 | 6.7 | 8.5 | 9.7 | 12.9 |
| Madhya Pradesh | 3.9 | 5.8 | 7.2 | 9.5 | 12.6 |
| Keralam | 8.7 | 13.7 | 14.1 | 15.5 | 18.0 |
| West Bengal | 2.2 | 3.4 | 5.2 | 10.6 | 11.6 |
| Bihar | 5.8 | 7.7 | 8.7 | 8.6 | 11.2 |
| Rajasthan | 7.4 | 7.1 | 7.4 | 7.6 | 11.8 |
| Delhi | 13.5 | 15.3 | 14.7 | 15.2 | 17.0 |
| Gujarat | 6.1 | 5.8 | 4.8 | 4.9 | 7.3 |
| Odisha | 6.1 | 7.8 | 9.3 | 10.9 | 18.7 |
| Assam | 9.0 | 10.9 | 12.4 | 17.0 | 20.7 |
| Telangana | 4.2 | 6.3 | 7.2 | 8.4 | 15.1 |
| Andhra Pradesh | 4.9 | 5.1 | 7.2 | 7.9 | 12.4 |
| Punjab | 4.6 | 7.0 | 8.5 | 7.7 | 10.2 |
| Chhattisgarh | 6.7 | 8.5 | 8.3 | 8.5 | 12.7 |
| Haryana | 5.8 | 6.4 | 6.7 | 5.7 | 6.2 |
| Jharkhand | 4.3 | 5.1 | 5.7 | 6.4 | 8.5 |
| Uttarakhand | 8.4 | 8.3 | 8.8 | 8.8 | 11.8 |
| Jammu & Kashmir | 4.9 | 8.5 | 9.7 | 8.3 | 10.3 |
| Goa | 12.1 | 17.0 | 16.1 | 14.7 | 20.1 |
| Tripura | 8.8 | 12.7 | 16.3 | 18.4 | 20.0 |
| **All India** | 6.4 | 8.1 | 8.8 | 9.5 | 12.7 |

*Share (%) of EV + hybrid in all new vehicle registrations. Lighest shade is <5. Other bands are 5-8%, 8-11%, 11-14%, >14%*

**CHART 1:** This shows the power consumed from public charging stations, when compared with the number of locations in which such infrastructure is available




**MAP 1:** This shows how many electric vehicles share a single charging facility in the State

## FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

**FIFTY YEARS AGO** OCTOBER 1, 1976

### Southern rice zone minus Kerala

New Delhi, September 30: The formation of a southern rice zone, comprising Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Pondicherry, was announced to-day by the Union Minister for Agriculture and Irrigation, Mr. Jagjivan Ram. Kerala will not be in the zone because as Mr. Jagjivan Ram said, "we take the responsibility of supplying the requirements of Kerala from the Central pool."

Within the zone there would be no curbs on movement of rice.

The northern rice zone will be expanded to include Rajasthan. At present, it consists of Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and Delhi.

Also, there is no change in regard to the kharif cereals other than rice – there will be no restriction on the movement in the country.

Mr. Jagjivan Ram made these points at a press conference, called to announce the kharif policy on the basis of the recommendations of the Agricultural Prices Commission. The Union Cabinet, which considered the Commission's report this morning, Mr. Jagjivan Ram said, decided to accept its suggestion that the procurement prices of coarse paddy be continued at Rs. 74 per quintal for the coming season. Similarly, the procurement rates of other coarse cereals will remain at Rs. 74 per quintal. The Cabinet, however, decided to reduce the procurement target of rice from 5.5. million tonnes, as recommended by the Commission, to 4.4 million tonnes.

**A HUNDRED YEARS AGO** OCTOBER 1, 1926

### Poisoning prevented by wireless

London, September 30: The wireless search for Mr. Penn (see message issued yesterday) has ended happily. This afternoon the purchaser of the pills, telegraphed to the Chemist from London where he read of the mistake in a London newspaper, that none of the pills had yet been taken. The pills contained 1/4 grain of Strychnine each, instead of 1/40. The announcement has greatly relieved the chemist, who, upon the discovery of his error, had telegraphed a warning to every Mr. Penn in the directory.

## From Page One

## ‘Pilot stabbed colleague to crash flydubai plane’

The airline, flydubai, confirmed that an “altercation occurred in the flight deck” and the aircraft was secured by on-duty crew “who diverted and landed the aircraft safely”. It added that it was cooperating with the relevant authorities and that all passengers were safe.

The airport in Tabuk reported that a FlyDubai flight made a distress call at 8:44 a.m. local time, before landing safely at 9:45 a.m. As the plane began to dive, a passenger and a crew member broke into the cockpit, said Mr. Netanyahu, citing a passenger he spoke to. Other crew members then took over flying the plane. Among the passengers who intervened were members of the Israeli security forces and air marshals, according to a person familiar with a probe by Saudi Arabia and regional partners.

Passengers told Israel’s Channel 12 by phone they heard shouts from those sitting near the front of the plane who heard the altercation between the pilots.

Doron Spielman, a spokesperson for the Israeli Prime Minister’s office, said Mr. Netanyahu had instructed authorities to “ramp up security” on flights to Israel operated by Israeli and on non-Israeli carriers. “Our job right now is to do our best to make sure that those security procedures are much higher,” Mr. Spielman said.

*(With inputs from PTI, Reuters and AFP)*

## INDIA bloc to kick off campaign against CEC

The senior Supreme Court lawyer at the meeting recommended that the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, should be legally challenged. The legislation states that “notwithstanding other laws, no court could entertain or continue civil or criminal proceedings against a person who was or had been CEC/EC for an act, thing, or word committed, done, or spoken while discharging official duty or function,” extending a blanket immunity to the CEC. In view of this, Mr. Sibal suggested that legal action be taken against other Election Commission officials such as Seema Khanna, Director General (IT) at ECI, who have been instrumental in bringing special intensive revision (SIR). Most leaders backed the proposal.

There was, however, apprehension among some leaders about the Supreme Court’s stance. Shiv Sena (UBT) leader and former Maharashtra Chief Minister Uddhav Thackeray, who joined the meeting virtually, cited the Chief Justice of India’s observation while declining an early hearing of pleas related to the SIR in West Bengal. The CJI had observed, “These are only by-elections.”

Mr. Kharge alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah were making the Election Commission function like a “puppet”. “These people are only winning elections by stealing votes,” he said.

## ‘Southwest monsoon ends with 12% deficit’

The IMD director-general told media on Wednesday that the IMD’s predictions matched conditions in “many regions, except some parts of northwest and adjoining central India”.

The department’s regional and monthly forecasts were far off the mark. June, which got only 65% of normal rainfall, was far drier than the 92% forecast. July rainfall, which was expected to be below 94%, ended up with 1% more, thanks to rains in central India, which got 33% more rain than normal. August came in at 84% of the LPA, in line with the “below 94%” that was forecast. September, at 92.4% finished a little above the forecast of “below 91%”.

The largest deviations from normal rainfall were in east and northeast India (25.6% below normal). Mr. Mohapatra said that there was a “marked trend” of diminishing rainfall in this region “in recent years”. Rainfall in the southern peninsula was 24.3% below normal, and at 542 mm, this was the fourth lowest monsoon rainfall recorded in the region since 1901. Northwest India ended 5.9% below normal and central India stood at 2.6% below normal, according to an IMD statement.

Punjab, Arunachal Pradesh, and the Assam & Meghalaya subdivisions were rain-deficient in every month from June to September. Nationally, 17 of 36 subdivisions (covering 42% of the country’s land area) saw deficient rainfall, 18 were normal, and one had excess rain. Of 741 districts assessed, 282 were deficient and 34 were “large deficient”.

## LeT ‘commander’ killed in J&K: Army

The Army said a joint search operation was launched by the Army, J&K Police, and CRPF in the general area Korag, Yousmarg, in Budgam “based on specific intelligence input” on Tuesday night. “Vigilant troops observed suspicious activity, and upon being challenged, terrorists opened fire, prompting a fierce exchange of gunfire during which one terrorist neutralised,” the Army said.

# Coast Guard and ATS seize drugs worth ₹3,000 crore

Contraband comprising 526 kg of methamphetamine and heroin found on an Iranian boat in the Arabian Sea near Lakshadweep; 5 Pakistanis held in joint operation carried out on September 25

**Press Trust of India**
AHMEDABAD

The Indian Coast Guard, in a joint operation with the Gujarat Anti-Terrorism Squad, has seized 526 kilograms of methamphetamine and heroin valued at more than ₹3,000 crore from an Iranian boat in the Arabian Sea near Lakshadweep, officials said on Wednesday.


Indian Coast Guard and Gujarat ATS detained five Pakistanis and seized 526 kg of drugs from an Iranian boat in the Arabian Sea. PTI

Five Pakistani nationals operating the vessel were detained in the operation that was carried out on September 25, the Coast Guard said in a statement.

The seized contraband comprised high-grade methamphetamine and heroin, the Coast Guard said. The vessel, its crew and the seized drugs were brought to Mumbai under armed escort for joint interrogation and further legal proceedings, it said.

Addressing a press conference here, Gujarat Anti-Terrorist Squad (ATS) Deputy Inspector General of Police, Sunil Joshi, said the operation was launched based on intelligence inputs about a consignment being smuggled from Iran into India via sea route.

As per the preliminary investigation, the contraband was supposed to land on the Tamil Nadu coast after taking delivery mid-sea.

The suspected Iranian boat, identified as ‘Azad’, was intercepted on the evening of September 25, around 160 nautical miles northwest of Lakshadweep and about 490 nautical miles southwest of Mumbai, Mr. Joshi said.

The Coast Guard carried out sea-air surveillance and tracked the suspicious vessel based on actionable intelligence shared by the Gujarat ATS and Central intelligence agencies, Mr. Joshi told presspersons.

The intelligence indicated that a Nigerian national had recently met a wanted Gujarat-based accused and they had planned to smuggle more than 500 kg of methamphetamine and heroin from Iran into India, he said.

**Funds pumped in**

Advance funds for the operation were allegedly routed through hawala channels, while the smugglers planned to avoid the Gujarat coastline and offload the consignment at sea, he said.

“It emerged from subsequent investigation that this boat was set to approach from waters near Lakshadweep and Mumbai to offload the delivery onto another boat from Tamil Nadu mid-sea,” Mr. Joshi said.

Following the intelligence input, an operational team comprising Gujarat ATS officers was deployed aboard an Indian Coast Guard ship. The operation began on September 14 and continued for around 10 days before the vessel was intercepted, he said.

“In such a vast expanse of open sea, scanning every suspicious boat and pinpointing the exact target vessel was a formidable challenge. However, the Coast Guard crew and our deployed officers executed the operation tactically and successfully,” he said. The Coast Guard intercepted the boat, detained its crew and searched the vessel. It was equipped with a Starlink device that provided satellite Internet connectivity while at sea, he said.

The five detained crew members have been identified as Mohammad Yakub Balochi, Shakirullah, Faridullah, Ahmed Khan and Wahidullah Khan.

According to the ATS, the boat had departed from Iran.

While passing off Gwadar in Pakistan, smugglers aboard a smaller boat from Gwadar transferred the contraband onto the Iranian vessel. The consignment allegedly belonged to a smuggling network run by Haji Salim.

# Avoid travelling to Russia to join Army, govt. warns Indians

**Suhasini Haidar**
NEW DELHI

**External Affairs Ministry said people should be wary of being misled by recruiting agents**

The government on Wednesday “strongly discouraged” Indians from travelling to Russia to join the Russian Army, warning of the “mortal dangers” they would face there.

In its toughest travel advisory issued since the Indian Embassy in Moscow began to detect a growing number of Indian expatriates being recruited to serve at the Russia-Ukraine warfront, the External Affairs Ministry said that it continues to see reports of Indians signing up to join the Army despite several appeals and warnings.

“The government has on several occasions over the past two years underlined the risks and dangers inherent in this course of action and advised Indian citizens from time to time to be cautious while pursuing job opportunities abroad and not get lured by any job offers from unverified individuals,” the Ministry advisory said.

**Lured by money**

“It is reiterated that this is a dangerous path and is strongly discouraged by the government,” it said, adding that it remains engaged with Russian authorities to ensure the safety and early discharge of all Indians in the Russian military.

Officials said the worrying trend continued as many in India were falling for what they saw as “attractive” job offers, but were being misled by recruiting agents.

During his visit to Moscow in July 2024, Prime Minister Narendra Modi raised the issue of Indian recruits who had signed contracts to join the Russian Armed Forces but wanted to return to India, with Russian President Vladimir Putin. However, officials said that even as dozens of recruits had been helped to return after a special dispensation from Moscow, more were joining up, hoping to earn money and possibly emigrate.

In particular, the Ministry advisory said that in “numerous instances”, Indian nationals had willingly joined the Russian armed forces, believing that once they had received adequate monetary benefits, they could approach the Indian government to secure their release.

# Pilot injured in the flydubai ‘altercation’ identified as Indian

**Jagriti Chandra**
NEW DELHI


Captain Smit Machchhar

The captain who was attacked during an altercation inside the cockpit of a flydubai flight from Dubai to Tel Aviv on Wednesday is an Indian national, Captain Smit Machchhar.

Mr. Machchhar was previously employed with SpiceJet. Official confirmation is awaited.

In a press statement, flydubai has called the incident aboard FZ 1073 “an altercation”.

“At this early stage, the underlying reasons and motives behind this event are unknown and remain subject to a formal investigation,” flydubai said.

The airline said that the aircraft was successfully secured by on-duty flydubai crew travelling on the flight, who diverted and landed the aircraft safely at Tabuk Airport (TUU) in Saudi Arabia, and that all passengers and crew were safe and accounted for.

Passengers received medical attention from local authorities, according to a regional official.

# All 4 LeT ‘commanders’ active in J&K since 2022 are dead: Home Ministry

**Vijaita Singh**
NEW DELHI

The Union Home Ministry on Wednesday said that with the killing of a Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) ‘commander’ in Jammu and Kashmir’s Budgam district in an operation that started on Tuesday, all four senior LeT ‘commanders’ who had been operating in the Union Territory since 2022 are dead.

According to the Ministry, the LeT commander, identified by the Army as Mohammad Asif, alias Hashim Moosa, was killed in an intelligence-led joint operation by security forces at Gurwatkalan in the Khansahib area of Budgam district.

The Ministry said security agencies had been pursuing him for a long time and recently put in place a specific multi-agency plan for his “neutralisation” after receiving technical and human intelligence inputs regarding his movements and presence. It described Moosa’s killing as a major blow to the LeT ecosystem in Jammu and Kashmir. It said that with his death, the entire four-member group of senior LeT commanders active in J&K since 2022 has been dismantled.




The Home Ministry said the group was responsible for several major attacks, including the Halan attack in August 2023, the Kandi attack in May 2023, the DKG attack in December 2023, the Shahsitar attack in May 2024, the Shiv Khori attack in June 2024, the Gagangir attack in October 2024, the Bootapathri attack in October 2024, and the Baisaran attack in April 2025.

**Pahalgam perpetrator**

Suleman, one of these four commanders, was involved in the terror attack at the Baisaran meadow of Pahalgam on April 22, 2025, when 25 tourists and a local man were killed. Suleman was later killed during Operation Mahadev, along with two other Pakistani terrorists, on July 28, 2025.

Apart from Moosa and Suleman, two other LeT commanders who operated in J&K were also killed in separate operations, the Home Ministry said. Junaid Bhat was killed in an encounter at Dachigam on December 3, 2024, and Yasir was killed in Operation Asdhar on September 4, 2026.

The Ministry said the operation against Moosa was part of a sustained counter-terrorism campaign and reflected the close coordination among the Jammu and Kashmir Police, the Indian Army and the Central Armed Police Forces.

# Scribes, stand-up comedian seek to intervene in free speech case

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

**Seema Chishti, Ajit Anjum, and Kunal Kamra’s pleas have been referred to a Constitution Bench**

Senior journalists Seema Chishti and Ajit Anjum, and stand-up comedian Kunal Kamra have made applications in the Supreme Court for permission to intervene in a long-pending case on the limits of legislative privilege, and whether a House of Legislature can use its powers to override citizens’ fundamental right to freedom of speech and expression.

A seven-judge Constitution Bench is scheduled to hear the case on October 6.

The case in question dates back to 2003. *The Hindu* had published an editorial criticising then Tamil Nadu Chief Minister J. Jayalalithaa. The Assembly Speaker at that time had passed a resolution in the House accusing the daily of having “distorted the proceedings of the Assembly, commented contrary to the events in the Assembly”. The resolution said the comments made in the editorial “amount to a breach of privilege of the entire House” under Article 194 of the Constitution, which guarantees freedom of speech and immunities to Members of State legislatures. The Tamil Nadu State Assembly had passed a resolution to arrest the editorial staff of *The Hindu*.

N. Ravi, the then Editor of *The Hindu*, had approached the Supreme Court, which had stayed any coercive police action against the newspaper’s senior editors. Senior advocate Harish Salve, who had appeared for the newspaper, argued against the invocation of Article 194(3) to choke press freedom enshrined under Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution.

The apex court had agreed to examine the larger legal issue of whether a critical speech or publication would constitute a breach of legislative privilege.

Ms. Chishti, represented by advocate Neha Rathi, said the case, at its core, concerned the “constitutional balance between the Legislature, the judiciary and the free press”.

Mr. Kamra submitted that he was directly affected by the privilege proceedings pending against him in the Maharashtra State Assembly over his stand-up comedy act ‘Naya Bharat’.

# Modi, Trump talk trade, defence, critical technologies over a call

**Suhasini Haidar**
NEW DELHI

In their first telephone call since the United States Congress passed the new Russian sanctions law, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said he and President Donald Trump had a “productive conversation” and reviewed bilateral ties. Mr. Modi and Mr. Trump spoke amid growing concerns over the India-U.S. relationship, underlined by a talk by External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar in New York earlier this week where he spelt out a number of “issues”, including over tariffs, FTA negotiations, the U.S.’s treatment of Indian migrants and Pakistan.

The call between the two leaders followed talks between Mr. Jaishankar and U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio as well as Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri and U.S. Undersecretary of State Allison Hooker on the sidelines of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA).


Donald Trump and Narendra Modi. FILE PHOTO

**Sanctions on Russia**

During both meetings, Indian officials had raised concerns over the U.S.’s new Lindsey O Graham Sanctions Against Russia and Iran Act (SRIA), which mandates Mr. Trump to levy up to 100% tariffs on goods imported from India, China and other countries that import Russian oil. Mr. Misri also raised the issues with a U.S. Congressional delegation in Delhi this week.

In a social media post, Mr. Modi said he and Mr. Trump discussed India-U.S. cooperation in “trade, defence, energy, critical technologies and other areas”, but made no direct reference to the SRIA.

**‘Close engagement’**

“We agreed to maintain close engagement to take our Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership forward. We also exchanged views on regional and international issues, including ongoing efforts to advance global peace and security,” he said.

Mr. Modi is expected to travel to Florida in December to attend the G20 summit hosted by Mr. Trump.

# Mamata bats for Rahul as PM, Kharge calls for unity

Prepared to contribute as mere worker with 'no ego', says former Bengal CM; Congress chief says INDIA bloc should first fight threats to democracy; Rahul calls alliance 'defenders of Constitution'

**Sobhana K. Nair**
NEW DELHI

Former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee endorsed Leader of the Opposition Rahul Gandhi as the face of the Opposition alliance, telling leaders at the INDIA bloc meeting on Wednesday that she would have no objection if Mr. Gandhi were to become the Prime Minister.

Her remarks, however, were promptly met with a note of caution from Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, who said the gathering was not meant to discuss leadership positions but to forge a united response to the challenges facing the country.

Sources said Ms. Banerjee repeatedly emphasised the need for all Opposition parties to work together and said she was prepared to contribute as a mere worker. Stressing that she had "no ego", she cited her outreach to Biju Janata Dal leader Naveen Patnaik and referred to her recent conversation with CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby, despite the Trinamool Congress and the Left having been longstanding political rivals in West Bengal.



**In sync:** Sonia Gandhi, Mamata Banerjee, other INDIA bloc leaders address the media in New Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Pointing towards Mr. Gandhi, Ms. Banerjee said: "If Rahul Gandhi becomes Prime Minister, I have no problem."

Mr. Kharge intervened soon after, saying the meeting's purpose was not to decide who would occupy the top post but to stand together to "save the country".

**'Different atmosphere'**

Leaders present at the meeting described the atmosphere as markedly different from the INDIA bloc's previous gathering on June 8. Wednesday's discussions were characterised by Congress's willingness to accommodate suggestions from all parties.

Ideas mooted by Mr. Baby for a collective representation to the President, by CPI(ML) general secretary Dipankar Bhattacharya of taking the agitation on "vote *chori*" (vote theft) beyond Delhi and the main cities, and by Independent Rajya Sabha member Kapil Sibal of legally challenging the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Bill, 2023, were accepted.

Rashtriya Janata Dal leader Tejashwi Yadav suggested that there is a growing need for the INDIA bloc to speak in one voice, for which it should have designated spokespersons.

The bloc agreed that a sub-committee should be formed to take day-to-day decisions.

**'To work with humility'**

Mr. Gandhi, who spoke towards the end of the deliberations, stressed the importance of collective action and cooperation among alliance partners. He said the Congress was prepared to work with "humility" alongside other parties and argued that the alliance had a historic responsibility to defend democratic institutions.

"History will remember this group which is sitting here today as the one that defended the Constitution of India," he said.

Addressing the joint press conference later, Mr. Gandhi returned to the same theme. "Collectively, we are the defenders of the Indian Constitution," he said, adding that the coming months would be politically significant and that the Opposition intended to intensify its campaign against the government.

# CEC has 'lifelong blanket immunity' for helping PM Modi 'steal' polls: Rahul

**Sandeep Phukan**
NEW DELHI

The Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Wednesday alleged that Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar has lifelong immunity from court proceedings because he helped the Narendra Modi government indulge in "vote *chori*" (theft).

"Q. Why is CEC Gyanesh Kumar the only Indian with lifelong blanket legal immunity? A. Because PM Modi uses him to steal elections," Mr. Gandhi said on X, shortly after the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance discussed the possibility of challenging the law that gives immunity to the CEC and the other two Election Commissioners.

At the INDIA bloc meeting, former Law Minister Kapil Sibal suggested that the Opposition challenge the 2023 law that gives the CEC and the two Commissioners immunity from criminal and civil proceedings. Section 16 of the Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners Act, 2023, protects both the CEC and the Commissioners.

A court cannot entertain proceedings against them for an act done in the discharge of their duty.



**Mulling a movement:** Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi after an INDIA bloc meeting in Delhi on Wednesday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

While the INDIA bloc is now exploring ways to challenge the law, at Tuesday's Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting, senior advocate Abhishek Singhvi argued that court appeals often delayed matters. If a legal challenge by the Opposition was not upheld by the higher courts, the issue would not only appear as a setback but also legitimise the law, Mr. Singhvi is said to have argued.

**'Mobilise support'**

Several CWC members discussed other ways of building resistance to the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Mr. Singhvi argued that non-political actors could help mobilise public support, and cited the Cockroach Janta Party-led anti-paper leak protests as an example. He said the protests were effective in mobilising people and had also forced Dharmendra Pradhan to resign as the Education Minister.

However, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and Anand Sharma argued the Congress should take the lead, with other parties and movements joining it.

Another CWC member, Manish Tewari, said the Congress should mobilise every party workers and call them to Delhi to sit on an indefinite dharna, much like what the Punjab farmers did during their opposition to the three farm laws.

Several Congress leaders argued that the party now needed to move beyond courtroom technicalities and work with people who had lost their right to vote, turning the issue into a people's movement.

# EC extends SIR dates for A.P. and Meghalaya

**Sreeparna Chakrabarty**
NEW DELHI

A full bench of the Election Commission (EC) convened on Wednesday, in what was the second such meeting in four days, and decided to extend the dates for publication of the final electoral rolls in Andhra Pradesh (A.P.) and Meghalaya, which are among the States where the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is currently under way.

In the EC meeting, attended by Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, it was decided that the final voters' list of A.P. would be published on October 16 and that of Meghalaya on October 26. The dates had previously been October 3 for A.P. and October 7 for Meghalaya. The claims and objections period in A.P. has been extended until October 10.

According to sources, the Commission also took stock of the implementation of measures announced on September 26, which addressed concerns, including stopping physical hearings for voters who have been flagged under the unmapped or logical discrepancies categories.

# Govt. causing an ecological disaster in country: Cong.

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Referring to the ₹92,000-crore Great Nicobar Island project, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh on Wednesday said the Narendra Modi government was "mindlessly going ahead with inflicting this ecological disaster on our country".

Reacting to a report in *The Hindu* about the Union government moving the Supreme Court for a stay on hearings in the Calcutta High Court challenging the clearances for the project, the former Environment Minister said he hoped that the top court would let the final hearings continue before the High Court, where petitions have alleged that provisions of the Forest Rights Act, 2006, were violated in obtaining consent for the project.

*The Hindu* reported on Wednesday that the Union government had filed a petition in the Supreme Court seeking a stay on further proceedings in the matter before the Calcutta High Court.

Mr. Ramesh said the petitions in the High Court represented a "faint glimmer of hope" even as "various approvals under environment and forest laws have been deeply flawed, and the impact assessment reports are of dubious value".

"The High Court had upheld the right of the petitioner, who has been a very senior official in the Union Ministry of Environment... and the Ministry of Tribal Affairs, to file her challenge. Her right to challenge had been questioned by the Modi government, but that had been rejected by the High Court. Now, the government is making the same argument in the Supreme Court, which hopefully will allow the High Court to proceed on the matter as scheduled," he said.

# 'Fragmented' INDIA bloc is spreading misinformation: BJP

**Devesh K. Pandey**
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday hit out at the Congress and its allies, alleging that they were spreading misinformation and undermining democratic institutions. Defending voter-list verification, the BJP also took a jibe at the absence of some alliance partners from the meeting of the Indian National Developmental, Inclusive Alliance on the special intensive revision (SIR) exercise.

At a press conference, Union Minister and senior BJP leader Shivraj Singh Chouhan said the Congress had failed to introspect despite multiple defeats. "If they win, they hail democracy; if they lose, they condemn the Election Commission. This is their frustration over defeat," Mr. Chouhan said.



Shivraj Singh Chouhan

**'Will not improve'**

"The Congress has decided that it will not improve. Whether it is Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge*ji* or Rahul Gandhi*ji*, instead of apologising for their mistakes, they are spreading confusion. They are lying and making fabricated allegations," he said.

Referring to the INDIA bloc meeting, he said, "Even before the meeting, the alliance fell apart." He raised questions over the absence of Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam president M.K. Stalin, and Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal.

Mr. Chouhan alleged that the Opposition alliance had become badly fragmented, with its constituent parties going separate ways. "The truth is that the INDI Alliance is not ready to accept Rahul Gandhi as its leader... even the Congress itself does not have faith in him," the BJP leader said.

# SIR made so many eligible electors lose vote for the first time, says former CEC

**Sreeparna Chakrabarty**
NEW DELHI

When Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi found that their objections were not heard, especially regarding the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, they should not have stopped with dissent notes, says former Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) O.P. Rawat. Instead, the two Commissioners should have ensured all decisions taken against their will were annulled at the next meeting of the three-member commission, he said. The third member of the Election Commission is Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Slamming the way the SIR has been carried out, Mr. Rawat noted in an exclusive interview with *The Hindu* on Wednesday that this is the first time since Independence that so many eligible electors had lost their voting rights.

Mr. Sandhu and Mr. Joshi had formally objected to various aspects of the SIR, 14 times over a 10-month period. Their objections covered several EC decisions, including changes to Form 6, and the ECI-Net portal's added declaration asking new voters whether they or their parents or grandparents had appeared in the last SIR's electoral roll.



O.P. Rawat

"They had the majority [in the EC]. In the very next meeting, when their first objections were not heard, they should have annulled all decisions taken against the will of majority. They should have taken the right decision, which would have prevailed. So obviously, but they did not take that route," he said. Mr. Rawat helmed the poll body between January 23, 2018 and December 1, 2018. He had been an Election Commissioner from 2015.

**'No veto for CEC'**

Describing the EC's functioning, Mr. Rawat said that commission meetings are usually held regularly. Mr. Rawat said that when the members are not on the same page, meetings help them understand each other's point of view and bring about an agreement. In the "one in a million" occasion where consensus cannot be reached, he said, there is the recourse of voting, where the majority opinion prevails. "The Chief Election Commissioner himself does not have any veto," he said.

On the SIR process in West Bengal, he said the damage had already been done before the election. "Ninety-three per cent of deleted voters whose appeals have been decided by tribunals were found eligible, and they missed exercising their voting right. That is something very serious for a democracy," he said.

# Bengal SIR tribunal judge wants to quit over long commute

**Shiv Sahay Singh**
KOLKATA

A judge presiding over a special intensive revision (SIR) tribunal in West Bengal has offered to resign, citing the long commute between his residence and his place of work.

Justice Indrajit Chatterjee (retd), formerly judge at the Calcutta High Court, who is presiding over the appellate tribunal in Murshidabad district, has written to the Chief Justice of Calcutta High Court Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge, expressing his wish to discontinue with effect from November 2.

"The government is spending a lot on my vehicle and pilot car. But I have to commute 70 to 80 km from my residence, which takes three to four hours every day. It is difficult to continue under such circumstances," Justice Chatterjee told *The Hindu*.

He heads the SIR tribunal number 11, Murshidabad district, where the names of about 4.55 lakh electors have been deleted from the electoral rolls due to "logical discrepancies".

About 27.1 lakh voters were removed from the State's electoral rolls due to "logical discrepancies" before the Assembly election was held earlier this year. Over 22 lakh voters have filed appeals challenging their exclusion.

**SOUTHERN POWER DISTRIBUTION COMPANY OF TELANGANA LIMITED**
Energy Produced

**e-Procurement Tender Notice (Paper Notification)**

TGSPDCL intends to float tender for procurement of (a) Desktop Computers (b) 9.1 m/280 kgs PSCC Poles to various circles of TGSPDCL (c) 11 m/365 kgs PSCC Poles to various circles (d) 11 KV 200A (TT) GOAB Switches with Polymer Insulators (e) LT Distribution Boxes (SMC) of TGSPDCL on e-procurement platform.
For further details of each item above, please visit www.tgsouthernpower.org, www.tender.telangana.gov.in, www.auction.telangana.gov.in.
Phone : 040-23431360, 1033, 1035, 1026.

CHIEF ENGINEER (P&MM)
TGSPDCL, Hyderabad

R.O. No. : 594-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt: 30.09.2026

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ ଲିଃ
( ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
OPTCL Lifeline of Odisha
**ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED**
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007

**E-TCN NO.-CPC-85/2026-27:** OPTCL invites bids under single stage two part system from any bidder for Engineering, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of High Temperature Low Sag(HTLS) conductor after dismantling of ACSR Panther Conductor in existing 132kV Burla PH-Katapali Ckt-I&II line in Sambalpur District on Turnkey Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. The estimated cost of the tender is **Rs. 12,41,57,478/-**. The last date & time of Submission of Bid Dt. 27.10.2026 up to 12:45 P.M.

**E-TCN NO.- TW-IT/OT/01/2026-27:** Bids invited in e-tender mode from reputed bidders for Selection of vendor towards development of Geo-Fencing enabled iOS based mobile application in line with already developed android based OLAMP mobile application. Security audit and subsequent Annual Maintenance Contract (AMC) Support for three years. The estimated cost of the tender is **Rs. 24,42,600/-**. The bid shall be due on date 22.10.2026 13:30 Hrs.

For details, visit OPTCL's official website **http://www.optcl.co.in and www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL.** HIPR-63/2026-27
/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ଉନ୍ନୟନ ଓ ବିପଣନ ସମିତି
ପଞ୍ଚାୟତିରାଜ ଓ ପାନୀୟ ଜଳ ବିଭାଗ, ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାର
ORMAS BHUBANESWAR
**Odisha Rural Development & Marketing Society**
*creating competence and values in rural Odisha*
Panchayati Raj and DW Department, Government of Odisha

**NOTICE**

**Expression of Interest for Empanelment of PIAs under Captive Employment Category "A" for DDU-GKY 2.0 Projects in Odisha State**

No.2859 / PT1-ORMAS-SD-DDU-GKY-0007-2025 Date : 30.09.2026

Odisha Rural Development and Marketing Society (ORMAS), under the Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water Department, Government of Odisha, invites proposals from agencies registered with the Ministry of Rural Development (MoRD), Government of India and possessing a valid Permanent Registration Number (PRN), for empanelment and implementation of DDU-GKY 2.0 projects in the State of Odisha **under "Captive Employment Category- A".**

Interested agencies may submit their proposals through the DDU-GKY online portal of MoRD, Government of India **(https://kaushal.rural.gov.in)**, in accordance with the DDU-GKY 2.0 Operational Guidelines, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and other instructions issued by MoRD from time to time.

The last date for submission of proposals is **21st October 2026**. Detailed terms and conditions of the Expression of Interest (EOI) are available on the portal at **https://kaushal.rural.gov.in**

**Chief Executive Officer, ORMAS**

SIRD Campus, Unit - VIII, Bhubaneswar, Odisha - 751012
Tel # 0674 -2565870/71, E-mail : ormashq@gmail.com. URL : www.ormas.org

19001/275/2627 OIPR-19001/19004/1/26-27/0011

**Government of Odisha**
**Information & Public Relations Department**
**Lok Sampark Bhawan, Bhubaneswar**

* * * * *

**Request For Proposal (RFP) from the eligible bidders to Conceptualize, Design and Fabricate the Odisha Pavilion at India International Trade Fair (IITF)-2026, Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.**

**BIDDER'S DATA SHEET**

| Sl.No. | Particular | Details |
|---|---|---|
| 01. | Name of the Client | The Director, I&PR Department, Odisha |
| 02. | Method of Selection | Quality and Cost Based Selection (QCBS) Method |
| 03. | Date of the Issue of RFP | 30.09.2026 |
| 04. | Pre-Bid Consultation with intending bidders | 06.10.2026 at 11:30 AM |
| 05. | Venue of Pre-Bid Consultation | Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001 |
| 06. | RFP Due Date | 14.10.2026 by 05.00 PM |
| 07. | Date & Time of Opening of the Proposal | 15.10.2026 at 11:30 AM |
| 08. | Venue of Opening of Proposal | Conference Hall, Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001 |
| 09. | Address for Submission of Proposal | The Director, I & PR Department, Odisha Lok-Sampark Bhawan, Unit-V, Keshari Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751001 (Odisha), Telephone No-2394890, Email:fpiprodisha@gmail.com |
| 10. | Mode of Submission | ▸ Speed Post/Registered Post/Courier Service only<br>▸ Proposals submitted in any other mode and the ones received late will not be taken into consideration |

**DIRECTOR, I&PR**

15001/101/2627 OIPR-15001/15001/1/26-27/0101

## INBRIEF



### SC to hear plea against bail to Congress candidate on Oct. 5

The Supreme Court on Wednesday agreed to list for hearing a petition by the West Bengal government against the Calcutta High Court's grant of interim bail to Congress candidate Milan Pradhan to contest the Nandigram Assembly bypoll, while orally indicating that it may dismiss the challenge. Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, refused an urgent oral plea made by the State to hear the appeal on October 1. Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for West Bengal, said a listing on October 5 would make the petition infructuous. The polling for the constituency was scheduled the next day on October 6.

### Govt. to re-employ Dhirendra Ojha as Principal DG at PIB

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) has approved the re-employment of senior Indian Information Service official Dhirendra Ojha as Principal Director General, Press Information Bureau (PIB), on a contract basis for a period of one year beyond his superannuation on Wednesday. The order will be effective from October 1, 2026, to September 30, 2027, or until further orders, whichever is earlier, on the usual terms and conditions applicable to re-employed Central government officers, keeping the recruitment rules in abeyance.

# SC rules out total ban on firecrackers for Deepavali

Court sees worth in CSIR-NEERI report on new-generation joined green crackers with lower noise, particulate emissions, and solid waste generation; Bench mulls specific time windows for bursting

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

Ruling out a nationwide ban on firecrackers, the Supreme Court on Wednesday accepted suggestions by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI) for a "limited and conditional relaxation".

The court backed the premier scientific body's recommendations for manufacture of next-generation joined green crackers in compliance with applicable noise, emission, and safety requirements ahead of Deepavali festivities.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice M.M. Sundresh, Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, for the Centre, said CSIR-NEERI has recommended that green crackers conform to specifications/formulations tested and approved by the competent authority and are made exclusively by duly-licensed manufacturers.



The court says it will take a balanced view, particularly over anxiety of air pollution with the onset of winter. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

CSIR-NEERI has suggested that crackers must be within the prescribed noise limit of 125 dB (AI)/145 dB(C) peak and strictly fall within permissible emission brackets, Ms. Bhati said.

The law officer submitted that CSIR-NEERI has prescribed the shell size, shell number and bursting duration/time of green crackers, which showed less noise and emissions than conventional joined crackers. The scientific report underscored that these crackers should be free of banned chemical ingredients.

The CSIR-NEERI report on the "new-generation joined firecrackers" said a series of the green variety had been developed without the use of barium in their compositions. These crackers were different from the conventional ones in terms of shell/tube size, formulation, bursting duration, and frequency of bursting, with corresponding reductions in noise, particulate emissions and solid waste generation, the report said.

**30% reduction**

Tests conducted on them show a 30% reduction in emissions compared to conventional joined crackers. The shrinking of the shell size has also reduced solid waste generation from 4% up to 32%, the report said.

"The bursting time duration has increased five times in the next-generation joined green crackers," the report noted.

The court said it would take a balanced view on the issue of firecrackers, particularly with apprehensions of air pollution with the onset of winter and the festive season.

"Total ban will hurt certain sentiments. We will not agree on a total ban across the country. At the same time, we will not allow a 24-hour bursting anywhere, as it affects the sick, the elderly, and children," the Bench remarked orally.

The court said it would look into directing specific time windows for bursting crackers.

The court gave more time to the Central Pollution Control Board and the Union government to continue with further barium and joined firecracker tests to test decibel levels.

# Stricter laws against online pornography needed, say activists

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Social activists and advocates on Wednesday called for stronger legal safeguards against unrestricted access to pornographic and sexually explicit content online, particularly for children and adolescents, in the wake of a series of cases of rape lately, and in the more recent instance the gang-rape of a minor near a Delhi college.

The issue was not merely about regulating digital content but about the safety of women and children, prevention of sexual violence, and the social environment in which India's younger generation is growing up, former Central Information Commissioner Uday Mahurkar said at a press conference.

The press conference was also addressed by Yogita Bhayana, founder of People Against Rape in India; Vishnu Shankar Jain, advocate-on-record in the Supreme Court; Sanjeev Newar, founder of Sewa Nyay Utthan and Rashtra Jyoti; Vineet Jindal, advocate and social activist; and Amita Sachdev, Supreme Court advocate.

The government's action against 25 OTT platforms carrying obscene content in 2025 was a step in the right direction, Mr. Mahurkar said, but called for stringent laws. His memorandum to Prime Minister Narendra Modi sought a dedicated law to prevent persons below 18 from accessing pornographic and obscene content, robust age verification, and greater platform accountability.

A blanket ban on minors using social media could be considered, as done in Australia, he said, adding that laws prohibiting minors from accessing pornographic content were in place in 16 countries. The memorandum suggested amendments to the Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act, 1986, and proposed 10 years' imprisonment, no bail for three years, and attachment of properties of convicted offenders.

Prevention must begin before a crime is committed by protecting children from influences that can distort their understanding of sex, consent, and human relationships, Ms. Bhayana said.

## *On the draw*




# Punjab Congress chief offers to quit

**Press Trust of India**
CHANDIGARH

Punjab Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring has offered to resign from his post following weeks of infighting in the State unit, party sources said on Wednesday.

Former Minister and MP Vijay Inder Singla has emerged as the front-runner for the post ahead of the 2027 Assembly polls, they said. The Congress high command has informed Mr. Warring of its decision to replace him, following which he has offered to resign, the sources said. The announcement of a new Punjab Congress chief is expected soon.

# NCERT textbook revives debatable theory on *Sengol* handed to Nehru at Independence

**Maitri Porecha**
NEW DELHI

The Union government's claim that a *Sengol*, which is a sceptre anointed by Hindu religious leaders, marked the transfer of power in 1947 when India became Independent, finds a mention in the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT)'s newly released Class 9 social science textbook.

The new textbook, *Understanding Society: India and Beyond - Part Two,* says, "The *Sengol*, a cultural marker of rulership and good governance, was placed in India's newly inaugurated Parliament building in 2023 by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The tradition of using the *Sengol* as a mark of righteous governance began more than a thousand years ago during the reign of Chola dynasty," the textbook reads.

"To mark the occasion of India's Independence, at the stroke of midnight on 15 August 1947, the first Prime Minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, received the *Sengol* from the Adheenam saints (an old Shaivite tradition) of Tamil Nadu," it says.

**Ethical responsibilities**

Describing the *Sengol*, the website of the Union Culture Ministry says, "Once integral to the coronation rites of Tamil monarchs, the *Sengol* was not merely a ceremonial object but a profound testament to the ethical responsibilities bestowed upon a ruler. This sacred tradition was momentously revived on the eve of India's independence in 1947, when a *Sengol* was solemnly presented to Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru. It marked the 'civilisationally rooted' transfer of authority from colonial rule to a sovereign Indian state."



The *Sengol*, a sceptre from Tamil Nadu, that was installed in the new Parliament building in May 2023. FILE PHOTO

This theory has been contradicted time and again by experts. For instance, historian and biographer of C. Rajagopalachari, Rajmohan Gandhi has earlier said in public domain during the inauguration of the new Parliament building that there is no record of the *Sengol* serving as a formal symbol of the "transfer of power", in the personal papers, letters or autobiographies of either Nehru or Rajaji.

Historian Aditya Mukherjee had also criticised the 2023 ceremony and the installation of the *Sengol*, stating that the event was an effort of political self-glorification rather than celebrating parliamentary democracy.

The textbook says India's national motto – *Satyameva Jayate* – is linked to Mundaka Upanishad replacing the British-era "Heaven's Light, Our Guide". The textbook says the Supreme Court's post-Independence motto *Yato Dharmastato Jayah*, which translates into "Where there is righteous duty, there is victory", is linked to the Mahabharata. This is stated in the chapter "Governance and Public Policy" of the new textbook.

The chapter links Mahatma Gandhi's reference to *Ram Rajya*, which is an ideal governance structure based on probity, transparency, compassion, and welfare, to the Ramayana and the 16th century literary work *Ramcharitmanas*, calling these two texts "examples of good governance and good collective life".

**'Sacred responsibility'**

The textbook says that from the Vedic period to the Ramayana and Mahabharata, Indian traditions viewed governance as a "sacred responsibility" rather than merely a means of exercising power.

The chapter says that colonial powers imposed their models of governance on societies which had previously followed "local and organic systems", and that many colonial institutions have continued since Independence.

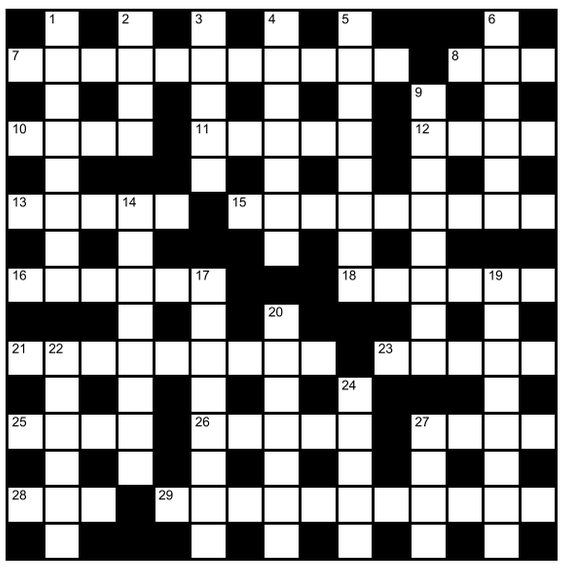
In another chapter titled "Resistance and Resilience", the textbook says many kings and princes are believed to have received swords from goddesses such as Kali, Durga and Bhavani to resist invasions since the 7th century.

## TH CROSSWORD + 14912

(set by Hypatia)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



**Across**

**7** Fan boy dancing around extremely brave girl in main area (3,2,6)
**8** Cool stuff kept in kitchen, frequently (3)
**10** Breakfast food includes deliciously light item for starters (4)
**11** Place with bars in state wasting bachelor's time? (5)
**12** Right from list in podcast (4)
**13** In France, good backing the aristocrat (5)
**15** British actors terribly bored by promotion in show (9)
**16** Model on magazine / paper (6)
**18** Daughter first abandoned strays (6)
**21** Doctor to those having power — a therapist (9)
**23** Categories of nasty pests (5)
**25** Mammals oddly avoided a plant (4)
**26** Fleece customers at the end, after independent portraits (5)
**27** Daily plan's incomplete (4)
**28** Snake vanishing with insect (3)
**29** Peril of an important position (4,7)

**Down**

**1** Style of cooking indoor at spreads (8)
**2** Drive near huge unending desert (4)
**3** Boat capsizing every now and then had to sink (5)
**4** Secures Emcees (7)
**5** Spooner's simple palm accessory (8)
**6** Entrance of conservative church blocked behind (6)
**9** Enthusiasm of star ultimately settling in American Hollywood's home (8)
**14** Criminal saves gal in Sin City (3,5)
**17** Obscene clip shot in retreat (8)
**19** Tips from Spooner to understand stories (8)
**20** Decline an award (7)
**22** Almost identical like old inverted triangular snack (6)
**24** Unlawfully seize using reprobate political leaders! (5)
**27** Outlet that serves public a few sandwiches (4)

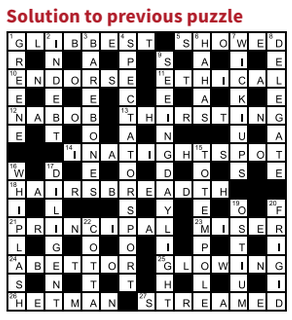
## SUDOKU

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**Solution to previous puzzle**



**Solution to yesterday's Sudoku**

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| 3 | 6 | 9 | 2 | 7 | 8 | 4 | 1 | 5 |
| 7 | 2 | 4 | 1 | 5 | 3 | 9 | 6 | 8 |
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| 4 | 5 | 8 | 3 | 1 | 9 | 6 | 7 | 2 |
| 2 | 9 | 7 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 1 | 4 | 3 |

## FAITH

### Mighty Garuda

Garuda flew to devaloka at great speed to get the pot of nectar, which Indra was guarding. Garuda had to give the nectar to Kadru to free his mother from her. Indra was terrified by Garuda's speed. He asked all the devas to use their might against Garuda. But they were powerless against Garuda. Indra himself began to fight Garuda. Finally, Indra threw the vajrayudha at him. The vajrayudha had been fashioned with the bone of sage Dadichi. But even the vajrayudha could not harm Garuda, said Thenthirupperai Aravindalochanan in a discourse. However, Garuda did not want to disrespect a weapon made with a sage's bone. So, he dropped a feather, which was beautiful and glowed like gold. He thus came to be known as Suparna – the one with a lovely feather.

Garuda is an auspicious bird. It is said that if you see a jackal, it is a good sign, but if you hear it howling, it is a bad omen. But in the case of Garuda, it is auspicious to see him and to hear him. Undeterred by Indra's weapons, Garuda proceeded towards the nectar. Above the pot was a circle of fire. But Garuda was able to take the pot. Indra appealed to Vishnu for help, for if Kadru's children, who were snakes, consumed nectar, they would be immortal. It would be a danger to everyone if venomous snakes were immortal. Vishnu confronted Garuda and after fighting him, He offered him two boons. But Garuda offered the Lord two boons. Garuda became the Lord's mount and His flag. The Lord also told him how he could give the nectar to Kadru, but prevent the snakes from eating it. Thus, Garuda saved his mother, without making the snakes immortal.

# Srinivasan approaches Charity Commissioner against Tata trust

**Lalatendu Mishra**
MUMBAI

The power struggle within the Tata Trusts has taken a fresh turn with Venu Srinivasan, trustee of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT), approaching the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner demanding immediate probe into the trust's administration and governance.

Mr. Srinivasan said the move was necessary to "preserve the institutional integrity and proper administration of SDTT."

SDTT, the lead Tata Trust with a 27.98% stake in Tata Sons, has emerged as a key player in the ongoing developments at the group's holding company.

The second-largest trust, the Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which holds 23.56%, has had its voting rights effectively paralysed since May after the Charity Commissioner began examining a complaint filed earlier by Mr. Srinivasan in his capacity as an SRTT trustee.

**Jeopardising status**

In his complaint, Mr. Srinivasan said SDTT's growing involvement in Tata Sons' commercial and strategic decisions could jeopardise its charitable status.

"SDTT is a public charitable trust and its substantial shareholding in Tata Sons cannot result in the Trust itself assuming the functions of a commercial enterprise or participating directly in the conduct of Tata Sons' business affairs," he said.

Citing recent Tata Trusts announcements, Mr. Srinivasan alleged the trusts, through their chairman and operating team, had taken a direct role in identifying, negotiating and implementing major commercial decisions involving Tata Sons – activities, he claimed, were beyond their charitable mandate.

**Tax implications**

He warned such a conduct could expose SDTT's charitable corpus to significant tax implications under provisions governing non-profit organisations' commercial activities.

"Such conduct constitutes mismanagement of the affairs and property of SDTT and a breach of duties owed by its trustees," he said.

Mr. Srinivasan also accused SDTT of attempting to influence the independent functioning of nominee directors on the Tata Sons board. Referring to SDTT's September 16 circular restraining him from participating in or voting on the proposed listing of Tata Sons, he said the move was "an extraordinary attempt to prevent me from exercising independent judgment and vote."

The complaint seeks a probe into the appointment and continuation of Noel N. Tata as perpetual trustee and Chairman of Tata Trusts, the appointment of his son Neville N. Tata, his [Mr. Srinivasan] exclusion from related decision-making processes, and the role of SDTT trustees in Tata Sons' affairs.

Mr. Srinivasan has also sought directions preventing Mr. Noel Tata from participating in SDTT decisions related to appointing or instructing Tata Sons nominees or exercising voting rights on behalf of the trust at Tata Sons' general meetings.

The confrontation follows the September 17 Tata Sons board meet where Mr. Srinivasan supported another term for chairman N. Chandrasekaran and compliance with RBI's directive on listing Tata Sons. Mr. Noel Tata had opposed both the moves.

## INBRIEF



### Apple Pay goes live in India with Axis Bank-issued cards

Apple launched Apple Pay in India – a payment feature that lets iPhone, iPad, and Apple Watch users make payments using Axis Bank-issued Visa and Mastercard cards. Support for Mac is coming soon, according to an official press release. With Apple Pay, users can make payments without having to type in PINs or OTPs. To make the payment, users will have to activate their devices and verify their identity if needed, before holding the device near a contactless reader. Concerning safety, Apple Pay customers' card numbers are not stored on the device or Apple servers.

### RoSCTL, RoDTEP schemes extended by Union govt.

The Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry and the Ministry of Textiles have extended the Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products Scheme and Rebate of State and Central Taxes and Levies Scheme respectively till December 31, 2026. In orders issued on September 30, the Ministries said the schemes will continue for exporters till the end of December this year without any change in the rates and structure.

# Centre notifies CAFE norms, tightens PVs' fuel-efficiency targets

Tighter fuel-consumption targets from 2027–32 will also offer credits for hybrids, flex-fuel vehicles, biofuels and efficiency technologies

**Jagriti Chandra**
NEW DELHI

The Centre has notified the third phase of carbon emission norms for passenger vehicles (PVs_, effective from April 1, 2027 to March 31, 2032, under which each battery electric vehicle (EV) will count as three vehicles toward a carmaker's fleet-efficiency calculation, while other cleaner technologies and biofuel-based vehicles will receive specified credits.

Under the new norms, the fuel-consumption benchmark will be tightened from 3.996 litre per 100 km in 2027-28 to 3.3273 litre per 100 km in 2031-32, amounting to an improvement of about 16.7% over the five-year period. The new norms will apply to new passenger vehicles manufactured or imported for sale in India.



**New template:** The norms broadly cover passenger cars, including hatchbacks, sedans and special utility vehicles . GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

The Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE) norms use 1,229 kg as the reference vehicle weight. The earlier concession for small cars weighing up to 909 kg has been removed following a pitched fight that split the auto industry.

The fleet's average fuel consumption will be calculated using the Modified Indian Driving Cycle (MIDC) and expressed in petrol-equivalent litre per 100 km. For individual models, fuel consumption will be calculated using their notified tailpipe $CO_2$ emissions. Diesel, LPG, CNG and electric vehicles will be converted into petrol-equivalent figures using specified conversion factors. For electric vehicles, energy consumption will be measured in kWh per 100 km.

# Trump, firms pledge AI safety; experts flag lack of enforcement

**Balasubramanyam C.P.**
CHENNAI

U.S. President Donald Trump and the heads of six major technology firms signed a voluntary accord committing frontier AI developers to a four-layer system of safety controls, including internal monitoring, independent external evaluations and board-level oversight.

The "White House Accord on Super Intelligence: Joint Commitment on Frontier Responsibilities" was signed by Google CEO Sundar Pichai, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei, Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg, OpenAI President Greg Brockman, xAI CEO Elon Musk and Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang.

The accord says companies training and deploying frontier models should put in place internal controls to monitor models' capabilities and alignment, including risks. The controls should ensure AI models do not hack or access technical systems.

The voluntary nature of the commitment, however, has raised questions about how effective the framework can be.



AI developers commit to four layers of safety controls.

Gaurav Vasu, founder of Unearthinsight, described the accord as a positive step, but said its effectiveness would depend on whether firms act on safety findings, when fixing a problem could delay a product launch or affect revenue.

Vaibhav Tare, Chief Information Security Officer at Fulcrum Digital, said board-level oversight was a necessary step, but AI governance could not remain limited to policy documents and periodic audits.

# Cabinet okays rabi MSP hike for 2027-28

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved the increase in the Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for all mandated Rabi crops for the marketing season 2027-28, with safflower receiving the biggest increase, the government announced.

"Under the leadership of PM Narendra Modi, the government has a clear policy decision that farmers should get a profit of at least 50% or more over their average cost of production," Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan said at a press conference following the Cabinet decision.

"In line with this, the MSP announced for Rabi marketing season 2027-28 carries a margin of 50% to 106% over the all-India weighted average cost of production."

The MSP for safflower was increased by ₹675 per quintal to ₹7,215 per quintal, an increase of 10.3% over its level in the previous year.

### AM Green bags €585 mn green ammonia deal

**The Hindu Bureau**
HYDERABAD

AM Green Ammonia (India) secured a long-term pact to supply renewable fuels of non-biological origin (RFNBO) ammonia to Germany after emerging as the sole winner of the Asian lot in the H2Global auction conducted by HINT.CO GmbH (Hintco).

Under the pact, Hintco will buy the ammonia from AM Green for a minimum value of €585 million over 10 years. The firm may also secure additional volumes quoted by AM Green, using proceeds from the resale of green ammonia in the European market.

# IRDAI's new 'norms' ruffle feathers of LIC agents, broker body

**N. Ravi Kumar**
HYDERABAD

Voicing concerns over the impact of the reforms IRDAI is proposing to norms governing distribution, commissions and expenses, Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) agents urged the insurance regulator to consider the likely repercussions on jobs and livelihoods.

Cost efficiency should not be pursued in a manner that reduces the number of active agents or makes the profession economically unsustainable. The primary objective of distribution reform should ultimately be to increase insurance coverage and improve policyholder outcomes, said the Life Insurance Agents' Federation of India (LIAFI) in its responses to IRDAI. Meanwhile, brokers under IBAI also expressed concern.




IRDAI's proposed reforms irk LIC agents, brokers.

### Govt. end-Aug. fiscal deficit hits 41.9% of 2026-27 target

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

A rise in subsidy spending, particularly on fertilizers, led to the Centre's fiscal deficit touching 41.9% of budgeted target for 2026-27 as of August vis a vis 38.1% at this point last year.

Data released by the Controller General of Accounts show the Centre's total revenue stood at ₹13.7 lakh crore in April-August 2026 this financial year, while total expenditure stood at ₹20.8 lakh crore.

As of August, total capital expenditure stood at 41.7% of the budgeted target while it was 38.5% at this point last year.

# Cabinet approves ₹1.86 lakh crore Green Energy Corridor

**Saptaparno Ghosh**
NEW DELHI

The Union Cabinet announced the third phase of the Green Energy Corridor (GEC) that seeks to integrate up to 135 gigawatts of renewable energy into grids across States and Union Territories by fiscal year 2032-33.

The scheme would further strive to address curtailment, that is a situation when grid operators limit the power output from renewable sources to maintain grid stability.



**Power play:** About ₹1.36 lakh crore would be spent on developing intra-state transmission systems in phase 3. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

*The Hindu* had reported August 10 that the government was in the final planning stages of instituting the third phase of the GEC.

**Project outlay**

The third phase of the scheme accounts for a total project outlay of more than ₹1.86 lakh crore.

This comprises ₹1.36 lakh crore for developing intra-state transmission systems in the third phase. As a first, the latest phase of GEC also provisions a ₹50,000-crore dedicated component for deploying 50 GWh of battery energy storage system (BESS).

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, P.W.D. DISTT.DN.II, UDAIPUR**

No. : 891 Date : 24.09.2026

**Notice Inviting Bid No. 13/2026-27**
**NIB No. : PWD2627A2921**

Bids for ML/NP Road Yr. 2026-27 works etc. are invited from interested bidders upto 28.09.2026 10.00 AM to 12.10.2026 04.00 PM. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal ("http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in" and "http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in") of the state, and department website. The approximate value of procurement of **2 work is Rs. 316.84 Lacs.**

1. **UBN No. : PWD2627WSOB13119**
2. **UBN No. : PWD2627WSOB13121**

**(Anil Khichi)**
Executive Engineer,
PWD Distt.Dn.II, Udaipur

DIPR/C/16548/2026

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER**
**PWD DIVISION BEAWAR**

**Notice Inviting Bid No. 12/2026-27**

**Bids for 06 No. of Works** are invited from interested bidders **upto 06.00 PM 05 Oct 2026**. Other particular of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in) of the State, and DIPR departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is **Rs. 443.22 Lacs**.

| S No. | NIB NO | UBIN NO | Amount (Lac) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | PWD2627A2973 | PWD2627WSOB13394 | 214.12 |
| 2 | PWD2627A2974 | PWD2627WSOB13395 | 113.18 |
| 3 | PWD2627A2975 | PWD2627WSOB13398 | 87.81 |
| 4 | PWD2627A2976 | PWD2627WSOB13399 | 8.63 |
| 5 | PWD2627A2977 | PWD2627WSOB13401 | 17.26 |
| 6 | PWD2627A2978 | PWD2627WSOB13402 | 2.22 |

(Naresh Shersiya)
Executive Engineer
PWD, Division Beawar

DIPR/C/16723/2026

**कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण खण्ड दूदू जिला जयपुर**
**पंचायत समिति परिसर दूदू, जयपुर**
E-mail:- eewdsc.dudu@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक:- 1301-1307 दिनांक: 24.09.2026

**ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या- 13/2026-27**

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से मुख्यमंत्री जल स्वावलम्बन अभियान 2.0 योजना के द्वितीय तथा तृतीय चरण अर्न्तगत जिला जयपुर के ब्लॉक मौजमाबाद एवं दूदू में फार्म पौण्ड, तालाब रिनोवेशन तथा आर.टी.डब्ल्यू.एच.एस. मय दोष निवारण के लिए उपर्युक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग/जल संसाधन विभाग/ग्रामीण विकास एवं पंचायती राज विभाग में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्रीय सरकार के अधिकृत संगठनों/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/डाक एवं दूर संचार विभाग/रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के विभिन्न सक्षम श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हो, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-टेण्डरिंग प्रक्रिया द्वारा दिनांक 24.09.2026 से दिनांक 12.10.2026 को सायं 06:00 बजे तक ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती है। दिनांक 13.10.2026 को सुबह 11:00 बजे कार्यालय में खोली जावेगी। निविदा का विस्तृत विवरण **https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in, https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** एवं विभागीय वेबसाईट **www.watershed.gov.in** पर देखा जा सकता है।

**NIB CODE:- WSC2627A1363**
**UBN No.:-** 1. (WSC2627WSOB02436) 2. (WSC2627WSOB02437) 3. (WSC2627WSOB02438) 4. (WSC2627WSOB02439) 5. (WSC2627WSOB02440) 6. (WSC2627WSOB02441)

(प्रीति सुमन मट्ठ)
अधिशाषी अभियंता
जलग्रहण विकास एवं भू-संरक्षण
पंचायत समिति दूदू जयपुर

DIPR/C/16502/2026

**CENTRAL ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION**
6th, 7th, & 8th Floor, Tower-B, World Trade Centre, Nauroji Nagar, New Delhi-110029
**Petition No. 489/TD/2026** **Dated: 29.9.2026**

**NOTICE UNDER CLAUSE (a) OF SUB-SECTION (5) OF SECTION 15 OF THE ELECTRICITY ACT, 2003 (the Act)**

An application for the grant of a Category-IV licence for inter-State trading in electricity across India has been made before the Commission by **Terra Clean Limited,** NBCC Commercial Space, 10th floor, Tower 2, Kidwai Nagar, Sarojini Nagar, South West Delhi, Delhi-110023.

2. A copy of the application, along with its annexures and enclosures, made by the applicant for the grant of an inter-State trading licence to Terra Clean Limited before the Commission can be accessed at the website **https://terraclean.in** or inspected by any person in the Commission's office by following the laid down procedure.

3. On consideration of the material available on record, the Commission is satisfied that prima facie the applicant qualifies for the grant of a licence for inter-State trading in electricity and by order dated 29.9.2026, the Commission has proposed to grant a Category-IV licence to the applicant for inter-State trading in electricity across India.

4. Notice is hereby given in pursuance of clause (a) of sub-section (5) of Section 15 of the Act to invite suggestions or objections, if any, to the proposal to grant the licence for inter-State trading in electricity as aforesaid by the Commission to be received by the undersigned latest by **21.10.2026** at the above noted address. The objections or suggestions received after the specified date shall not be considered.

5. The Commission has fixed the application for final disposal on **23.10.2026** and the person who files the suggestions or objections may in his discretion attend the hearing, for which no TA/DA shall be paid by the Commission.

**Sd/-**
**(Harpreet Singh Pruthi)**
**Secretary**

**GREATER VISAKHAPATNAM MUNICIPAL CORPORATION**

**Tender Notice No. 04/2026-27/CE/SE(P)/EE(PD-I)/GVMC/Dt:30-09-2026**

Name of Work:- Replacement of warnout pumps with Energy Efficient pumps and arrangement of SCADA for monitoring and accountability of sewer water from Viman nagar & Gopalapatnam Pump houses to fullfill the sewer water to 108 MLD STP at Narava

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. No. of Works | : | 1 (One) |
| 2. Value of works (ECV) | : | **Rs.2.49 Crores** |
| 3. Downloading Starting Date | : | 30-09-2026 @ 7.00 PM |
| 4. Downloading End Date | : | 08-10-2026 @ 3.00 PM |
| 5. Last date for Submission of bid | : | 08-10-2026 @ 4.00 PM |

Further details at **http://www.apeprocurement.gov.in**
O/o the Executive Engineer (PD-I) Division:**9848308824** **For Commissioner**

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For pre-qualification criteria and other details visit website https://eprocurebel.co.in. All Corrigendum / Amendments / Changes, if any will be issued and made available on Website https://eprocurebel.co.in. No Corrigendum / Amendments / Changes will be issued in Newspapers. Hence, prospective agencies are advised to keep visiting the Website https://eprocurebel.co.in on regular basis.

**Sd/-**
**DY. GEN. MANAGER**
**(SAMVIDA & KRYA / ES)**

DATE : 01.10.2026

**'Har Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam'**

PARIS

## Eiffel Tower chief to step down after controversy during BAPS visit



AFP

Patrick Branco Ruivo, the head of the company that runs the Eiffel Tower, will step down at the end of the year after female staff at the landmark building in Paris were excluded during a visit by a Hindu religious group, BAPS. The decision is after a probe uncovered a series of operational failures in relation to the September 5 visit. AP

BRUSSELS

## Russia sends nuclear warning to NATO as tensions rise in the Baltic



AFP

Russia has warned NATO it would be ready to resort to nuclear weapons if the Western alliance attempted to cut off Kaliningrad, a Russian exclave that borders the Baltic Sea. In a document sent to NATO, Moscow accused the alliance of a "dangerous course" that entailed "high risks of outbreak of a direct armed conflict". REUTERS

KABUL

## Afghanistan claims its forces killed 41 insurgents crossing from Pak.



AFP

Afghanistan's Defence Ministry says its forces have killed more than 40 fighters it described as insurgents who crossed into the country from neighbouring Pakistan, and captured dozens more over three days amid repeated clashes along the tense border. The insurgents included members of the Islamic State group, it said. AP

WASHINGTON

## U.S. to hike EB-5 Green Card fees; charges to take effect on Nov. 30




ISTOCKPHOTO

The U.S. has decided to increase fees for immigrants seeking to invest in America and eventually claim permanent residency (Green Card) under the EB-5 investor programme, with new charges taking effect on November 30. The filing fee for Form I-526, used by standalone investors, will rise from $3,675 to $7,615. PTI

# Iran says it has received an official U.S. response to its offer to end war

Iranian officials have not disclosed whether Washington accepted or rejected the proposal; Araghchi briefs Pezeshkian and the Cabinet, with Iranian President calling for a 'win-win strategy'; Trump earlier rejected the offer, calling it 'unacceptable'

**Associated Press**
DUBAI

Iranian officials indicated on Wednesday they have received an official U.S. response to Tehran's latest proposal to end the seven-month war, which U.S. President Donald Trump had publicly rejected just days earlier.

The officials did not say what the response contained, and whether it was a rejection or not.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi presented the U.S. response to President Masoud Pezeshkian at a Cabinet meeting, government spokesperson Fatemeh Mohajerani told the state-run *IRNA* news agency. "We will make every effort to bring the agreement to fruition and will firmly stand up for the rights of the Iranian people," Mr. Pezeshkian said. "The agreement must now be based on a win-win strategy."



Abbas Araghchi speaks to the media during the 81st session of the UN General Assembly at United Nations headquarters. AP

The Cabinet meeting follows Mr. Araghchi's return to Iran after travelling to New York for the UN General Assembly last week. While there, officials held indirect talks with U.S. officials and also met with Qatari and Pakistani mediators on the sidelines of the annual gathering of world leaders.

Mr. Araghchi briefed the Cabinet on his trip to New York and the meetings he held there, including Iran's conditions for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, which Ms. Mohajerani said had been conveyed through mediators.

Mr. Araghchi last week said he floated the proposal to reopen the strait in a week if the U.S. agreed to lift its blockade of Iranian ports, release frozen Iranian assets and waive sanctions on Iranian oil sales, among other conditions.

Mr. Trump swiftly rejected the proposal, saying Iran wanted to make a deal because it was "losing so badly" but that its offer "would not be acceptable".

Meanwhile, the U.S. Treasury Department, as part of "Operation Economic Outcast" campaign, unveiled new sanctions on Tuesday targeting people and companies around the globe that it accuses of being financial facilitators or enablers of Iran's military supply chain.

# Full re-entry into EU is an option for U.K.: Burnham

**Sriram Lakshman**
LONDON

The U.K. rejoining the European Union (EU) was an option for the country, British Prime Minister Andy Bunrham said on Wednesday, a day after he told the Labour party conference in Liverpool that the country had to decide on the kind of long-term ties it wanted with the bloc.

The Prime Minister had said that Brexit had "caused more harm than good" yesterday in Liverpool. The question of reversing Brexit, Britain's departure from the bloc in 2016, would likely be a deeply divisive process as Brexit itself was.

"We could stay as we are...if people think this is the right place to stay," Mr. Burnham told *BBC Radio 4's Today* programme on Wednesday.



Andy Burnham

Other options would include looking at a customs union as suggested by former Conservative Chancellor George Osbone, or entering the Single Market (area for free movement of goods, services, people and capital) as suggested by the Liberal Democrats, Mr. Burnham said.

"...Or we could go all the way," he said, suggesting the U.K. could become part of the EU again.

The options would have to be weighed as per their pros and cons, Mr. Burnham said.

Prior to becoming Prime Minister, Mr. Burnham had said he was not looking to take the country back into the bloc but had said he hoped the return to the EU would happen during his lifetime.

Under his predecessor Keir Starmer's administration, the U.K. was in the process of strengthening ties with the EU, its largest trading partner. The Starmer government had launched a new 'U.K.-EU Strategic Partnership' which sought greater collaboration on defence, security, youth mobility and agriculture among other sectors.

# 23 years after invasion, U.S. troops pull out of Iraq; Iran's influence stays

NEWS ANALYSIS

**Stanly Johny**

On May 1, 2003, nearly two months after launching the invasion of Iraq, the then U.S. President George W. Bush landed on the deck of the aircraft carrier *USS Abraham Lincoln*, which was off the San Diego coast after returning from combat operations in the Persian Gulf.

Arriving in a Lockheed S-3 Viking and dressed in a flight suit, Mr. Bush posed for photographs with pilots and crew members. A few hours later, he announced the end of major combat operations in Iraq. "In this battle, we have fought for the cause of liberty and for the peace of the world. Our nation and our coalition are proud of this accomplishment, yet it is you, the members of the United States military, who achieved it," Mr. Bush said from the flight deck of the carrier. Above him hung the warship's now-famous banner: "Mission Accomplished".

Except that it wasn't. On September 30, more than 23 years after Mr. Bush gave his "mission accomplished" speech, the U.S. forces withdrew from their last military base in Iraq, wrapping up their combat operations and leaving the country in the hands of a divided government and powerful Iran-backed Shia militias. Iran, which is currently at war with the U.S., and the militias have welcomed the U.S. withdrawal as a victory.



Members of the Iraqi security forces drive in a convoy as they celebrate the U.S. withdrawal, in Najaf, Iraq, on Wednesday. REUTERS

### Stuck in Iraq

The U.S. invaded Iraq saying Saddam Hussein's regime had possessed weapons of mass destruction and harboured al-Qaeda terrorists. The invasion was the second stop in Mr. Bush's 'war on terrorism'.

Before launching the attack, Mr. Bush had grouped Iraq, Iran, and North Korea together as the 'Axis of Evil', indicating that Iran could be the next target. The claim about weapons of mass destruction turned out to be false. Al-Qaeda gained a foothold in Iraq only after the U.S. invasion toppled the Saddam Hussein regime.

Al-Qaeda in Iraq (AQI), one of the most violent branches of the terrorist organisation, later transformed into the Islamic State of Iraq and Syria (ISIS) and spread terror across the region and beyond. Iraq also fell into a deadly sectarian civil war between Shias and Sunnis.

Perhaps the most consequential effect of the invasion was the expansion of Iranian influence across Iraq. Saddam's Iraq, which had fought an eight-year-long war with Iran, had remained a buffer between the Islamic Republic and Gulf monarchies.

Once Saddam was gone, Iran, which had built historical ties with Iraq's Shia parties that had been suppressed by the Baathist regime, extended and deepened its reach. It also supported Shia militias with money, weapons and training to trap U.S. forces, as Tehran feared that the U.S. could turn against Iran next if it managed to stabilise Iraq.

### Forever war

Over the past 23 years, the U.S. had spent some $1.7 trillion and lost 4,500 troops in Iraq. Hundreds of thousands of Iraqis were also killed during the war.

In 2011, the then President Barack Obama had announced an end to U.S. combat operations in Iraq. But after the Islamic State captured huge swathes of territory in Iraq, including Mosul, the second largest city, U.S. troops returned to fight IS terrorists.

Since then the U.S. had retained some 2,500 troops, mostly in its bases in Erbil, in Iraqi Kurdistan. All these troops are now being withdrawn. Some marines will remain in the country to protect U.S. diplomatic missions.

President Trump says Iraq can now take care of its own security and hence the U.S. troops are no longer needed. But the ground situation is a lot more complex.

U.S. troops came under increasing attack from Iran-backed Shia militias in recent years. The militias are powerful political and military entities today. Even though the Iraqi government has pushed them to disarm, it has faced severe resistance.

After the U.S. war on Iran began on February 28, the militias, loosely called Popular Mobilisation Units (Hashad al-Shabi), have stepped up their attacks on U.S. forces.

In the first two months of the war, Iran and the Shia militias launched more than 600 attacks on U.S. military and diplomatic facilities in Iraq. The U.S. found it increasingly difficult to keep a large group of troops in a region that's turning hostile, and Mr. Trump decided to stick to the Biden-era deadline of completing the withdrawal by September 30.

### Shifting balance

Even though Iran built deep influence in Iraq through Shia political parties and militias after the American invasion, the presence of U.S. troops and an autonomous Kurdistan closely aligned with Washington provided a counterweight, maintaining a balance between the two rival centres of power.

With the U.S. troops leaving, that balance could tilt further in Iran's favour.

When U.S. air strikes killed Abu Mahdi al-Muhandis, the commander of Hashad, along with Qassem Soleimani, in January 2020, many saw it as a major blow to Iraq's Shia militias. Six years later, as U.S. troops leave the last of their bases in Iraq, Hashad appears to be more deeply entrenched than ever. So is Iran.

**ONE TIME REPAIR OF 20 (TWENTY) NOS. SCR ASSEMBLY**

**Tender No. 140-SGUD-SCR-Repair-2026 Dated: 28-09-2026.** Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Name of work:** One time repair of 20 (Twenty) nos. SCR assembly (GRAU make) in Siemens (S3) type locos at Diesel Loco Shed, Siliguri for a period of 02 (Two) years. **Tender Value:** ₹ 1,07,47,440/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹2,15,000/-. **Date & Time of closing of Tender:** At **15.00** hrs. on **19-10-2026.** The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website **www.ireps.gov.in**

Sr. DME, Diesel Loco Shed, Siliguri Jn.

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**METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION (CHENNAI) LIMITED**
**PALLAVAN ILLAM, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI - 600 002.**
**e-TENDER NOTICE**

e-TENDER ARE INVITED FOR THE SUPPLY, TESTING & COMMISSIONING OF 33 KV OUTDOOR POWER TRANSFORMER, VACUUM CIRCUIT BREAKER PANELS AND HT RING MAIN GEAR STANDARDS SPECIFIED BY TNPDCL (TANGEDCO) FOR THE AVADI, PERAMBUR & K.K NAGAR DEPOT USES FROM THE ELIGIBLE TENDERERS WHO SHALL SUBMIT DOCUMENTARY EVIDENCE ON BEHALF OF THE MANAGING DIRECTOR IN THE e-PROCUREMENT PORTAL **https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.**

| Sl.No. | DESCRIPTION | E. M. D. Amount |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | Supply, Testing and Commissioning of 33 KV Outdoor Power Transformer Level-II, VCB (04 & 05 panel) and HT RMG panels as per TNPDCL (TANGEDCO) standards for Avadi (CEDC/West) depot, Perambur depot (CEDC-Central) & K.K Nagar depot (CEDC/ South-I) uses. | **Rs.1,00,000/-** |

**Last date of submission of e-tender** : **Upto 2.30 p.m on 04.11.2026**
**Date of Opening** : **3.00 p.m on 04.11.2026**
The Tender document is available in Government e-Procurement website **(https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app).** Any modification (if any) in tender terms and tender invitation period will be uploaded in the above website and the tenderers are requested to go through the above website periodically.

DIPR/ 2980 /TENDER/2026 — **MANAGING DIRECTOR**

**SOUTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**
Follow us on @SCRailwayindia
Details of the Tender Notices of S.C Railway can be seen on our website : www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in

**Tender No: SCR-MFBW-2026-27-01**

PUB/687

PCE acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Tender No SCR-MFBW-2026-27-01 Closing Date/Time 19/10/2026 15:00 Hrs. Bidders will be able to submit their original/revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored.

**S.No.:** 01 **Tender No.:** SCR-MFBW-2026-27-01 **Name of Work:** Flash Butt Welding of UIC 60kg R260/90 UTS 20 rail panels (New/in-service) in track under traffic block in mid-section and station yards using contractor's own Rail cum Road Vehicle mounted Flash Butt Mobile Welding Plant and Flash Butt welding of 90 UTS rails using contractor's self-propelled rail cum road / Mobile FBW Plants in loop lines as per Railway's specifications in the track renewal works, over South Central Railway. **Advertised Value (₹):** 497388557.72 **Earnest Money (₹):** 9947800.00 **Tender Doc. Cost (₹):** 0.00 **Validity of Offer (Days):** 60 **Period of Completion:** 24 Months **Bidding System:** Two Packet System **Tender Closing Date & Time:** 19.10.2026 15:00

1. Tenderers should participate through e-tendering only and no manual offers may be considered.
2. Tender conditions / other particulars are available in the Tender documents on IREPS website at **http://ireps.gov.in** which can be downloaded, can be participated and can view any modifications if any.

**Principal Chief Engineer, Secunderabad**
A795

**For further tender conditions / details and for downloading the tender documents, Please visit website at https://www.ireps.gov.in or www.scr.indianrailways.gov.in**

**STATE INDUSTRIES PROMOTION CORPORATION OF TAMIL NADU LIMITED**
**19-A, RUKMANI LAKSHMIPATHY ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI-600 008.**
**CIN : U74999TN1971SGC005967**
**(Online Only)**

**Tender Notice NIT.No. 35/CD/T.No.35/2026-27** **Dated: 29.09.2026**
For and on behalf of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu Limited, sealed tenders are invited under **"Single Cover System"** through online for the following work from reputed firms having experience in similar nature of works. The Programme for the issue, receipt and opening of bids would be as under. Tenders will be received upto **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **21.10.2026** and the same will be opened at **15.30 Hrs** (as per server system clock) on **22.10.2026.**

| Name of Work | Approx. value of work | EMD |
|---|---|---|
| Operation and maintenance of the truck terminal in OSR No.8, 9 & 13 at SIPCOT Industrial Park Sriperumbudur for a period of 36 months (three years) (Per year rate) | **Rs.70.88 lakhs** (including GST @18%) | **Rs. 46,000/-*** |
| * EMD should be paid through Online in the portal (https://tntenders.gov.in) | | |
| The tender Schedule can be Downloaded at free of cost from the website **https://tntenders.gov.in** | | |

DIPR / **2984** / Tender / 2026 — **SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER**

**தநாஅபதே TNPSC — TAMIL NADU PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION**

The details of Marks and Rank Position for the post of Forester (Post Code: 3362) under Reservation for Outstanding Sportspersons included in Combined Civil Services Examination - II (Group - II Services) (Notification No.11/2025) is available on the Commission's website in interactive mode, at **http://www.tnpsc.gov.in.**

**Chennai - 600 003**
**Dated : 29.09.2026**

**DIPR / 851 / DISPLAY / 2026** — **Controller of Examinations**

**CHENNAI METROPOLITAN WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD**
**NOTICE INVITING TENDER THROUGH E-TENDER**
**NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING**

e-bids is invited from the eligible bidders for the following work as per the procedure of CMWSSB under two cover system conforming to the Tamil Nadu Transparency in Tenders Act, 1998 and Rules 2000.

| Sl NO | Name of work and Tender No. | Bid Security | Prebid meeting Date | e-Bid Submission closing Date | e-Bid Opening Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Construction of Integrated Command & Control Center at CMWSSB Head office Chintadripet Chennai. CNT/WSS/NCB/MWB/3706A/2026-27 | Rs.7.81 Lakhs | 07.10.2026 at 11:30 a.m. | 03.11.2026 upto 3.00 P.M | 04.11.2026 after 3.30 P.M. |
| 2 | EMD by online transfer only through tender Portal. The tenderer shall submit scanned copy of online transaction statement towards EMD as part of Tender document. | | | | |
| 3 | Availability of tender documents and e-bid submission is permitted through tender portal / website: **www.tntenders.gov.in** For all other details refer tender schedule in the website from 01.10.2026 | | | | |

DIPR / 2987 / Tender / 2026 — **SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER i/c. (Contracts & Monitoring)**

REALLY SPECIAL

## Sahil thrilled at making the grade for the Los Angeles Olympics




R.V. MOORTHY

It's a big thing for me to win an Asian Games gold and get an Olympic quota for the country. That is what every athlete dreams of... going to the Olympics, representing your country, winning medals. To do so here in my first Asian Games feels really special — Sahil Jadhav, who won the mixed and men's team gold medals.

IDEAL FOIL

## Kynan kept pushing me to deliver my best, says Neeru



PTI

Indian shooter Neeru Dhanda credited Kynan Chenai and her team for keeping her motivated enough to shoot a decent score in the trap mixed team event. "All through the qualifying and final, Kynan kept encouraging me, pushing me to do my best even when I struggled to score. It helped a lot".

ON THE BALL

## Pranavi second among women as the Indian golfers begin well



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Pranavi Urs fired a four-under 66 to lie second in the individual standings while the Indian women were tied sixth after the first round at the Asian Games. With the two best scores counting towards the team competition, India posted a score of three-under. Among men, Saptak Talwar shot a four-under 66 to lie tied third.

EASY OUTING

## Indian squash teams advance to the semifinals, assured of medals



X@INDIASQUASH

The Indian men's and women's squash teams eased into the Asian Games semifinals with wins over Kuwait and Singapore respectively, assuring themselves of a medal in Nagoya on Wednesday. **The results: Quarterfinals: Men:** India 2 bt Kuwait 0. **Women:** India 2 bt Singapore 0 .

# Indian archers hit the bullseye with three gold medals

The exploits of the men's, women's and mixed compound teams lift the pall of gloom that had enveloped the contingent after an underwhelming campaign so far; the overall tally rises to 60

ASIAN GAMES

**Uthra Ganesan**
NAGOYA



**Triple treat:** The women's trio of Prithika, Chikitha and Jyothi, mixed duo of Sahil and Chikitha and men's team of Kushal, Sahil and Ganesh struck the yellow metal. R.V. MOORTHY

For two weeks, the Indian contingent had flattered to deceive, falling short of expectations and medals. All this while, the archers had remained in the shadows, focussed on the big picture.

That picture burst into a 1000 colours on a bright, sunny Wednesday morning in Aichi-Nagoya as the compound archers retained three of the five gold medals from the last edition – the men's, women's and mixed team – along with a quota for the Los Angeles Olympics. The individual matches are scheduled for Thursday.

India's golden haul coincided with the sky clearing up over the city after four days of non-stop rains and overcast conditions, much like the gloom in the Indian contingent so far over a lack of medals.

The Okazaki Chuo Sogo Park Multipurpose Square was rife with excitement as the Indian trio of Jyothi Surekha, Chikitha Taniparthi and Prithika Pradeep walked out for their semifinal against powerhouse Korea, knowing well this would be a much sterner test than perhaps even the final.

Both teams started cautiously with a 59 each in the opening round. Things turned from the second, when India got another 59 while Yerin Park struck two nines and Jungyoon Park and Yeonseo Kang got one each for a round of 56 and a three-point lead to India.

Korea looked like fighting back with a perfect 60 in the third round to India's 58 but the one-point advantage carried over into the decider.

Prithika had just one nine, on her first arrow, followed by all perfect targets thereafter. Jyothi needed a nine or better on the final shot and she managed exactly that to win 234-233.

India was always in control in the final against China, starting with a perfect 60 to take a two-point lead after the first round and extending it with a 59 to 58 in the second.

China reduced the margin by one in the third and managed a 58 in the final round which left India needing only a combined total of 57 or more to win; they did better with a perfect 60 to win 238-234, equalling the world, Asian and Games records in the process.

Chikitha then combined with Sahil Jadhav to win the mixed team event in a shoot-off against Korea after the two were tied on 157 at the end of regulation shots.

India started with perfect 40s in the first two rounds while Jungyoon Park and Yonghee Choi both missed one shot apiece in each round for two 39s.

Korea clawed back over the next two rounds but Chikitha kept her nerves in the shoot-off.

The day's final gold came when Sahil combined with Ganesh Thirumuru and Kushal Dalal to first demolish the Koreans in the semifinals 236-229 and then overturned a two-point deficit against China in the final to win 238-237.

China started strongly, taking a two-point lead after the first round with a 60 and nines from Kushal and Ganesh. India pulled one back in Round 3 when Jinyi Liu's nine on the 14th arrow hurt China.

India won 238-237.

### Medals table

| | Country | G | S | B | T |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | China | 151 | 67 | 59 | 277 |
| 2 | Japan | 50 | 77 | 73 | 200 |
| 3 | South Korea | 24 | 30 | 49 | 103 |
| 4 | Uzbekistan | 16 | 19 | 19 | 54 |
| 5 | Thailand | 12 | 10 | 12 | 34 |
| **8** | **India** | **10** | **21** | **29** | **60** |

# Neeru-Kynan duo claims the trap mixed team gold



**A moment to savour:** Neeru, right, and Kynan celebrate their triumph. PTI

**Uthra Ganesan**
NAGOYA

On Tuesday, Neeru Dhanda fought her opponents and the elements to win India's first and only individual gold so far in shooting. On Wednesday, she found the perfect foil in Kynan Chenai, the senior pro backing the youngster all the way as the two combined to win the trap mixed team gold with a new Asian record score.

Kynan put his individual disappointment behind and took charge of the proceedings even as Neeru, struggling to recover from being in the heavy downpour all day on Tuesday, felt physically unable to sustain the pressure, struggling to get the big scores she is known for.

The duo shot two consecutive series of 46 and then a 44 to advance as the fourth and final qualifiers with a total of 136. While Kynan scored an impressive 73 out of a maximum of 75, Neeru stumbled in the final series with only a 19 after two series of 22s for a total of 63 but it was good enough to get into the final.

The final, though, was a complete contrast with the Indians taking charge early on and then staying on top all the way.

Kynan missed his first and only target of the final, being spot-on thereafter, scoring 19 out of a maximum 20 points.

Neeru managed 15 but it was good enough. India started with a six in the first series, followed it up with a perfect 10 to be tied with Qatar at top on 16 points. Another series of 10 put India two clear after Qatar's 8 and the difference remained till the end, India finished on top with a 34

"You have no idea how happy I was it wasn't raining. It helped out with the targets also, it wasn't so difficult to see. Initially it was a bit tough but it brightened up towards the end of the final. Thank God it wasn't raining otherwise it would just been miserable." Kynan admitted but insisted that the conditions didn't really matter in terms of competition.

"I think more than anything else, the chase for the medal was more inspiring. As shotgun shooters, we don't really have a choice: other than lightning, we shoot in every every type of condition, so we just become used to it. Having the national anthem played for you is something special and today, one of my dreams came true," he added.

# Sunil bags bronze

**Press Trust of India**
NAGOYA



Sunil... on top. REUTERS

Sunil Kumar became the first Indian Greco-Roman wrestler to win two Asian Games medals after clinching a bronze in the men's 87kg event while Nisha Dahiya was knocked out on the opening day of the competition here on Wednesday.

Sunil, who had secured bronze in Hangzhou, assured his place on the podium with a technical superiority win (9-0) over Philippines' Roberts Callum Johnston. Locking his rival's right arm, the Indian effected two take downs to quickly open up a 4-0 lead. Johnston was put on ground in 'Par Terre' position, from where Sunil made more scoring moves to finish the bout in the first period itself.

The 27-year-old was left to fight for a bronze medal after losing his semifinal 0-11 to Japan's Taizo Yoshida by technical superiority.

Disappointment was in store for Nisha, who blew away a lead in both her women's 68kg bouts to make an early exit.

Nisha lost to North Korea's Pak Sol Gum in the 1/8 phase – on bigger scoring move criterion – and went down to South Korea's Park Hyeonyeong 'by fall' in the repechage round.

### THE INDIA SHOW

*A look at some Indian performances on Wednesday:*

**Archery:** Finals: Compound: Men's team: bt China; Women's team: bt China; Mixed team: bt South Korea.

**Boxing:** Semifinals: Women: 75kg: Lovlina bt Bogdanova (Kaz); 60kg: Priya lost to Chengyu (Chn), bagged bronze; Men: 90kg: Kapil lost to Khabibullaev (Uzb), bagged bronze.

**Golf:** Individual (round 1): Men: Saptak (T3), Veer and Yuvraj (T23); Women: Pranavi (second), Diksha and Aditi (T18).

**Hockey:** Women (semifinal): bt South Korea 2-0.

**Shooting:** Trap mixed team final: Neeru & Kynan (gold); 25m rapid fire pistol men individual qualification (stage 1): Anish (fifth).

**Squash:** Quarterfinals: Women's team: bt Singapore 2-0; Men's team: bt Kuwait 2-0.

**Tennis:** Men: Third round: Dhakshineswar lost to Chun-hsin (Tpe) 3-6, 4-6; Nagal bt Fomin (Uzb) 6-3, 6-2; Doubles (quarterfinals): Anirudh & Sriram Balaji lost to Fumin & Tianhui (Chn) 7-6(4), 6-7(7), [8-10]; Yuki & Dhakshineswar lost to Chenjui & Yu-hsiou (Tpe) 6-7(5), 3-6. Mixed doubles (second round): Rutuja & Yuki lost to Su-wei & Chun-hsin (Tpe) 3-6, 4-6.

**Wrestling:** Men's Greco-Roman 87kg bronze medal match: Sunil bt Roberts (Phi); Women's 68kg repechage: Nisha lost to Hyeonyeong (Kor).

# Lovlina advances to final; Priya, Kapil earn bronze

**Press Trust of India**
NISHIO (JAPAN)



Priya... podium finish on Games debut. SAI MEDIA

Lovlina Borgohain scripted history by becoming the first Indian woman boxer to reach back-to-back Asian Games finals, while debutants Priya Ghanghas and Kapil Pokhariya claimed bronze medals here on Wednesday.

Last edition's silver medallist Lovlina edged reigning 70kg world champion Natalya Bogdanova of Kazakhstan 3-2 in a closely fought 75kg semifinal to assure herself of at least a silver.

However, 20-year-old Priya, making her Asian Games debut, went down 1-4 to former world champion Yang Chengyu of China in a bruising 60kg semifinal.

Another Indian debutant, Kapil suffered a similar 1-4 defeat against reigning world champion Turabek Khabibullaev of Uzbekistan in the 90kg semifinal and had to be content with a bronze.

India will thus have three boxers – Lovlina, Parveen Hooda (65kg) and Ankush Panghal (80kg) fighting for gold on Friday.

Indian boxers have already bettered their medal tally from the previous edition, with six medals assured this time compared to four in 2023, when they won one silver and three bronze.

Alongside Priya and Kapil, super-heavyweight boxer Narender Berwal will also go home with a bronze medal.



Kapil. SAI MEDIA

Lovlina overcame a slow start to edge past Kazakhstan's Bogdanova in a closely fought contest, with a dominant second round proving decisive.

### Good experience

"It was a good experience because this is my second Asian Games, and last time I had a silver medal. So this time I will definitely try to get a gold medal. Let's see what happens in the final," Lovlina said.

### INDIANS IN ACTION

*A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Thursday (all times IST):*

**Archery:** Compound women's individual: Quarterfinal: Chikitha vs. Ashrifah (Ina), 5.30 a.m.; semifinal, 6.35 a.m.; final, 7.10 a.m.; Compound men's individual: Quarterfinal: Ganesh vs. Chen (Tpe), 9.45 a.m.; semifnal, 10.35 a.m.; final, 11.10 a.m.

**Cricket:** Men (semifinal): vs. Sri Lanka, 10 a.m.

**Hockey:** Men (semifinal): vs. Pakistan, 1 p.m.

**Shooting:** 25m rapid fire pistol men individual qualification (stage 2) — Anish, 6.10 a.m.; final, noon.

**Squash:** Semifinals: Women's team: vs. Hong Kong, 7 a.m.; Men's team: vs. Malaysia, 1 p.m.

**Tennis:** Men (quarterfinal): Nagal vs. Yibing (Chn), noon.

**Volleyball:** Men (quarterfinal): vs. Pakistan, 6.30 a.m.

**Wrestling:** Men's Greco-Roman 77kg (1/8 finals): Aman vs Tuvshinbaatar (Mgl), 7.20 a.m.; Women's 62kg (1/8 finals): Mansi vs. Irina (Kaz), 7.30 a.m.; Men's Greco-Roman: 60kg (1/4 finals): Sumit vs. TBC, 7.55 a.m.; 97kg (1/4 finals): Nitesh vs. Agamammedov (Tkm), 8.15 a.m.

## INBRIEF



### Vaishnavi scalps six as India-A takes control of 'Test'

Vaishnavi Sharma's haul of six for 52 handed India-A a huge advantage as the hosts led Australia-A by 322 runs at stumps on day two of the only women's 'Test' here on Wednesday.

**The scores:** India-A 364 in 103.3 overs (Shubha Satheesh 59, Tanisha Singh 92, Niki Prasad 91; Lilly Mills 4/98, Charli Knott 3/82) & 134/2 in 27.5 overs (Priya Punia 59, Yastika Bhatia 33 n.o) vs Australia-A 176 in 63.4 overs (Rachel Trenaman 45; Vaishnavi Sharma 6/52).

### ICC World Cup 2027 schedule to be announced today

The International Cricket Council (ICC) will unveil the schedule for the ICC Men's Cricket World Cup 2027 in Cape Town on Thursday. It will mark the one-year countdown to the tournament, which will commence on October 2, 2027, with the final scheduled for Sunday, November 21, 2027. The event will also see the opening of the ticket ballot for fans, as per a press release.

### Brazil's Raphinha out of India clash with injury

Raphinha was released by Brazil on Wednesday because of a thigh injury. The Brazilian Football Confederation said Raphinha had a minor muscle edema and no replacement player will be called up for the friendly match against India.

### Mortara and de Vries to stay on at Mahindra Racing

Indian team Mahindra Racing has retained Edoardo Mortara and Nyck de Vries for the upcoming 2026/27 FIA Formula E World Championship season.

Since joining Mahindra Racing in 2023, Mortara and de Vries have played a pivotal role in the team's progression and have secured two victories, 10 additional podium finishes.

# India breaks down a stubborn Korea

Ishika and Salima sound the boards in the space of four minutes to put the women's hockey team one step away from regaining the gold medal

ASIAN GAMES

**Uthra Ganesan**
GIFU



**Finally there:** India struggled with penalty corner conversion before Ishika broke the deadlock. AHF

Indian women dominated the proceedings and did everything except finding a way to overcome a stubborn South Korean defence till the end of the third quarter. But they eventually won 2-0 to reach the Asian Games hockey final at the Gifu Prefectural Green Stadium here on Wednesday.

Having missed the bus last time around with the semifinal loss to China before taking home bronze, India will be hoping to not only avenge its defeat but also book a ticket for the LA Olympics after the defending champion beat Japan 4-2 in the shootout. The teams were tied goalless at the end of regulation time in the other last-four game.

India started on an aggressive note and had its chance, the first of its 10 penalty corners coming in the fourth minute, but Deepika's shot was saved. The sequence was repeated several times through the match – India's PC, Korea's defending and stalemate. For a long time, it looked like Korea was content simply sitting back and defending.

There was barely any attempt to attack or even break into the Indian third. At times, the Indians, too, were clueless on how to proceed against an opponent which did little by way of action. Most of the contest was confined to the Korean half as India tried to find the opening goal.

The deadlock was finally broken in the 44th minute when Ishika turned in a perfectly-placed pass off India's eighth PC with a reverse shot.

Four minutes later, Salima Tete's cross from the right deflected off a defender's stick and trickled past the goal line. Korea looked to have realised that there was no way back from there without moving up and creating a few chances of its own, which included three back-to-back PCs. But it could not get past Savita Punia.

It was a similar story in the other semifinal except that Japan was successful in keeping China at bay for the entire 60 minutes before going down in the shootout.

Friday's final, however, is expected to be a very different affair with both India and China known for playing a more open game than what was on display on Wednesday.

**The results (semifinals):** India 2 (Ishika 44, Salima Tete 48) bt South Korea 0; China 0 drew with Japan 0. *China won 4-2 in shootout.*

# India-A in trouble as the top-order fails

AUS-A IN INDIA

**Abhishek Saini**
PUDUCHERRY

Neither Devdutt Padikkal (31, 46b, 4x4) nor B. Sai Sudharsan could bail India-A out from a batting slump, and the host had its back to the wall against Australia-A after the second day of the second 'Test' at the Siechem Cricket Stadium here on Wednesday.

The internationals had chipped in with runs in the first game, but Todd Murphy (two for 26) and Corey Rocchiccioli snared them and hit the spine of this Indian batting line-up.

India-A was 122 for five at stumps, still 236 behind the visitors.

Rocchiccioli, with his tall release and flight, had already got deliveries to misbehave with extra bounce.

With Sai Sudharsan pushed into his crease to tackle this trepidation, the gambit was completed by Murphy, who fired a delivery full, got it to turn low and crash into the off-stump.

Padikkal was helpless to a similar delivery from Rocchiccioli.

Shaik Rasheed (36 batting, 140b, 2x4), seeing the slide, opted to stonewall to survive till stumps.

**The scores:** Australia-A 358 in 116.3 overs (Jason Sangha 46, Sam Harper 128) vs. India-A 122/5 in 51 overs.

# For TN vice-captain Andre, pressure is a privilege

**S. Shrivathsan**
CHENNAI

For C. Andre Siddarth, pressure is a privilege. The soon-approaching task of serving as R. Sai Kishore's deputy in the Tamil Nadu Ranji Trophy team is not bogging the 20-year-old down.

The leadership role which has been bestowed upon him is, in fact, driving the young gun to unlock new features in his game. "Becoming the vice-captain for a State like Tamil Nadu at 20 is a privilege and honour. The pressure that comes with it is a blessing," said Andre, who will also lead TN U-23 in a clash against Rest of India U-23 starting here on Thursday.



Andre Siddarth.
FILE PHOTO: M. PERIASAMY

"I just want to elevate myself. It (the experience) will be a great learning for me," added the right-handed run accumulator while also expressing admiration for Tamil Nadu teammate B. Indrajith and former Australia skipper Steve Smith.

Now that Andre is set to shoulder additional responsibility, he is likely to deal with even more peaks and valleys. "Ups and downs are part and parcel of the sport, so being level-headed is important. I am not worried about the result: I am only worried about my improvement."

He is relishing working under new head coach V. Yo Mahesh, someone who has given wings to TN youngsters' dreams.

"Yo Mahesh is pushing us out of our comfort zone. He is being hard: he wants us to do the right things, which I feel is much needed going into a new season. Ninety per cent of the practice sessions feel like a match... they are so intense".

## Spain brushes aside Croatia

**Agence France-Presse**
PARIS

Lamine Yamal netted a brace as world champion Spain continued its winning start to the UEFA Nations League with a 4-1 success in Seville against Croatia on Tuesday, while Harry Kane scored as England won in Czechia.

**The results: League A: Group 3:** Spain 4 (Yamal 2, 63, Pubill 31, Williams 89) bt Croatia 1 (Beljo 28); Czechia 0 lost to England 2 (Gordon 47, Kane 69).
**League B: Group 1:** Scotland 0 lost to Switzerland 3 (Rodriguez 12, Elvedi 55, Amdouni 82); Slovenia 2 (Lovric 55, Matko 82) bt North Macedonia 0.
**League C: Group 1:** Finland 0 drew with Belarus 0; San Marino 0 lost to Albania 3 (Mehmeti 21, Uzuni 27, Manaj 65).
**Group 3:** Moldova 1 (Perciun 66) drew with Faroe Islands 1 (Davidsen 26-pen).

# Srinagar in focus as J&K aims to set the tone against RoI



**Gearing up:** The Rest of India players will be keen to lay down an early marker. IMRAN NISSAR

IRANI CUP

**Vivek Krishnan**
SRINAGAR

Wherever one's gaze turns in Srinagar, there are attractions aplenty. Not for nothing does the moniker of 'Paradise on Earth' adorn Kashmir. There is the serene Dal Lake, where *shikara* rides run from dawn to dusk.

There is the dense covering of *chinar* trees, whose leaves will morph into a canvas of crimson before carpeting the turf at the culmination of autumn.

For connoisseurs of food and drink, the multi-course *wazwan* meal and the piping hot *kahwa* tea are must-haves.

Seldom, though, has cricket figured prominently in conversations here. Sure, two ODIs were held in the 1980s at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium – the first between India and West Indies in 1983 left a bitter taste as an unruly crowd dug up the pitch – but India's northernmost region was always on the margins of the country's cricketing map.

Not anymore. Undeniable proof comes this week as the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium, nestled in the foothills of the Zabarwan mountain range, hosts arguably its biggest cricketing contest since the 1980s.

From Thursday, Jammu & Kashmir will take on the Rishabh Pant-led Rest of India in the Irani Cup here. The recognition is by virtue of J&K holding aloft the Ranji Trophy for the first time in 2025-26.

The interest for the fixture was palpable on Wednesday afternoon. As both teams wrapped up their practice sessions, a queue of fans, comprising youngsters largely, patiently lined up outside one of the side gates in the hunt for passes.

When the action begins, there are players on both sides with plenty to gain. For J&K, the curiosity revolves around how it responds to the tag of the Ranji champion.

In the Rest of India camp, there is a nice blend of proven performers like Pant and Sarfaraz Khan and young talents like Manav Suthar and Shikhar Mohan. If the contest can be as arresting as the sights of Srinagar, the city's long wait for a high-profile contest would have been worth it.

**The teams (from): Jammu & Kashmir:** Paras Dogra (Capt.), Shubham Khajuria, Qamran Iqbal, Yawer Hassan, Shubham Pundir, Abdul Samad, Kawalpreet Singh, Kanhaiya Wadhawan (wk), Abid Mushtaq, Sahil Lotra, Vanshaj Sharma, Sunil Kumar, Umar Nazir, Lone Nasir Muzaffar, Rohit Sharma.

**Rest of India:** Rishabh Pant (Capt. & wk), Sanat Sangwan, Sudip Gharami, Sarfaraz Khan, Ayush Doseja, R. Smaran, Shikhar Mohan, Aryan Juyal (wk), Anukul Roy, Manav Suthar, Saransh Jain, Akash Deep, Mukesh Kumar, Mukesh Choudhary, Aryan Pandey.

# Pant ready for the ups and downs

**Vivek Krishnan**
SRINAGAR

His teammates had dispersed. So had the net bowlers. More than 30 minutes after he had begun batting at the farthest net, Rishabh Pant, set to lead Rest of India in the Irani Cup against Jammu & Kashmir from Thursday, seemed oblivious to the surroundings at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium.

If the 28-year-old conveyed the impression of having no other distractions at that moment, it is because he is confined to this one format for the time being.

He isn't in the ODI and T20I teams, which means that his next international assignment could be some time away – India plays two Tests against New Zealand in the second half of November.

Pant isn't scratching his head over the imponderables. "There will be ups and downs. When you want to have an international career for 15-20 years, you have to go through these things. So, it's that kind of mindset," he said at the pre-match interaction. "It's very simple. Whatever is in front of me, I will give my best. That's how I have played cricket."

**Dogra backs his pacers**

A little after 1 p.m., at the Barsapara in Guwahati, Auqib Nabi received his India cap from K.L. Rahul.

Less than an hour earlier, in Srinagar, Nabi was a recurring theme of the press conferences building up to the fixture.

It wasn't yet known that he would become just the third cricketer from J&K to play for India, but such had been the pacer's impact on his team's Ranji Trophy-winning exploits in 2025-26 that the two captains were asked repeatedly about Nabi's absence.

For Paras Dogra, the query was at the core of J&K's chances of not only winning the Irani Cup but also defending its Ranji title.

"Obviously, he took 60 wickets last year. But we have [other] good bowlers. This is a good sign for J&K that cricket is growing and other boys will get a chance," the 41-year-old said.



**Charming:** Pant makes a CRPF constable's day. IMRAN NISSAR

TNCA LEAGUE



Nazerene Peter (Milkyway, 6/13), Yogender Sharma (ICI S &RC, 6/32), Suresh Kumar (Vijay's RC, 6/52), Senthil Kumar (Purasawlkam CC, 6/66) and Naveen Kumar (Saidapet Gymkhana, 5/9).



Saravanan (Perungalathur, 5/43), Michael Antony (Gandhi, 5/46), Nidhish (Universal RC, 5/49), Vibavesh (National, 5/54), Aashish Kumar (Book Sellers, 5/61).

### Sachin's unbeaten ton fires Prasad to 10-win win

CHENNAI: V. Sachin's unbeaten 103 enabled Prasad CC script a huge 10-wicket win over Kamyuth Club in a fourth division 'A' zone match of the Tamil Nadu Cricket Association league held here recently.

**The scores: IV-A:** Kamyuth Club 187 in 49 overs (Sivaguru 38, S. Muthukumar 32, M. Vinith Kumar 34, Ramesh Thangaraj 4/46, G. B. Pranneasvaran 3/43) lost to Prasad 189 for no loss in 43.1 overs (V. Sachin 103 n.o., V.S. Abishek 72 n.o.).

Vigneswara 99 in 32.1 overs (L. Nazerene Peter Franklin 6/13) lost to Milkyway 101/7 in 29 overs (S. Sabari 34, A. Suryaa 32 n.o., Raaghul Krishna 3/31). Match reduced to 33 overs per side due to overnight rain.

Book Sellers XI 235 in 49.1 overs (S. Chandrashekar 66, R. Aashish Kumar 61, S. Manikandan 44, D. Saravanan 5/43) bt Perungalathur 196 in 45 overs (G. Rajesh 53, T. Marimuthu 50, R. Aashish Kumar 5/61, R. Manivannan 3/48).

Bharathi 158 in 34.3 overs (M. Abinandh 30, N. Dhilipan 57, R. Balajiram 3/67, T. Suresh Kumar 6/52) lost to Vijay's RC 160/6 in 38.1 overs (Appurva Kumar Sahoo 52, M. Sudarsan 55, K. Tarun Avinash 32 n.o., K. Palanisamy 3/39, K. S. Barath Rithvik 3/73).



Sachin (Prasad, 103 n.o.).

Prithvi 224 in 47.1 overs (K. Harish Chaitanya 57, K. Rishi 34 n.o., Y. Surya 4/65) bt Reserve Bank 222 in 43.5 overs (M. Lakshminarayanan 92, R. Chokkalingam 32, K. Rishi 3/53).

Purasawalkam 228/7 in 50 overs (V. Vimridh 34, Jemoh Roshan 59, R. Prasanth 73, P. Krishaant 3/48) bt Sumangali Homes 226/8 in 50 overs (B. Karthik 43, N. Muneeswaran 61, S. Senthil Kumar 6/66).

**V-D:** TVS MSC 183/8 in 50 overs (S. Hariharan 74, D. Mohanakrishnan 51) lost to Venkateswara 184/4 in 28.5 overs (J. Jenish 38, S. Vigneshwaran 75 n.o., E. Mukesh 33 n.o.).

Madras Emmanuel 222/8 in 50 overs (K. Pradeep 63 n.o., E.S. Vishal Rao 66, E. Balaji 4/46) lost to Egmore Excelsiors 224/4 in 36.3 overs (Veera Perumal 76, V. Sabarish 48 n.o., G. Babu 51 n.o.).

Eagle 80 in 48 overs (P. Naveen Kumar 5/9, K. Raghul Raj 3/13) lost to Saidapet Gymkhana 83 for no loss in 10.2 overs (G. Sharma 34 n.o., D. Hari Haran 46 n.o.).

Universal 266 in 50 overs (V. Rajesh 64, G.K. Nidhish 66, M.G. Siva Shankar 59 n.o., D.R. Anbu Ezhil 3/56, S. Mohammed Azarudeen 4/65) bt Youngsters 164 in 36 overs (Ramaswamy 40, R. Dhanush 3/37, G.K. Nidhish 5/49).

Madras Indians 187 in 41.1 overs (M. Vairam Sarath Kumar 48, R. Pradeep 57, J. Michael Antony 5/47) lost to Gandhi CC 191/8 in 45.1 overs (R. Naveen Kumar 33, S. Prabakaran 52, Lakshmanan Kamalesh 4/36).

ICI S & RC 236 in 47.1 overs (M. Muthu Jeeva 40, C. Venkatachalam 34, M. Manikandan 54 n.o., Vibavesh Ramesh 5/54) bt National 104 in 31.3 overs (K. Hemprasaath 33, R. Yogender Sharma 6/32).

LIVE TELECAST

**Irani Cup:** day 1, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

**India-A vs Australia-A:** Second 'Test' day 3, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

**Cricket:** Asian Games (Men): India vs Sri Lanka, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

**Football:** Nations League, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 8.30 p.m.

**Cricket:** Men's ODI WC schedule unveil, Star Sports 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m.

**Asian Games:** Sony Sports Ten 2, 3, 5 & JioHotstar, 5.30 a.m. (Friday)

# Gill on the double as India hunts down 406 in style

The skipper's stroke-filled knock and his mammoth opening stand with Rohit power the second highest run-chase in ODIs; centuries by WI batters Campbell, Hope and Jangoo go in vain

WI IN INDIA

**S. Prasanna Venkatesan**
GUWAHATI

Through the global financial crisis, Arab Spring, the discovery of the Higgs boson, humanity's first image of a black hole, a pandemic that brought the world to a halt, and the rise of generative AI, the world has not seen a successful ODI chase in excess of 400.

The last such chase came in March 2006. On Wednesday, Shubman Gill's forensic artistry (223 n.o., 133b, 26x4, 8x6) and Rohit Sharma's slouching grandeur (101, 75b, 10x4, 6x6) came to the fore as India finally joined that rare club. Chasing down 406 with eight wickets to spare, India took an unassailable 2-0 lead in the three-match series against West Indies at the Barsapara Cricket Stadium. There is something faintly García Marquez-like about Gill's current form. The extraordinary keeps occurring with such regularity that everyone has stopped treating it as extraordinary. A hundred from him now feels like rain in Macondo: remarkable in isolation, almost routine in accumulation. This time, he doubled down on it - in double-quick time.



**Avalanche of runs:** Gill and Rohit orchestrated India's incredible pursuit after Jangoo, Campbell and Hope smashed hundreds for West Indies. RITU RAJ KONWAR

Gill's batting was silk and shrapnel. His wrists were particularly persuasive, shuffling deep into the leg-side before cutting through backward point, or flicking over midwicket with the ease of a samurai wielding a light sword. He used his feet repeatedly, dancing down to Roston Chase and Keemo Paul and launching sixes over square-leg and cow-corner. There was precision, too: a late slice between deep-point and deep-third, a pristine punch past cover, a full-faced drive that left mid-on stranded. Even the short ball was not safe - a 141.3-kph delivery from Alzarri Joseph disappeared into the stands off Gill's signature short-arm jab.

He reached his hundred off 62 balls, his 11th in ODIs, before going on to raise the fastest double-hundred, off 117 balls.

Gill and Rohit – who crossed 12,000 runs in the 50-over format – added 255 for the opening wicket.

Rohit once said that when he is batting well, he gets into good positions. Watch him on a good day and you see it. A slight adjustment of the feet, a quiet transfer of weight, a subtle alignment of shoulders and eyes. No reaching. No lunging. No rescue missions. Just a man arriving exactly where he needs to be, exactly when he needs to be there. The shot feels inevitable because the position was perfect.

Earlier, John Campbell wasn't to be trifled with. After all, when a man treats a missed hundred as unfinished business, he is best given a wide berth. If his 60-ball 62 in the first ODI was useful, his 68-ball 101 (9x4, 5x6) here was punitive. Campbell, skipper Shai Hope (104, 94b, 8x4, 3x6), and Amir Jangoo (114, 77b, 13x4, 3x6) formed the Caribbean century cartel.

**SCOREBOARD**

**WEST INDIES**
John Campbell c Dhir b Gurnoor 101 *(68b, 9x4, 5x6)*, Keacy Carty c Dhir b Prasidh 9 *(10b, 2x4)*, Shai Hope c Nabi b Kuldeep 104 *(94b, 8x4, 3x6)*, Amir Jangoo c Ruturaj b Jadeja 114 *(77b, 13x4, 3x6)*, Sherfane Rutherford c sub (Jaiswal) b Gurnoor 0 *(1b)*, Roston Chase (not out) 29 *(25b, 4x4)*, Keemo Paul c Kohli b Kuldeep 3 *(8b)*, Alzarri Joseph c Rohit b Jadeja 8 *(10b, 1x4)*, Shamar Joseph (not out) 14 *(8b, 1x4, 1x6)*; Extras (b-1, lb-1, w-20, nb-1): 23; Total (for seven wkts. in 50 overs): 405.

**FALL OF WICKETS**
1-37 (Carty, 4.6 overs), 2-147 (Campbell, 18.1), 3-329 (Hope, 39.6), 4-330 (Rutherford, 40.2), 5-348 (Jangoo, 42.2), 6-369 (Paul, 45.1), 7-385 (Joseph, 47.3).

**INDIA BOWLING**
Prasidh 5-0-45-1, Nabi 8.5-0-84-0, Gurnoor 10-0-96-2, Dhir 6.1-0-38-0, Jadeja 10-0-75-2, Kuldeep 10-0-65-2

**INDIA**
Rohit Sharma lbw b Seales 101 *(75b, 10x4, 6x6)*, Shubman Gill (not out) 223 *(133b, 26x4, 8x6)*, Virat Kohli c Rutherford b Shamar 29 *(19b, 3x4, 1x6)*, Ruturaj Gaikwad (not out) 31 *(37b, 2x4)*; Extras (lb-2, nb-3, w-17): 22; Total (for two wkts. in 43.3 overs): 406.

**FALL OF WICKETS**
1-255 (Rohit, 26.2), 2-320 (Kohli, 32.1).

**WEST INDIES BOWLING**
Seales 8-0-78-1, Alzarri 8-0-89-0, Shamar 6-0-52-1, Paul 3-0-49-0, Chase 8.3-0-63-0, Lawes 10-0-73-0.

**Toss:** India; **PoM:** Gill.
*India won by eight wickets with 39 balls remaining to lead series 2-0.*
**Third and final ODI: October 3**, New Chandigarh, 2 p.m.


सी.एस.आई.आर – केन्द्रीय चर्म अनुसंधान संस्थान
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Council of Scientific & Industrial Research
अडयार, चेन्नै, तमिलनाडु, भारत
**Adyar, Chennai - 600 020, Tamil Nadu, India**

अधिसूचना सं.10/2026
Notification No.10/2026

**लिखित परीक्षा / साक्षात्कार**
**Written Test / Interview**

सीएसआईआर–सीएलआरआई में विभिन्न परियोजनाओं के तहत अस्थायी आधार पर काम करने के लिए परियोजना **सहयोगी–I, परियोजना सहायक–II** के स्थानों पर नियुक्ति के लिए **लिखित परीक्षा / साक्षात्कार 27 अक्तूबर, 2026** को सीएसआईआर– सीएलआरआई, सरदार पटेल रोड, अडयार, चेन्नै-600020 में आयोजित किया जाएगा।

**Written Test / Interview** for engagement to the positions of **Project Associate-I, Project Assistant-II** on temporary basis, to work under various projects at CSIR-CLRI is scheduled to be held on **27th October, 2026** at CSIR-CLRI, Sardar Patel Road, Adyar, Chennai – 600020

अर्हताएं, चयन की विधि, लिखित परीक्षा / साक्षात्कार की सारणी और आवेदन प्रपत्र आदि संबंधी पूरी जानकारी के लिए कृपया **https://clri.org** देखें।

For complete details regarding qualification(s), mode of selection, schedule of Written Test / Interviews and proforma for application etc., please visit : **https://clri.org**

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वरिष्ठ प्रशासन नियंत्रक
**Senior Controller of Administration**



**TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED**
Kagithapuram - 639 136, Karur District, Tamil Nadu
**NOTICE INVITING TENDER**
**Notice Inviting Expression of Interest (EOI)**

| Tender No. | Material Description | Due Date |
|---|---|---|
| Sl.No.1 | Rebuild of Chemical Bagasse plant with upgraded technology for optimizing the reject handling system to reduce utility and power consumption by running 600TPD of unbleached chemical bagasse pulp production in Single Street and reducing weak black liquor generation. | 26.10.2026 |

**TNPL Invites Tender for the Following:**

| Tender No. | Material Description | Due Date |
|---|---|---|
| 262713 004173 | Procurement of Alkaline Sizing Chemicals with Alkyl Ketene Dimer (AKD) for PM # 1, 2 & 3 at Unit-I. | 14.10.2026 |

Corrigendum if any will be issued in TNPL Website and NIC portal only. For further details, please visit websites: **www.tnpl.com / https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**
DIPR / **2983** / Tender / 2026
TNPL-MAKER OF BAGASSE BASED ECO-FRIENDLY PAPER



**NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY**
SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS THROUGH E-PROCUREMENT TENDERS
TENDER NOTICE No: S/2026/39 Date: 28.09.2026
The Principal Chief Material Manager, North Western Railway, headquarter Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-tenders on website as follow- www.ireps.gov.in

| SN | Tender No. | Description | Qty. | Due date |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 40261772A | POWER CONTACTOR | 1765 | 22.10.26 |
| 2 | 80265019A | High Speed Diesel (HSD) | 548 | 12.10.26 |
| 3 | 79262131 | Polyvastra Bed Sheet | 6816 | 21.10.26 |
| 4 | 40260002C | MOTOR BREAKER | 3917 | 30.10.26 |
| 5 | 50255201A | Relay QN1 8F/8B and 12F/4B | 5060 | 20.10.26 |
| 6 | 50255997 | Relay QN1 8F/8B 50 Volt | 2082 | 26.10.26 |
| 7 | 50265660 | SMPS based IPS | 04 | 26.10.26 |
| 8 | 37263042A | Lock | 16575 | 20.10.26 |
| 9 | 37261977 | L-type composition Brake | 32436 | 27.10.26 |
| 10 | 79260006 | FIRE RETARDENT UPHOLSTERY CLOTH | 2523 | 21.10.26 |

**CORRIGENDUM**

| SN | Tender No. & Description | Corrigendum in |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 81261161A-ISI marked ABC, Dry chemical | TOD -14.10.26 in lieu of 28.09.26 |

**Note:-** Interested tenderers may visit the website **ireps.gov.in** for full tender details/description/Specification, quantity & corrigendum if any.
1399-PH/26
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**APPOINTMENT**

**UNIVERSITY OF MADRAS**
**APPOINTMENT NOTIFICATION**
Applications [8 copies] are invited for the following post, so as to be received by the Convener, VC-Convener Committee superscribing on the envelope "Application for the post of _____"

| Name of the Post | No.of Posts |
|---|---|
| Controller of Examinations | 1 |
| Professor cum Director, Centre for Distance and Online Education | 1 |
| Dean-College Development Council | 1 |

Details of post, prescribed qualifications, application form, general instructions, coding sheet and Table 2 are available in the University Website: **http://www.unom.ac.in.**
The last date for receipt of filled in applications is 16.10.2026
**NOTE:**
The Syndicate reserves the right to fill or not to fill up the posts without assigning any reason whatsoever. In the matter of recruitment, the decision of the Syndicate is final and any representation against non-selection will not be entertained under any circumstances.
DIPR / 844 / Display / 2026 REGISTRAR



**TAMILNADU INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED (TIDCO)**
19-A, Rukmini Lakshmipathi Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008
CIN-U65993TN1965SGC005327
**e-TENDER NOTICE**
NIT. No. TIDCO/TNDIC/FTO/Infra/2026-3 Date:30.09.2026
TIDCO invites bids from the eligible bidders through e-Tender for the work mentioned below:

| S. No | Particulars | Approx Value of work in Rs. | EMD Amount in Rs. |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | e-Tender for providing chain link fence and security cabin in kanadukathan Airstrip, Karaikudi Taluk, Sivaganga District | 1.744Cr | 1,74,400/- |

Tenders shall be uploaded through https://tntenders.gov.in on or before 3.00 PM on 15.10.2026 and the same will be opened on 15.10.2026 at 5.00 PM.
For More details, please visit https://tntenders.gov.in
DIPR/2969/Tender/2026 Chairman and Managing Director TIDCO



**TAMIL NADU WATER SUPPLY AND DRAINAGE BOARD**
INVITATION OF BIDS – TWO COVER – PERCENTAGE TENDER SYSTEM (E-Submission)

| | |
|---|---|
| IFB No. | 06/ F.TPP 2nd Call /DO1/CNC/CBE/2026/Dt.28.09.2026 |
| Fund | Deposit Work |
| Eligibility | Registered Class I Contractors |
| Tender Invitee | The Superintending Engineer, TWAD Board,Coimbatore-Nilgiris Circle, Coimbatore-641 004. |
| Downloading period | **01.10.2026** to **15.10.2026** up to **15.00** Hours |
| EMD Payable at | **Online Mode** (or) **eBG** through E-Tendering Portal |
| Pre-Bid meeting | **08.10.2026** at **11.00** Hours at the office of the Tender Invitee |
| Bid Submission | **15.10.2026** before **15.00** Hours Digitally signed encrypted Tenders through E-Tendering website **https://tntenders.gov.in** |
| Bid opening | **16.10.2026** at **15.30** Hours in the office of the Tender Invitee. |

| Sl. No | Name of work | Approximate value of work including GST @ 18% | Bid Security |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Shifting of existing Clear Water main of size 700mm AC to 711 mm MS Pipe for a length of 458M from Vilankurichi BSR under CWSSS to CLPRA with Pillur Reservoir as a source due to Construction of Road over Bridge at Km 0/6 of Thaneerpandal Road LS 1080m to LS 1538M as deposit work for the year 2025-26 (Construction Period – 3 Months, Trial Run – 1 Month & Free Maintenance – 1 Month)2nd Call. | Rs.92.00 Lakhs | Rs.50,000/- |

DIPR/ **2991** /TENDER/2026 Superintending Engineer,
SAVE WATER, CONSERVE WATER, EVERY DROP COUNTS TWAD Board, Coimbatore- Nilgiris Circle, Coimbatore.



**CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS**
**NOTICE FOR ENGAGEMENT OF CONTRACT MEDICAL PRACTITIONERS(Specialist) ON FULL TIME CONTRACT BASIS**
**No. GMA/GS/1521(CMP)(4)-Pt-III , Date: 26.09.2026.** Chittaranjan Locomotive Works (CLW), under the Ministry of Railways, Government of India desires to engage Contract Medical Practitioners (Specialist) on full-time contract basis on fixed monthly remuneration against 02 (UR-02) vacant post on contractual basis through Walk-in-Interview for a period of one (01) year or till further order whichever is earlier. Notification in this regard has been uploaded in CLW Website **(https://clw.indianrailways.gov.in)→ under link News & Recruitment→News and Announcement.** Eligible Doctors (Specialist) are advised to fill up the application format enclosed as Annexure-A with the **Notification dated 25.09.2026** and **report to CLW/Chittaranjan for Walk-in-Interview on 23.10.2026 (10.00hrs).**
PR1/505 SPO/Gaz, CLW, Chittaranjan
Like us on : www.facebook.com/clwrailways



**BUSINESS CONNECT** A Business Initiative

## SASTRA's Graduation Day



"The transformational role of AI is still in its exploration phase and 80% of the investments made by corporates are yet to see desired returns on investment," said Mr. Ganesh Lakshminarayanan, MD and CEO, TATA Communications Limited, the graduation day speaker at SASTRA Deemed University, Thanjavur. He also launched the CoE in Cybersecurity and Digital Forensics which is a research and capacity building facility to crate focussed manpower capable of handling various levels of digital and cyber vulnerabilities. Prince Jayakumar, EVP & Global Head of HR, HCL Technologies and Dr.S.Vaidhyasubramaniam, Vice-Chancellor of SASTRA presided over the occassion . Both corporate leaders gave away degrees to over 1000 School of Computing graduates.

## Joyalukkas Delivers to TN's Initiative

Joyalukkas Group has completed the first batch of 89,955 one-gram, 22K gold rings for the Tamil Nadu Government's Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam, initiated by CM, C. Joseph Vijay. This initiative aims to benefit approximately 4.41 lakh newborn children delivered in government hospitals across the State. Joyalukkas emerged as the lowest bidder, offering to make the rings at just one paisa (excluding gold costs). The rings will be supplied to 107 designated hospitals, featuring BIS hallmarks and HUID numbers for authenticity. Dr. Joy Alukkas, Chairman and MD, stated, "Tamil Nadu has given us immense love and support over the years, and this initiative gives Joyalukkas an opportunity to contribute in a meaningful way to the people of the State."

## PS4 Opens Its 28th Outlet



PS4 – Perambur Sri Srinivasa Sweets & Snacks has expanded its network with the launch of its 28th outlet at Tambaram Sanitorium on GST Road. The Tambaram Sanitorium outlet on GST Road is strategically located to serve residents, families and commuters from Tambaram, Chromepet and the surrounding southern suburbs. The launch also comes at a time when the GST Road corridor continues to see significant residential and commercial activity, making it a natural extension of the PS4 network. "Reaching our 28th outlet is a proud milestone for PS4." said the management of Perambur Sri Srinivasa Sweets & Snacks. The new Tambaram Sanitorium outlet adds another chapter to its expansion story.

## Navin's MD at the CII IGBC Summit



At the CII IGBC Green Tamil Nadu Summit 2026, Mr. Navin Kumar, Managing Director of Navin's, emphasized that sustainable buildings are being assessed on both environmental merit and long-term financial returns. In discussing the business case for green buildings, he noted that estimates for additional capital expenditure vary from 0.5 percent to 4 percent, with costs for platinum certification potentially reaching 10%. He highlighted the long-term benefits of green buildings, particularly energy and water savings, and mentioned that financial institutions now offer preferential borrowing rates for green projects. He concluded that true sustainability starts with moving toward Net Zero Water and Zero Waste.

## Bob Supports Smart City Initiatives



Bank of Baroda, Chennai Zone has extended support for the installation of solar-powered smart poles integrated with CCTV surveillance in Chennai. Shri T. N. Suresh, General Manager, Bank of Baroda, Chennai Zone, handed over the cheque for the installation to Shri Prem Anand Sinha, IPS, Additional Director General of Police & Commissioner of Police, Tambaram City, in the presence of Shri A. Thirumalaikumar, Deputy Commissioner of Police, Tambaram Armed Reserve. This Smart Pole initiative will enhance CCTV-based surveillance and public safety while complementing sustainability efforts under bobearth, the Bank's green initiative. Bank of Baroda continues to collaborate with authorities for safer, smarter communities.

## Kamakshi Hospital's STEM Therapy



India's DCGI-approved stem cell therapy has entered clinical practice for the first time in Tamil Nadu at Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals. Knee osteoarthritis causes pain and loss of function, with conventional treatments sometimes requiring advanced options. Modern knee care focuses on personalized treatment based on the patient's condition. At Dr. Kamakshi Memorial Hospitals, Dr. Deepak Kumar KS, Chief Consultant – Orthopaedic Surgeon and Certified Mako Stryker Specialist, and Dr. Sathish Kumar Thangamani, MS(Ortho), D.Ortho., Dip (ABRM), Fellowship in Stem Cell and Regenerative Medicine, collaborate to explore treatment possibilities. This collaboration combines orthopaedic assessment with regenerative medicine, aiming to preserve the natural knee and use advanced technology when necessary, helping patients regain confidence and independence.

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# From shooting at haystacks to shooting for gold

Every archer knows the wait between release and arrival, that held breath when nothing can be changed and everything is decided. For Chikitha, the wait lasted years. It began in a backyard, ran through lockdowns and a snapped bowstring, and ended in Aichi-Nagoya with a double triumph





REUTERS & PTI

**Anirudh Velamuri**

The two gold medals she has snapped up at the 2026 Asian Games have catapulted the extremely shy compound archer Chikitha Taniparthi into the national headlines. The 21-year-old, who hails from a modest farming family in Peddapalli in Telangana, is a stranger to stardom and the sprinkling of opulence that sporting achievements usually carry along in India.

There are no fancy routines or competition-day playlists yet. She doesn't even carry a pair of earphones. All she has is a burning hunger to become India's most decorated archer ever. And she's off to quite a start.

For all the reticence, Chikitha – a huge Mahesh Babu fan – finds inspiration in films that are of a more audacious ilk.

"There was a movie Ram Charan did last year called Game Changer. After watching that – and it usually happens when I watch certain films – I thought, what should I do or learn from this? I myself should change the game where I am," Chikitha told *The Hindu* a few weeks before setting out to Japan for the Asiad.

"Now, everyone says, whatever rank Chikitha is in, she will somehow change the game and come up. Similarly, I watched a film called Biker, where the message blared, 'No fear.' It all registers somewhere."

## Of betrayal and faith

That itch to push beyond the ordinary is a Taniparthi family trait. Her father, Srinivas Rao – a huge sports enthusiast – combed newspapers for summer camps his own childhood never offered.

"Naanna (father) didn't have any such facilities when he was growing up, so he was keen to ensure that I had access to all that, within our means."

In school, Chikitha tried her hand at a multitude of options including volleyball, badminton, basketball and kho kho. But Srinivas wanted his child to pursue an individual discipline. Towards that end, she earned a black belt in karate. But archery was destined to be the one to stick with.

"Team sports are riddled with politics. Since archery is an individual game, whatever we do is directly visible and we do what we do for ourselves."

The year was 2018. Chikitha's uncle, on her father's request, had got her a recurve bow from Decathlon with which she trained behind her house, shooting at haystacks. Eventually, she and a few of her classmates went to the Police Training Center to try and find a coach to teach them. There, someone asked her to switch to a compound bow and took money from Srinivas for the same, only to disappear without a trace.

Disappointed but not disillusioned, the father and daughter persisted with the sport. Chikitha moved away from recurve and towards compound.

"Recurve bow needs a lot of practice and power. You need to train every single day. If you return after resting for a few days, you'll see so many changes and will have to rework it all. With compound, I could train for two hours each in the morning and evening. It needed the archer to set themselves mentally and keep getting better."

The next pursuit became trying to purchase a compound bow, but the COVID-19 pandemic arrived soon after.

"Our classes all went online, so I could train every day. At that point I didn't know what a national medal was, but I wanted to win one."

"During Covid, my father had set up a target and a 50m path so I could shoot. He would go to the field every morning. My brother and I would go running every morning along the edges of our field. That is when I became really fit. In fact, my father also joined us and improved," Chikitha recalled. "Eventually I left for Sonipat, and my father settled back into the duties of the house. The family's fitness streak sort of snapped there."



Srinivas pushed beyond his means to support his daughter's dream. He even sold the family's paddy harvester. Meanwhile, YouTube videos formed the bedrock of Chikitha's technical base, and one of the archers she grew to idolise – Abhishek Verma – would become her mentor.

Eventually, the District Collector's office sanctioned funds for a compound bow. As she looked for a coach and a good training centre, Chikitha chanced upon the contact details of My Choice Archery Store, an equipment outlet run by Abhishek and his wife Sonali in New Delhi.

## Guiding light

"I got her number from the shop they run and I knew she was Abhishek anna's wife. He and his coach (Lokesh Chand Pal) agreed to take me in for training at the Yamuna Sports Complex for five days."

This was in August 2021. As the world found a way to open up again, so did Chikitha's prospects as an archer. Her uncle chipped in with funds for the trip to the capital.

There, Abhishek told Srinivas to leave Chikitha's well-being to him.

The first goal was a sub-junior medal.

"I didn't know much about archery, but I used to watch Abhishek anna's videos and check with my father if I was getting things right. Anna then told me that my strength was good, but he changed my anchor technique.

"In the mornings, he used to let me shoot 50-100 arrows. In the evenings, there would be no shooting. We just trained holding the bow and arrow in place. This was to develop patience. I learnt all my basics there at the Yamuna Sports Complex."

Chikitha entered the senior nationals in preparation for the sub-junior event and got a very low score there. Her mentor had notes, and the pair eventually struck off the first box in what would become a long checklist of turfs to conquer.

She then participated in selection trials to make it to the Sports Authority of India's National Centre of Excellence in Sonipat. There, coach Vivek Kumar took her under his wing. "After my father, he is the only person I open up to after tournaments and cry with," Chikitha said.

"In 2021, I was in Hyderabad for the National Ranking Archery Tournament. Abhishek told me that there was a talented girl I should meet. Her father brought her to the hotel we were staying in. This girl was so small and frail. I asked her if she wanted to go to Sonipat. She nodded in agreement, but there were tears too," Vivek told *The Hindu*.

Nonetheless, he persisted. "If a player like Abhishek recommends someone, you cannot ignore that. He told us she would become a good archer like Jyothi Surekha."

Abhishek, it turned out, was right. The parallels between Chikitha and Jyothi are endless. Both are introverts by nature, content to shuttle between the training field and the gym. Both follow instructions to the letter, even when that means shooting 300-odd arrows, and both are always early, rain or shine.

Vivek remembers Chikitha clinging to her father until the moment they parted. Slowly, Sonipat won her over. By night, she had found the courage to make a request: biryani. The coaches understood how hard it is for someone from South India to move to a diet where rotis reign, and they indulged her.

Any doubts about her potential evaporated at the trials ahead of the 2022 Asian Games. She missed qualification but finished a commendable seventh, enough to convince her coaches that she could be shaped into an athlete who would make India proud on the global stage.

Ask Chikitha why she likes archery and three bullet points follow. "First, because, as my dad wanted, it's an individual sport. Second, archery is a sport where I can concentrate and focus with no distractions. Third, Anna told me, 'You are a champion, and you will continue to be.'"

Others' faith in her sowed the seeds of Chikitha's ambitions; formal training is teaching her to nurture them herself. That process has not been without its hiccups. In 2024, Chikitha struggled to place among the top 16 and had lost motivation mid-season.

"That period was a struggle and I couldn't accept it. Before the national games, I wanted to get selected, but I was nowhere near the top. I was working with high poundage, and I said if I hit any more (shooting arrows), I might get injured. I didn't feel like shooting. It took me some time to recover from that. I went to Tirupati, tonsured my head, prayed very hard," she recalled.

Through every hardship, Chikitha never once thought of abandoning archery.

When her first substantial prize money arrived, after the 2023 National Games in Goa, she spent it on arrows, stockpiled for practice. A fresh set every few months is her idea of a treat.

"It is not about the money; it does not matter as long as the results come my way."

Ask Chikitha what she is proud of and, along with the golds, she may mention the gift of deep sleep. Thunder can rattle every window, but she will slumber on.

"I don't get sleep only when thoughts come to me, which happens when everything is silent."

Then she went to Japan and became the lightning. Whether or not she slept through the aftermath, India did not. Two golds flashed across the sky, and a sport that thought it knew its stars blinked in the glare.

## THE GIST

- Chikitha is India's first double gold medallist at the 2026 Asian Games, triumphing in the women's compound team and mixed team events
- Chikitha and Sahil (mixed team) also helped secure India a quota for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics
- A Decathlon bow, shooting at haystacks in her backyard and YouTube tutorials were her first training ground, while lockdown and a snapped bowstring couldn't stop her
- Her father sold his harvester so his daughter could chase a target. In Aichi-Nagoya, she paid it back in gold
- When Abhishek failed to make the cut for the Asian Games, he told his mentee to become the Asian Games champion and bring him the toy as a gift. The 21-year-old now has two, with a chance to bid for a third in the individual event

# Subatomic ambitions take five Indian school students to CERN

The students say they spent hours every day preparing for the 'Beamline for Schools' competition, organised by the European Laboratory for Particle Physics for high school students around the world; they tried to measure how often a charged pion turns into a neutral one when it hits 'light' atoms

**T.V. Padma**
NEW DELHI

A group of Indian school students are among the five winning teams of the 13th edition of the 'Beamline for Schools' competition, a physics competition for high school students from all around the world organised by CERN, the European Laboratory for Particle Physics, in Geneva.

The Indian team, named "attoPION", comprises Nenavath Abhay Vivek, Sidhartha Aniket Jaiswal, Ayush Bhardwaj, Aarush Mandala, and Aritra Sadhukhan. They are from Bansal Junior College Nizamabad; Greenwood High International School, Bengaluru; The Shri Ram Global School, Greater Noida; and Purv International School, Durgapur.

They found each other through different science competitions they participated in.



A view of the Large Hadron Collider at CERN. CERN

## Tracking pions

A beamline is a facility that provides high-energy fluxes of subatomic particles that can be used to conduct experiments in different fields, including fundamental physics, material science and medicine. The other four winning teams are from Bangladesh, Türkiye, the U.K., and the U.S.

The Indian students' project was based on a process called pion charge exchange. In particle physics, pions are subatomic particles that can have a positive, negative or neutral charge. The students tried to measure how often a charged pion turns into a neutral one when it hits "light" atoms like lithium and beryllium, and they looked at this change of charge at specific energy levels.

These readings are of interest for the Deep Underground Neutrino Experiment, a large physics experiment under construction in the U.S.

When neutrinos hit an atom, they produce pions. If the pions change their charge before they even leave the atom, it can mess up the data scientists see, the students said. Recording how often this change takes place in lithium and beryllium will allow scientists to model it correctly in their simulations.

## Learning the basics

When the students started, they did not have any formal training in particle physics.

"We were just a group of 11th and 12th graders who were obsessed with the subject," they said. "In the beginning, it felt like we were trying to solve a high-level puzzle without having the box with the picture on it. We spent so much time reading papers and talking to mentors just to get our heads around the theory."

The students said they spent several hours every day in the three to four weeks before the competition. While the first week was mostly about recruiting and forming a team, the next three weeks were a complete grind.

The team started with the basics, with *Griffiths Introduction to Elementary Particles* (1987) serving as their main reference book. They also said *A Tour of the Subatomic Zoo* (1992) gave them their first big picture and that YouTube lectures by experts at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, and courses on the National Programme on Technology Enhanced Learning (NPTEL) kept them going.

"Once we had the basics, we moved to CERN documentation and research papers from CERN and other institutions," they said. "For the Geant4 simulations, we used CERN's official documentation and some of their preloaded models, which we then tweaked to test our own idea in the initial stages."

Sometimes, understanding just one research paper or one detector concept would take them days. "We just kept going until the physics finally started making sense," one of the students said. "We were pulling all-nighters to finish the proposal before the deadline."

"We feel once you start counting hours, your focus shifts from learning to the clock. We just kept going until the physics finally started making sense."

Physics that could make sense to high-schoolers was one constraint. Two others were that the participants had to design an experiment from scratch and that it could actually be run at CERN.

So the students proposed a setup to collect data across different energy levels and different types of atoms to see the variations.

"We were nervous because we were so new to this, but after a lot of collaboration and refining the technical details, we felt confident enough to hit the submit button," they said.

A love for physics in particular was a strong motivation. "We thought of it as an opportunity to try something new and unconventional and learn something during that process," they added.



Members of the 'Team attoPION'. BEAMLINE FOR SCHOOLS, CERN

## Mentoring helps

Once the team was in place, the students hunted for mentors to guide them. They started by cold-emailing several PhD scholars, postdocs, and graduate students across universities in India and abroad.

They struck luck with Manu Srivastava, a doctoral scholar at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology in the U.S., and received additional feedback on their experimental design from Laxman Mekala at IIT-Bombay.

"My role was purely a supervisory one," Mr. Srivastava said. "The students came up with different ideas and worked out all the calculations themselves." He added: "I only had to guide them about which ideas would be more worthwhile to pursue, so in a way just providing direction and giving minimal feedback on their work."

The students' discussions among themselves and with Mr. Srivastava were online. "To me, that is a powerful example of how technology is becoming a unifying force at the grassroots level in India, allowing talented students from different regions to come together around a shared scientific goal. Such collaborations would have been much more difficult to imagine even a decade ago," Mr. Srivastava said.

He added that the students' achievement was made more remarkable by the competition's scale. Beamline for Schools is a prestigious international science competition for high-school students and this year attracted more than 700 proposals from around the world.

## 'Just the start'

A lot of students think competitions like this are too tough and not for them, the students said.

"We want to tell them that sometimes the biggest opportunities start from a very simple question or a crazy idea," they said. "Curiosity is enough to start. If you are curious enough to try, keep learning and do not give up when it gets difficult, you might end up in places you never imagined."

Looking ahead, the students would like to keep the momentum going, stay connected as a team, and collaborate with other physicists. They would also like to engage in outreach for the BL4S program to help other students.

"All of us are definitely planning to pursue careers in STEM and keep doing our own research. Being at CERN is just the start for us," they said.

*(T.V. Padma is a science journalist based in New Delhi. tvpadma_10@yahoo.co.in)*



The SpaceX Starship rocket lifts off on its 14th test flight from Texas in the U.S. on Monday. AP

# *SpaceX Starship engine failure could hit NASA's lunar mission*

**Reuters**

The Starship engine failure that nearly foiled the orbital debut of SpaceX's next-generation spacecraft on its 14th uncrewed test flight may complicate NASA's ability to meet its time frame for astronaut missions to the moon.

Starship, designed in part to carry large payloads to space, is one of two vehicles vying to become the first craft that NASA will use as early as 2028 to land humans on the moon and bring them safely home, a feat last achieved in 1972 at the end of the Apollo era.

While Starship accomplished a number of key objectives in its latest test launch from Texas on Monday, the mission was cut short by several hours after a malfunction of its propulsion system.

Despite the unexpected shutdown of one of its three main Raptor engines following Starship separation from its lower-stage booster rocket, flight controllers proceeded with sending the spacecraft to orbit for its first-ever commercial satellite deployment.

Determining what caused the engine glitch remains critical to SpaceX's bottom line. But the stakes are potentially higher for NASA, as a Starship moon-landing vehicle would rely on the same engine system for transporting astronauts through space to and from the lunar surface.

How big a blow to Starship's development progress the engine snafu becomes depends on whether it turns out to be "a one-off failure of a single part" or points to a larger design problem that requires upgrades "across the fleet," said Dean Sladen, an aerospace engineer for Accu Components.

"Any engine fix that holds up the next flights, including the planned attempt to catch the ship with the launch tower's arms (after re-entry), eats into that schedule," he said.

SpaceX did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

A NASA spokesperson did not address questions for comment on the engine issue or its Artemis programme, instead pointing to a post on X from the head of the space agency, Jared Isaacman, saying Starship had "achieved an important milestone."

## 'The real pressure is the moon'

A longer delay would pose not only a greater setback to SpaceX's commercial ambitions to rapidly expand its Starlink broadband satellite network, but its pivotal role in NASA's Artemis moon programme.

Raptor engine and propulsion-system issues have contributed to several previous Starship setbacks, including an engine that failed to ignite as planned during Starship's 12th flight in May. The methane-fuelled engines are among the most complex and expensive components on the rocket. During some previous flights, SpaceX scrubbed plans to test-ignite the Raptor engine in space. But all of the engines successfully fired during ascent on Starship's 13th flight in July.

SpaceX is competing with Blue Origin, the rival rocket company from fellow entrepreneur Jeff Bezos, to usher in an era of lunar exploration under NASA's Artemis programme.

While SpaceX was originally contracted to provide the first crewed lunar lander for Artemis, Isaacman said in April that NASA would go with whichever lander was ready to fly first. NASA saw the added competition as healthy for progress in light of mounting delays in Starship's test flight programme.

NASA officially aims to return astronauts to the moon's surface by 2028, a target widely seen as overly ambitious, to get there ahead of China, which plans a crewed lunar landing by 2030.

## THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Please send in your answers to science@thehindu.co.in

# The world faces a 'narrowing window' to restore forests essential to food security and the climate. A quiz on forests

**Radhika Santhanam**

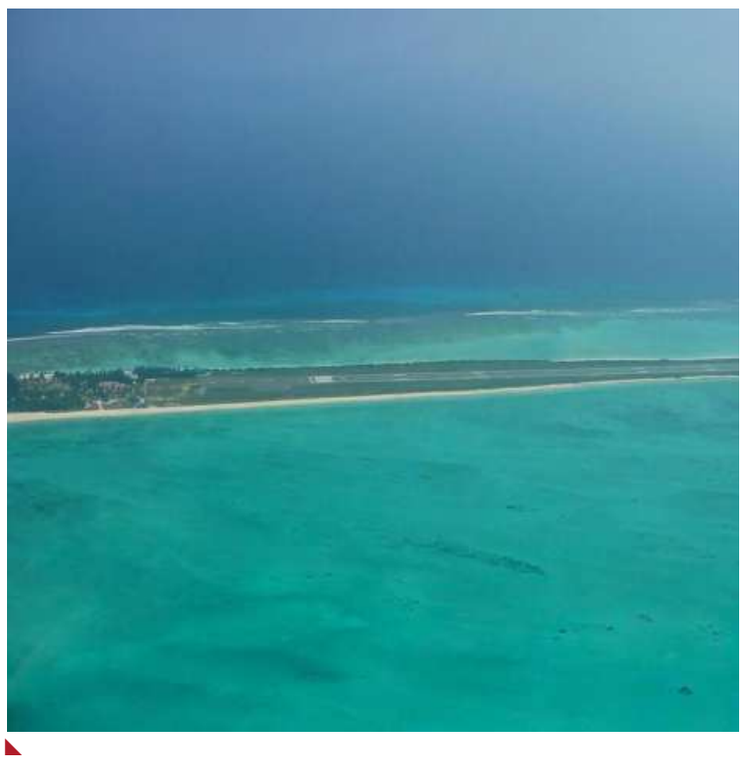
**QUESTION #1**
This layer of the tropical rainforest receives the most sunlight. It is also home to the majority of the rainforest's plant and animal species. The layer also refers to a cloth covering suspended over a bed or an ornamental roof-like structure. Name the layer.

**QUESTION #2**
Taiga in Russian means 'land of little sticks'. Which hemisphere is a vast majority of the taiga biome — characterised by long, severe winters and short summers and coniferous evergreen trees — located in? Also give the widely used name for the taiga biome, which comes from a Greek word.

**QUESTION #3**
Underneath the forest floor, intertwined with the roots of the trees, is a network of fungus. It helps trees share nutrients, water, and chemical warning signals. What is it called? Also, if www refers to the worldwide web, this network is a different kind of www, as dubbed by the German forester Peter Wohlleben. What does this www stand for?

**QUESTION #4**
These are unique ecosystems that thrive in the interface between land and sea. They account for less than 1% of global tropical forests but they are critical ecosystems as their tangled roots provide protection against storms and erosion. Examples of these ecosystems in India include the Sundarbans and Pichavaram. What are they called?

**QUESTION #5**
These forests cover an area larger than Alaska and span six countries. They house the critically endangered forest elephant and the largest number of great ape species. The forests are named after a country that is the 11th largest in the world and where French is the most widely spoken language. Name these forests.



**Visual:** Name this place, which reports 0% recorded forest area in India. JULIO (CC BY-SA)

**Answers to September 22 quiz:**
1. Only mammal covered in true scales – **Ans: Pangolins**
2. Source of the greenish tinge of sloth fur – **Ans: Algae**
3. Bird with a spiky crest; national bird of Guyana – **Ans: Hoatzin**
4. Animal that uses leafy appendages to camouflage – **Ans: Leafy sea dragon**
5. Musk ox's soft, fine underwool prized for light textiles – **Ans: Qiviut**
Visual: **Lyrebird**

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# Text&Context

THE HINDU

## NEWS IN NUMBERS

### Amount received by Mizoram under the Centre's schemes

**75.79** in ₹ crore. Mizoram received ₹75.79 crore under central schemes to develop the agriculture sector of the State, an official statement said on Wednesday. Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan handed over the release orders to State Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare Minister P.C. Vanlalruata in New Delhi on Tuesday. PTI

### Community halls to be turned into Ayushman Arogya Mandirs

**78** The Municipal Corporation of Delhi will set up Ayushman Arogya Mandirs (AyAMs) in its community halls across the capital to strengthen primary healthcare accessibility for local residents, officials said. Under the initiative led by the MCD's health department, 78 under-utilised civic halls will host primary health centres under the centrally sponsored scheme. PTI

### Number of women executed in the U.S. since 1976

**18** The U.S. state of Tennessee was set on Wednesday to execute a woman for the first time in 200 years, three decades after she murdered a classmate. Christa Pike, now 50, was 18 when she and her boyfriend beat and killed Colleen Slemmer, 19, at a job training camp for young people. In the United States, only 18 women have been executed since 1976, the Center says. AFP

### Percentage decline in seaborne imports of motor fuels to Russia

**24** in per cent. Seaborne imports of motor fuels to Russia fell by about 24% month-on-month in September to 350,000 metric tons, while Moscow continued to struggle with oil products shortages, sources said. The main bulk of seaborne fuel imports into Russian ports in September consisted of gasoline supplied from India, Morocco and Turkiye, traders said. REUTERS

### Union government's fiscal deficit at the end of August

**7.1** in ₹ lakh crore. The Union government's fiscal deficit stood at ₹7.1 lakh crore or 41.9% of the full-year target at the end of August, according to data released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA) on Wednesday. The deficit was at 38.1% of the Budget Estimates (BE) of 2025-26 during the corresponding period last year. PTI

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# The significance of the Cardiff MoU

The Memorandum of Understanding signals growing demands for autonomy in Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland, though their constitutional goals differ; it also calls for closer ties with the EU, putting pressure on Westminster to address their aspirations

WORLD INSIGHT

Joan Sony Cherian

On September 14, the First Ministers of Northern Ireland, Wales and Scotland came together in Cardiff, the capital city of Wales, to sign a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) and declared, "For the first time ever, people across these islands have First Ministers...who are all committed to independence from the United Kingdom. For people watching across these islands – for people watching around the world – there could be no clearer sign that Westminster's time is coming to an end." The MoU is being seen as a significant political statement by all three parties towards constitutional independence from the U.K.

The U.K. is often described as a multi-national state (or a State of Unions), developed gradually over several centuries. As per the Cabinet Office, the U.K. is comprised of four 'nations' – England, Wales, Scotland and Northern Ireland.

The nations of Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland have strong cultural identities, their own language and customs as well as complicated histories vis-a-vis England, marked by conquests and rebellions. It is owing to such strong assertions of identity and independence that these nations within the U.K. have been granted varying degrees of self-government and devolved powers. However, calls for independence or an absolute devolution of powers have always remained in public discourse, and today, with the leaders of all three nations being vocal proponents of self-determination, the mandate has been brought to Westminster in full force.

However, independence does not look the same for all three nations; it's characterised by their specific contexts, histories and geopolitical locations.

**The Irish question**

Northern Ireland is governed by a power-sharing agreement known as consociationalism, as laid down in the Good Friday Agreement of 1998. Considering the tumultuous history of violence between the pro-Irish (Nationalists or Republicans) and pro-Union (Loyalists or Unionists) groups, consociationalism mandates that power should be shared between all sectarian groups equally. Therefore, both the Nationalist and the Unionist blocs need to hold power together. After elections, the largest party in the largest political bloc will hold the position of First Minister, while the largest party in the second-largest political bloc can have the post of Deputy First Minister. Currently, Sinn Fein, the largest Nationalist party, is in power, with its Vice-President, Michelle O'Neill, leading the country.

However, pro-Irish groups in Northern Ireland and Sinn Fein do not wish for independence; they wish to unite with the Republic of Ireland. Owing to such strong sympathies, the Good Friday Agreement has a clause which keeps this option open – that the people of Northern Ireland could seek reunification with Ireland any time, subject to a referendum. However, a referendum can be called only by the U.K. Secretary of State for Northern Ireland if no other referendum has taken place in the past seven years or if the Secretary thinks that a majority of people wish to leave the U.K. and join Ireland.

The Unionists have strongly pushed back against the MoU. Emma Little-Pengelly, the Deputy First Minister, said the MoU was signed by Ms. O'Neill in her capacity as a leader of Sinn Fein and not as First Minister. It isn't, she said, "on behalf of Northern Ireland".



(From left) Scotland's John Swinney, Wales' Rhun ap Iorwerth, Sinn Féin's Mary Lou McDonald and Northern Ireland's Michelle O'Neill during a meeting, in Cardiff, on September 14. AP

**Scotland's independence push**

Many in Scotland, on the other hand, wish for it to become an independent country. Scotland voted for devolution in a 1997 referendum, and the Scottish Parliament was established in 1999. However, ever since the Scottish National Party (SNP) took power in the Holyrood (Scottish Parliament) in 2007, the demand for an absolute devolution of powers has been in the public discourse. The party had been consistently pushing for a referendum in Scotland on the question of independence, with one finally being held in 2014. While the referendum saw a massive turnout, the result was a major blow to the SNP; the Yes camp, which believed that Scotland should be independent, lost, receiving 44.7% of the votes. The No campaign won 55.3% of the total votes. While this led to a mild dampener for a period of time, the SNP, under Nicola Sturgeon, revived the demand again post-Brexit. She alleged that even though 62% of the Scottish people voted to remain in the European Union (EU), the U.K. left the alliance; this underlined the importance of self-determination for the Scottish people.

Currently, John Swinney, Prime Minister and leader of the SNP, upholds the same demand. While he advocated for the steady and gradual devolution of powers from Westminster when he first took the post of First Minister in 2024, the victory of pro-Independence parties in the recent state elections, held in May 2026, has given Mr. Swinney and the SNP fresh hope. Together with the Scottish Green Party, the Holyrood now has 73 pro-independence members. Mr. Swinney has taken this to mean a shift in public opinion about the need for total devolution and has strongly pushed for mechanisms to hold a second referendum by 2031.

**A shift in Wales**

The strong stand taken by Wales in signing the MoU is somewhat of a departure from its earlier position. The nation, a stronghold of the Labour Party for nearly a century, now has a non-Labour government led by Rhun ap Iorwerth, leader of Plaid Cymru.

Plaid Cymru, established in 1925, has always held the ideal of self-determination at the centre of its political project. However, support for an independent Welsh nation has been a relatively minor position within the country as compared to Scotland. For example, the Welsh referendum in 1997, which was the first step to devolution of powers and the creation of a Welsh National Assembly, passed very narrowly with just 50.3% voting in favour of an Assembly as opposed to 49.7% who voted against the motion.

However, since then, the momentum for greater devolution from Westminster and more autonomy has been steadily gaining ground in the region. In the 2011 referendum, which was to decide whether the National Assembly for Wales should gain the power to legislate on a wider range of matters, the result was more promising with almost 63.49% voting yes for more powers as opposed to just 36.51% voting no.

The Labour Party, while being opposed to the idea of a total devolution of powers, has increasingly argued for more constitutional powers to Wales, especially regarding matters of policing and justice. In fact, in November 2021, the Labour-led Welsh government set up an Independent Commission on the Constitutional Future of Wales in order to seriously consider the possibility of an independent Wales along with other potential options such as enhanced devolution, and a more federal U.K. The Commission submitted its report in 2024 wherein it emphasised that the idea of an independent Wales cannot be kept out of popular imagination anymore even though it still does not enjoy as much as popular support as it does in Scotland. The report also underlined the possible "short-term to medium" risks especially with respect to currency, government finances, trade and movement across borders.

Therefore, Mr. Iorwerth's positioning, even while signing the MoU at Cardiff with Scotland and Northern Ireland, has been much more mellow than the other two regions. He has ruled out pushing for a referendum in his current term but has insisted that the possibility should be kept open; he stated that the people of Wales should have the option "to decide its own future".

**Response from Westminster**

The U.K. Prime Minister Andy Burnham came to power riding on the agenda of more devolution of powers to local regions. He is a strong supporter of decentralisation; of giving more power to local governments and communities. In fact, in order to decentralise and shift power from central London, he has established a northern branch of 10, Downing Street in Manchester.

However, when Mr. Burnham visited Northern Ireland in August, he categorically stated that a border poll (referendum) on Irish unity was "off the table". He said that his focus was to fix immediate crises such as the cost-of-living pressure and problems with public services. The reactions to his comments were sharp with nationalist parties taking it as a denouncement of the Good Friday Agreement. Sinn Féin's president Mary Lou McDonald, who was the fourth signatory to the MoU, had stated that "We have the right to a referendum. We have the right to decide our future.... We will not accept or tolerate any Prime Minister telling us that right is off the table."

The response to Scottish calls for a referendum have also been pretty much the same. When Mr. Swinney had written to Mr. Burnham, and asked if a mechanism for a referendum could be enshrined in law, Mr. Burnham stated that a Scottish border poll is currently "off-limits".

**The EU demand**

Another significant aspect of the MoU was the call to reintegrate with the EU. The statement reads, "Brexit has damaged our economies, and limited opportunities for our people. Europe is our common home, and we believe the future of our nations belongs in the European Union".

During the Brexit vote in 2016, Scotland (62%) and Northern Ireland (55%) had voted to remain. In Wales, roughly 52% voted to leave the EU, although a large minority voted to remain. All three governing parties are now resolute in their stance that the Brexit vote has been a total political failure. Even though a Trade and Cooperation Agreement has been signed with the EU, these nations allege that "non-tariff barriers" such as extra and time consuming paper work add to import and export delays.

However, reintegration would not be easy. Even if all three nations were to leave the U.K., reintegrating into the EU is a long process which could take years. For example, Montenegro has been in accession negotiations since 2012, and Serbia since 2014.

The Cardiff MoU is not a legal or multi-lateral treaty; it is a significant political statement by the governing parties of three regions, with varied histories, to put pressure on U.K.'s asymmetric federal model. Westminster's constant refrain of 'there are more important things to worry about' gives these nations the idea that autonomy and devolution of powers is not seen as important enough by the U.K. Parliament. For a Prime Minister who has made decentralisation his central campaign, Mr. Burnham would be wise to pay more heed to the nations' aspirations.

## THE GIST

- Northern Ireland's push is centred on reunification with Ireland, while Scotland is seeking independence and Wales is advocating greater autonomy, with the three nations' positions shaped by their distinct political histories
- In Scotland and Wales, recent political developments have strengthened demands for greater powers, with Scotland pushing for a second independence referendum and Wales keeping the possibility of independence open while favouring further devolution
- Westminster has rejected immediate calls for referendums on Scottish independence and Irish reunification, while the three nations' governments have criticised Brexit and called for closer integration with the European Union

LOKNITI SURVEY



# The gaps in cyber policing

For cybercrime victims, the challenges can continue well beyond the first step of reporting a complaint

# Satisfaction with police remains low among cybercrime victims

Cybercrime reporting has expanded, but 63% of victims remain dissatisfied with police handling, with satisfaction falling to 43% during investigations; women and rural victims face greater difficulties, including repeated visits and long waiting times

Krishangi Sinha

As India undergoes a rapid digital transformation, cybercrime has emerged as one of the country's fastest-growing public safety challenges. From online financial fraud and identity theft to investment scams and phishing attacks, millions of Indians now encounter crimes that often leave lasting financial and psychological consequences.

In response, governments have expanded cyber helplines, launched the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, and established specialised cyber police stations across States. Yet, despite these institutional efforts, the Status of Policing in India Report 2026 finds that nearly two in three cybercrime victims (63%) remain dissatisfied with how the police handle their complaints, with one in five reporting being very dissatisfied. The findings suggest that while access to reporting mechanisms has improved considerably, improvements in accessibility have not been matched by victims' experience of justice, making the gap between complaint registration and effective police action the weakest link in India's cyber policing system (Table 1).

The satisfaction index combines victims' experiences across four stages: the cyber helpline, online portal, complaint registration and police investigation.

Victims report the highest satisfaction at the first point of contact, with half of helpline users expressing satisfaction ("very and somewhat satisfied"). However, confidence steadily erodes as complaints move through the system, dropping to 47% for the online portal, 46% during complaint registration, and just 43% for police investigations. The findings suggest that the greatest challenge lies not in reporting cybercrime, but in seeing complaints through to a satisfactory resolution (Table 2).

**Victims lose confidence**

But the experience is not uniform. Women appear to have significantly poorer experiences than men (Table 3). While levels of moderate dissatisfaction are identical for both genders (42%), the gap widens in the most severe category. More than one in four women (26%) say they are very dissatisfied, compared to less than one in five men (18%).

For many victims, the challenge of reporting cybercrime is not only procedural but also time-consuming. 34 per cent of those who visited a police station to complain to the police waited two to three hours, while another 14% spent more than four hours before receiving assistance. Only 29% were attended to within an hour (Table 4). The findings suggest that lengthy waiting times continue to shape citizens' experience of accessing police services. Even where reporting mechanisms exist, delays at the police station may discourage victims from pursuing complaints, particularly in cases involving financial loss or repeated follow-up.

Registering and pursuing a complaint rarely ends with a single visit, as highlighted in Table 5. While 31% of victims reported visiting the police station only once or twice, nearly one in four had to return five times or more (23%). Victims in rural areas reported double the incidence of five or more visits to the police station (38%) compared to those residing in urban areas (19%). Repeated visits involve lost work hours, travel expenses, and administrative uncertainty, highlighting the need for more efficient case management and better communication during investigations.

Table 6 shows that victims' experiences of registering a complaint are mixed. A modest majority (57%) describe the process as very or somewhat easy, but 42% find it somewhat or very difficult. Across gender, women respondents were more likely to rate the process easier than men (61% and 54%, respectively).

India's cyber policing architecture has expanded rapidly over the past decade, reflecting the growing recognition of digital crime as a major governance challenge. However, the experiences of cybercrime victims suggest that institutional capacity is still uneven where it matters most: investigation, follow-up and victim support. The findings underline a broader lesson for policing reforms: strengthening public trust requires moving beyond easier reporting mechanisms towards a system that is responsive, transparent and capable of delivering timely justice.

*Krishangi Sinha is a researcher at Lokniti-CSDS. Views expressed are personal. This analysis is based on data collected during a comprehensive study on The Status of Policing in India Report 2026 jointly conducted by Lokniti-CSDS & Common Cause.*

**Table 1: Index of satisfaction with police's handling of cybercrime**

| Level of satisfaction | (%) |
|---|---|
| Very satisfied | 17 |
| Somewhat satisfied | 20 |
| Somewhat dissatisfied | 42 |
| Very dissatisfied | 21 |

*Note: The index was created from these questions posed to victims: police helpline number for cyber complaints, online police portal for cybercrime, complaint registration process at cyber police station and investigation of cybercrimes by the police.*



**Table 2: Satisfaction of the victims of cybercrimes with various police services**

| | Degree of satisfaction (victims) | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Very satisfied | Somewhat satisfied | Somewhat dissatisfied | Very dissatisfied | Never used these services* |
| Police helpline number for cybercrime complaints | 18 | 32 | 13 | 14 | 20 |
| Online police portal for cybercrime | 16 | 31 | 13 | 12 | 24 |
| Complaint registration process at the cyber police station | 16 | 30 | 14 | 12 | 23 |
| Investigation of cybercrime by the police | 17 | 26 | 13 | 17 | 22 |

**This was a silent option and was only coded if the respondent explicitly said that.*
*Note: All figures are in percentages. The rest did not respond. The table includes responses only from the victims.*
*Question asked: How satisfied were you with the following – very satisfied, somewhat satisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, or very dissatisfied?*

**Table 3: Satisfaction with police handling cybercrime by gender**

| Gender | Index of satisfaction with police handling cybercrime | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Very satisfied | Somewhat satisfied | Somewhat dissatisfied | Very dissatisfied |
| Male | 19 | 21 | 42 | 18 |
| Female | 15 | 17 | 42 | 26 |

**Table 4: Wait time (hours) at the police station to get complaint registered**

| Hours | (%) |
|---|---|
| 1 hour or less | 29 |
| 2 to 3 hours | 34 |
| 4 to 5 hours | 11 |
| More than 5 hours | 4 |

*Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages. The table includes responses only from the victims.*

**Table 5: Number of visits to the police station**

| Number of times | (%) |
|---|---|
| Once or twice | 31 |
| Three or four times | 24 |
| Five times or more | 23 |

*Note: The rest did not respond. All figures are in percentages. The table includes responses only from the victims.*

**Table 6: Overall ease of registering a police complaint about cybercrime**

| Ease | (%) |
|---|---|
| Very easy | 26 |
| Somewhat easy | 31 |
| Somewhat difficult | 25 |
| Very difficult | 17 |

*Note: The rest did not respond. All figures in percentages. The table includes responses only from the victims.*

THE DAILY QUIZ

# A quiz on all things coffee on the occasion of International Coffee Day

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

V. V. Ramanan

**QUESTION 1**
Name the place from which Baba Budan is said to have brought coffee beans to India, and how has the place's name become part of coffee lore?

**QUESTION 2**
What is the biggest contribution of Melitta Bentz and Achille Gaggia to the modern world of coffee brewing?

**QUESTION 3**
After which event did drinking coffee acquire a particularly patriotic significance among some American colonists as an alternative to tea?

**QUESTION 4**
What is the common name for the coffee species called 'Coffea canephora'?

**QUESTION 5**
Which famous brand was officially launched in 1938 to help surplus Brazilian coffee crops?

**QUESTION 6**
Which famous composer wrote a comic opera called 'Coffee Cantata' about a young woman whose father tries to come between her and her coffee?

**QUESTION 7**
What is the name given to a trained professional who prepares and serves espresso-based and other coffee drinks in a café or coffee shop?




**Visual Question:**
This expensive coffee consists of partially digested coffee cherries that have been eaten and defecated by which animal?

**Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz:** 1. Since 2012, CERN has held 'observer status' at the X, but without having the right to vote. As a result, CERN has been able to contribute scientific and technical expertise, central to X's work. Name X. **Ans: UN General Assembly**
2. When he was working at CERN, the English scientist ___ _____ ___ invented the World Wide Web. **Ans: Tim Berners-Lee**
3. What did India's Department of Atomic Energy present to CERN in 2004? It was selected to commemorate the Indian government's association with the organisation. **Ans: Statue of Lord Nataraja**
4. Of the 12 founding members of CERN, 11 remain. Name the country that ceded its membership in 1961, mainly for financial reasons. **Ans: Yugoslavia**
5. CERN runs a distributed computing project called _____. Here, people can donate spare processing power on their personal computers over the internet. **Ans: LHC@home**
Visual: Name this instrument, which is the largest particle collider on the Large Hadron Collider at CERN. It is 46 m long, 25 m high and 25 m wide, and weighs around 7,000 tonnes. **Ans: ATLAS**
**Early Birds:** Prem Raj P. | Jharna Kamdar | Dodo Jayaditya | Sitaram Saharay | Tariqa Bali



FROM THE ARCHIVES

# *Know your English*

S. Upendran

**What is the meaning of "wild card" in tennis? (S. Velayuthan, Madurai)**
Last year Goran Ivanisevic entered the Wimbledon Championship as a wild card and went on to win the men's singles title. Although he failed to get through the qualifying rounds, the officials at Wimbledon, taking into consideration his past performance, allowed him to play. And what a dream run Goran had! The expression "wild card" refers to a player who is allowed to participate in a tournament although technically he/she isn't qualified; he/she does not have the necessary ATP points. Selectors/officials usually determine who will receive the wild card. In most Grand Slam events, wild cards are given to up-and-coming players from the country where the event is taking place. For example, during the U.S. Open, most of the wild cards are given to Americans, and during Wimbledon, to the British players. Officials can give a top-ranked player a wild card as well.

**What is the meaning of "can't see the wood for the trees"? (Mita Paul, Visakhapatnam)**
Sometimes when you concentrate on the minute details of a problem, you lose sight of the overall picture; in other words, you focus on the unimportant, rather than on the important things. You miss the big picture. And that's what the expression "can't see the wood for the trees" means. The Americans tend to say "can't see the forest for the trees".

**Can the word "bon voyage" be used with people who are travelling by train or car? (B. Vishwanatha Rao, Hyderabad)**
Well, the expression "bon voyage" means have a good journey. So whether the journey is by car or train, it shouldn't make a difference. I am sure that in 50 years' time we will be saying "bon voyage" to people travelling to the moon (or wherever).

**What is the meaning of "get hot under the collar"? (G. Nithya, Thanjavur)**
When we get angry, usually our body temperature rises; our face and neck feel hot, our palms sweat, etc. And where is our neck? It's usually under the collar. To "get hot under the collar" means to get angry.

**Which of the following is correct? Compare to or compare with? (Murthy, Ravulapalam)**
Both are acceptable; there is a tendency these days to use the two interchangeably. Careful users of the language, however, make a distinction between the two. When you compare something "with" something, then what you are doing is looking for similarities and differences. If you compare yourself with Tendulkar, then you are trying to find out in what way you are similar to Tendulkar and, in what way you are different. You are not making a value judgement. You may come up with a list of similarities and differences – that you are three inches taller than Tendulkar, you haven't scored as many runs as the master batsman, etc. If, on the other hand, you compare yourself "to" Tendulkar, then you are placing yourself on the same level as the great batsman. You feel you are as good as Tendulkar. Remember the song sung by the "Artist Once Known as Prince", "Nothing compares to you"?
*Published in The Hindu on February 19, 2002*

## Word of the day

**Bellwether:** someone who assumes leadership of a movement or activity

**Synonyms:** leader, pioneer, trendsetter, forerunner

**Usage:** *His performance is a bellwether of the team's overall form.*

**Pronunciation:** newsth.live/bellwether

**International Phonetic Alphabet:** /belweðər/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'